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Times Business

Weakness in currency can create negative loop: HSBC

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Mumbai: HSBC has been in India since 1853 and has maintained the most consistent retail presence among global banks. Its Indian operations have doubled pre-tax profits in four years, making it the leading foreign bank by revenue and balance sheet, which stood at \$50 billion. Hitendra Dave, HSBC India's CEO since 2021, spoke about the bank's FCNR(B) mobilisation and ambitions in affluent banking. •How did HSBC lead FCNR(B) mobilisation? We are the most preferred global bank among India's affluent. Our deposit mobilisation reflects our strength and reach in the NRI community across markets. Beyond FCNR(B) deposits, HSBC has helped Indian banks raise dollar resources, deploying about \$1.5 billion to \$2 billion through bilateral bonds and similar amounts through foreign currency loans.

In the overseas bond issues by two private banks, we were practically the only bank participating, and these were large transactions. •How will you deploy the rupees raised by swapping the dollars with RBI? Our asset-liability management tools tell us the bucket-wise gaps we can run. Even if we park the funds in G-secs, we have a spread of 75-100 bps. We have announced fixed-rate mortgages starting at 7.5% for the initial three years, addressing buyers' concerns about rising interest rates. Our balance sheet was Rs 4.5 lakh crore at end-March and would have easily crossed Rs 5 lakh crore. Our GIFT City balance sheet would also have increased because some leverage is provided from there. •Will you focus only on affluent customers? Mass affluent is the entry point for acquiring affluent customers. We are doubling down on **wealth** and affluent banking through digital platforms, advisory services and cross-border products spanning LRS, offshore accounts, GIFT City, mortgages and premium cards. Of 20 approved branches, eight have opened, prioritising cities with high mutual fund penetration and NRI diaspora, which has helped FCNR(B) collections. We are also setting up a stockbroking arm. •Has India lost favour among foreign investors? Financial markets are inherently short-term in their thinking. Capital chases whatever is currently selling elsewhere. There is massive debt issuance by US hyperscalers, more than by some sovereigns, while equities in Taiwan and Korea are attracting capital. Currency weakness can create a self-fulfilling negative loop, with investors holding back and weaker inflows keeping the rupee under pressure. Corporate earnings have improved after weakening a couple of years ago, but valuations have not. A spark is needed to shift the narrative, such as lower oil prices, new land or labour reforms or major FDI announcements. •Why has corporate capex been weak? Capex is often viewed through the 2012-14 cycle, when mega projects in power, steel and cement had virtually no genuine promoter equity and were largely bank-financed. With little equity, promoters had less incentive to fight for or stay with projects when conditions deteriorated. We do not want such projects because they involve taxpayer money. Current growth is instead seeing capacity expansion through consolidation, with well-capitalised groups such as Tata, UltraTech and Adani expanding through internal cash flows. •Are you funding acquisitions now that this is allowed? We are the number one bank in acquisition financing. We were the first, and at that time the only bank, to fund the two domestic M&A directly from our local-currency balance sheet. •Are large IPOs crowding out smaller players? The inverse economics of asset markets means more investors enter when prices rise. Successful giant IPOs draw in new retail investors and deeper pools of international institutional capital by demonstrating that India can handle largescale liquidity. Whether an issue performs well on listing depends on whether the issuer has maximised its valuation and pricing.

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Business

Ask what AI can do for you, not what it will do to you: DBS HR chief

Cheong Poh Kwan

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SINGAPORE – When DBS Bank human resources chief Lee Yan Hong reflects on the biggest challenges of her more than three-decade career, artificial intelligence does not make the list.

During the 2008 global financial crisis, she watched the share price of the international bank she was working for then collapse, wondering whether her team would remain intact if the business were to go under.

At DBS during the Covid-19 pandemic, she had to keep thousands of employees safe amid the unprecedented public health crisis.

AI, to her, feels more manageable. It is less of a crisis, and more of a leadership opportunity where she feels “more in control”, Lee told The Straits Times in an exclusive interview.

The challenge, she believes, is changing the narrative around artificial intelligence – from a technology that threatens jobs to one that helps people overcome their limitations.

Just like cars, which were invented to help humans overcome physical limitations and travel faster and farther, AI is an invention that can compensate for cognitive limitations, said the head of group human resources at South-east Asia’s largest bank by assets.

“I cannot read a million pages,” Lee said. “I cannot go to all the websites. I cannot summarise things so fast, and look at all the patterns and synthesise so fast, so AI helps me with that.”

“It’s a cognitive enhancer, and we want to use it to create capacity to drive growth,” she added, her voice spirited as she made the case for AI.

DBS’ current AI momentum builds on a digital transformation journey that started in 2014. Lee said the bank moved quickly to experiment with generative AI in 2023, after ChatGPT became more mainstream.

Rather than waiting for employees to adopt GenAI on their own, Lee said the bank gave them the tools, including its in-house DBS GPT and Microsoft Copilot, and encouraged broad-based use across its 19 markets.

She said what helped drive adoption was a sense of FOMO, or fear of missing out. As employees saw how colleagues were able to write in perfect English and produce better reports, more began experimenting with the tools themselves.

More than 70 per cent of DBS employees now use AI tools, Lee noted with pride. “For my team, if I take away their AI, they will kill me,” she quipped.

At DBS, more than 1.8 million prompts are generated each month across all its markets – and all that AI usage does not come cheap.

Lee said the bank has invested millions of dollars in tech, including AI subscriptions, and sees this as necessary in helping staff do their work better.

If AI can reduce the amount of “toil” employees spend on repetitive work and help them finish their tasks faster, she is happy, for they can go home earlier, recharge and return the next day with better ideas.

AI in human resources

The HR chief herself is also benefitting from AI. For example, performance evaluations for senior executives once involved gathering information from 360-degree surveys, personality assessment reports and other sources of data. The process could take her about eight hours.

Now, AI can produce a first cut in five minutes, she said. The hours saved can then be spent on careful deliberation before she meets the committee to make the final decision.

"I have seven hours to be really thoughtful," she said, adding that AI, paradoxically, "makes hard thinking easier".

One often-cited concern about the use of AI in HR is that applicant tracking systems can reduce resume screening to a game of numbers and keyword-stuffing.

Lee said DBS has to use AI for resume-screening for practical reasons. In India, for example, a single job posting can attract anywhere from 10,000 to 100,000 applications. Without AI, it is impossible to screen all resumes against consistent, skills-based criteria without human bias.

But she said the bank has never outsourced hiring entirely to AI. Candidates still go through psychometric and technical assessments. Interviews remain important for hiring managers to assess chemistry and fit, as well as for candidates to understand the company's values and culture.

When it comes to candidate assessments, DBS allows the use of GenAI for writing and coding tests. But as Lee points out, AI merely raises the baseline for everyone, as people can arrive at similar answers with AI.

To stand out, candidates have to think deeper, read widely, join the dots and propose outstanding solutions. The thinking cannot be outsourced, she said.

Ramping up hiring

For young graduates, the door into DBS has widened in 2026, as it plans to take in more than 500 of them through its management associate (MA), internship and traineeship programmes. It has hired 112 MAs so far in 2026 – more than double the average annual intake in 2024 and 2025.

DBS is also focused on creating roles that will help grow the bank and keep it safe. This means more hiring is expected in areas such as AI, data, **wealth management**, risk management and cybersecurity.

In fact, Lee said the number of new hires in Singapore is up about 10 per cent so far in 2026, compared with the same period in 2025.

If sustained, that uptick could reverse a multi-year drop that saw new hires here fall from 1,833 in 2023 to 1,097 in 2025.

But Lee also emphasised that DBS has had low turnover. In particular, its attrition rate in Singapore is just 2.8 per cent, she said, reducing the need for many replacements.

Lee is also an advocate for internal mobility for those whose existing roles may be affected.

Call centre staff, for instance, can move into relationship management roles, serving **wealth** clients or small and medium-sized enterprises, after acquiring the necessary licences.

For staff who do not want a front-office role or the pressure of meeting sales and profit-and-loss targets, there are also opportunities to move into adjacent support and operational roles in the growing **wealth management** business, Lee said.

That, to her, is the broader point of workforce transformation: using AI to help the bank grow while bringing its existing workforce along with it.

That emphasis on career resilience was reinforced on Aug 24 with the launch of DBS' new career advisory service. More than 100 members of the bank's 500-strong HR team were trained as career advisers, enabling them to guide their colleagues while expanding their job scope.

The bank also signed a memorandum of understanding with the Institute of Banking and Finance to jointly build AI capabilities, support workers' transitions into redesigned roles and strengthen the pipeline of young talent for the financial sector.

For Lee, a crucial part of preparing the workforce for AI is removing the fear surrounding it.

She herself was "super irritated" by jargon such as prompt engineering, which can make AI sound intimidating to the uninitiated.

It is just about asking questions, she said – the better the questions, the better the answers from AI.

"Fear is not a strategy," she added. "If you don't do anything, you will miss this industrial revolution."

Her message to workers is simple: Don't ask what AI will do to you.

Instead, ask: "What is AI doing for me?"

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DBS posts threefold surge in millennials upgrading to Treasures

James Phillipps

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DBS said the number of its millennial retail customers upgrading their accounts to its Treasures **wealth** tier tripled in the first half of the year.

In total, the Singaporean lender saw a 180% year-on-year increase in customers progressing to its introductory **wealth** tier, which requires S\$350,000 (\$276,000) of investible assets, according to a 22 Aug release.

Of the overall number of customers progressing to DBS Treasures, 70% initially had retail accounts. The bank said the combined investment balances of all of the clients upgrading to Treasures in 2025 have since grown 'almost sixfold', without disclosing a figure.

Andrew Bok, head of DBS Treasures Singapore, said: 'More Singaporeans are recognising that building **wealth** cannot wait until later in life. Starting earlier and staying invested over the long run gives them more time and more options.'

DBS last month outlined plans to [double its pace of growth](#) to manage over S\$1tn (\$773bn) in assets by 2030, driven by artificial intelligence and a unified operating model across its retail and **wealth** segments. Stripping out retail assets, the **wealth management** target stands at S\$830bn (\$642bn)

To support this growth, the bank said it will recruit more than 600 additional relationship managers, frontline advisors and platform engineers by the end of 2028. DBS will also open 18 new **wealth** centres and upgrade 36 existing centres across the region by end of the 2027, increasing its DBS Treasures **wealth**-centre footprint in Singapore by 50%.

The private bank currently employs more than 500 relationship managers across Singapore, Hong Kong, Dubai, London and Thailand.

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Standard Chartered's Kendrick Says Bitcoin Has 'Turned The Tide,' Keeps \$500K Target

Anushka Basu

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Geoff Kendrick said he was sticking with Standard Chartered's long-term Bitcoin target which the bank pushed by two years after cutting near-term forecasts.

* Standard Chartered's Geoff Kendrick said this on Saturday that this week had "turned the tide" for Bitcoin.

* He compared it to the March 2023 Silicon Valley Bank collapse that preceded a rally from \$25,000 to above \$100,000.

* Kendrick's call echoed macro investor Jordi Visser, who separately argued Bitcoin was an "anti-decay" hedge.

Standard Chartered's Head of Digital Assets Research Geoffry 'Geoff' Kendrick said Bitcoin (BTC) was "heading back into crypto summer" after a week which he said "turned the tide" for the apex cryptocurrency.

Speaking in a Bloomberg [interview](#) on Saturday, Kendrick compared the moment to the March 2023 collapse of Silicon Valley Bank, which preceded Bitcoin's rally from \$25,000 to above \$100,000. He said that the move came "at a time when everyone hated Bitcoin," and reinforced the cryptocurrency's core use case as a way to store **wealth** outside a system dependent on central authority.

"Whenever you have things like the Silicon Valley Bank example, March 2023, or things like US Treasury or Fed independence type stories coming up, for me that's the turn of the tide," Kendrick said.

[BTC's price](#) was down roughly 1% on Sunday, trading at the \$76,500 level. On Stocktwits, the retail sentiment around BTC remained in the 'extremely bullish' zone, while chatter around it stayed at 'extremely high' levels over the past day.

[BTC retail sentiment on August 23 as of 5:20 a.m. ET | Source: Stocktwits](#)

\$500K Target Stands

Kendrick said he was sticking with his forecasts that were "much higher, medium term." Standard Chartered maintained a [long-term Bitcoin target of \\$500,000](#), pushed from 2028 to 2030 last December, after cutting new projections.

He acknowledged that crypto had been overshadowed by AI-driven excitement and the initial public offering (IPO) season. "There's just been so many other easier things to make money," Kendrick said. "It's pretty exciting, and I would say crypto is back."

Building The Rails

Kendrick's bullish call arrived as Standard Chartered deepens its own crypto infrastructure. On Tuesday, the bank [announced](#) that it had completed the first live cross-border transaction using tokenized deposits on SWIFT's blockchain-based ledger alongside HSBC, a milestone in connecting regulated bank money with distributed ledger technology. The transaction was a part of a broad pilot involving 17 banks across six continents.

Kendrick's view also aligned with a growing chorus of institutional voices calling the bottom this week, with macro investor Jordi Visser separately arguing that Bitcoin was [an anti-decay hedge](#) as AI-driven competition compressed returns across every traditional asset class.

Read also: [Ripple CEO Brad Garlinghouse Calls CFTC's New Crypto Panel An 'Olympic Roster'](#)

For updates and corrections, email [newsroom\[at\]stocktwits\[dot\]com](mailto:newsroom[at]stocktwits[dot]com).

[A general view of the Standard Chartered Bank logo at their head office in Basinghall Avenue on October 14, 2024 in London, United Kingdom. \(Photo by John Keeble/Getty Images\)](#)

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Standard Chartered opens Two Affluent Banking Centres in Gurugram branches

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Key Highlights:

- * Standard Chartered opens two Affluent Banking Centres in Gurugram.
- * Expands total Affluent Banking Centres to 22 within existing branches in India.

Original Press Release:

Gurugram, Aug. 21 -- Standard Chartered PLC issued the following news release:

- Expands total Affluent Banking Centres to 22 within existing branches across India

Standard Chartered today announced the opening of two new Affluent Banking Centres within its existing branches in Gurugram, reinforcing the Bank's commitment to growing its Affluent, **Wealth** and SME businesses in India while deepening relationships across the client continuum.

These centres are part of the existing branches located at Sector 65 and Golf Course Road in Gurugram, further strengthening the Bank's presence in Delhi NCR, a key market for both Affluent and SME Banking.

PD Singh, CEO, India and South Asia, Standard Chartered and Aditya Mandloi, MD & Head, **Wealth** and Retail Banking, India and South Asia, Standard Chartered, inaugurated the two centres, in the presence of other senior colleagues from the Bank.

India is among the key markets for Standard Chartered's **Wealth** & Retail Banking business and is also a significant contributor to the Bank's SME Banking franchise.

These new centres are designed to offer an elevated and differentiated experience for affluent clients bringing together the Bank's **wealth** expertise, local market insights and the strength and reach of its international network to deliver a more holistic proposition.

One more affluent banking centre was opened within the Rajaji Salai branch in Chennai, earlier this week. This takes the Bank's total number of Affluent Banking Centres in India to 22 within existing branches.

Aditya Mandloi, MD & Head, **Wealth** and Retail Banking, India and South Asia, Standard Chartered, said, "Our continued investment in Affluent Banking Centres reflects our commitment to evolving needs and aspirations of our affluent clients. These centres bring together our **wealth** expertise, global network and specialist-led engagement, creating an environment for more meaningful conversations around clients' financial and life goals. We will continue to invest in our network with 8 more Affluent Banking Centres planned this year. Our focus remains on building deeper, long-term relationships and delivering a seamless and differentiated experience to our clients."

Standard Chartered

Standard Chartered Bank has been operating in India with a continuous presence of over 165 years making it one of the oldest foreign banks in the country offering a full range of services across business segments including Corporate and Investment Banking and **Wealth** and Retail Banking. The Bank has an extensive branch network covering major cities. For more information, visit <https://www.sc.bank.in/>

Globally, we are a leading international banking group, with a presence in 55 of the world's most dynamic markets. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong stock exchanges.

[Category: Banking and Financial Services, Asset and **Wealth Management**, Investment Banking, Facility Expansion]

Source: Standard Chartered PLC

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Companies & Markets

DBS expects tokenised finance investment to catch up with traditional payments, custody in 2-3 years

Renald Yeo

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STBT

online

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[SINGAPORE] DBS expects its investment in tokenised finance to catch up with – and potentially overtake – spending on traditional payments and custody within the next two to three years.

This is as the lender positions itself for what it sees as an “inflection point” in digital-asset adoption.

Investment in tokenised finance remains smaller than that for traditional payments and custody today, but its share has risen over the past few years, said Lim Soon Chong, group head of global transaction services at DBS. He did not disclose the current split.

“I expect this to be as large or even bigger in the next two (or) three years,” he told The Business Times in a recent interview.

Rather than commit to a fixed investment amount, DBS intends to scale its spending in tandem with the pace of adoption.

DBS processed about S\$10 billion in tokenised payments cumulatively over the past two years, said Lim, as tokenisation moves from experimentation towards commercial use.

Tokenised finance broadly involves representing money or traditional financial assets as digital tokens on shared digital ledgers, potentially allowing faster settlement, round-the-clock liquidity and programmable transactions.

DBS had deliberately moved more cautiously when it began investing in the space around 2020, Lim said, as the network effects needed for tokenised payments and settlement have yet to emerge.

That is changing as more banks, regulators and institutional investors participate, prompting the lender to step up investment.

“We really see this as an inflection point, and the network effect is going to kick in,” he said.

Much of the bank’s investment is going into new infrastructure and business processes, including security, customer-facing applications and systems that allow tokenised instruments to connect with existing payment rails and other financial intermediaries.

Adoption gathers pace

The push comes even as major cryptocurrency prices have fallen sharply from their peaks.

Lim said crypto prices were becoming a less useful gauge of broader digital-asset adoption, with activity among DBS’ clients continuing to grow.

The number of digital assets under custody at DBS rose about 50 to 70 per cent year on year in 2025, while accredited investors using the bank to invest in digital assets or related products grew at a double-digit pace. Participation among corporate and institutional clients also increased.

Revenue from its digital-assets business trebled in 2025, from around S\$30 million in 2024, although Lim expects it to be lower this year.

That is largely due to falling cryptocurrency prices rather than weaker activity, he said, as digital assets such as Bitcoin and Ethereum still make up a much larger market than tokenised traditional assets and money, leaving revenue exposed to crypto-price movements.

DBS is instead focusing on the longer-term growth of tokenised assets and money.

In the near term, Lim sees more immediate commercial opportunities in investor access to digital assets and tokenised assets, as well as custody and related services, as these businesses are less dependent on multiple institutions adopting the same infrastructure before they can scale.

Tokenised money and payments could bring a more structural change over the longer term, but wider adoption requires common technology standards, acceptance among users and regulatory alignment, particularly for cross-border transactions, he said.

"The argument is not about the 'what' – the argument is about the 'how'," he said, referring to questions over whether stablecoins, tokenised deposits or central bank digital currencies will be used, and how the systems will interoperate.

Building up digital-asset talent

DBS is also adding manpower to support the push, although Lim said specialised talent remains "difficult" to find.

The bank is bringing in employees dedicated to digital assets while also moving and retraining existing staff for the area. It has not set out a specific hiring target, with Lim saying he could not put a number on how many people would ultimately be needed.

He said the challenge is finding employees who understand the technology while also being familiar with banking regulation, compliance and risk management.

Within DBS, a digital-assets task force draws people from markets, global transaction services, coverage, consumer banking and **wealth management**, technology and compliance.

Lim estimated that about 40 to 60 employees are actively working on or engaged with digital assets every day. Including those in areas such as risk management, compliance and finance who are involved either full-time or part-time, the number runs into the hundreds.

"The subject matter and understanding of what the technology does and what kind of change we need is broadening in the organisation," he said.

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HSBC Private Bank Appoints Feras Al Jarmani to Lead UAE Market

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08:00

MarketLine News and Comment

DTMNTR

English

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Feras Al Jarmani has been appointed to lead HSBC Private Bank's UAE market, taking overall responsibility for the bank's private banking business across the country.

HSBC Private Bank today confirmed the appointment of Feras Al Jarmani to lead its UAE Market, taking on overall responsibility for the bank's private banking business across the country. Mr Al Jarmani expands his role from Head of the UAE Market for Arab and Emirati Clients, and his expanded remit brings HSBC's UAE private banking teams under a single leadership as the bank pursues its ambition to become the leading private bank in the Middle East.

The appointment supports HSBC's UAE **wealth** hub strategy and the ambition of its International **Wealth** and Premier Banking (IWPB) business to become the UAE's leading international **wealth** player, serving the full spectrum of clients from affluent individuals to ultra-high-net-worth families and entrepreneurs. The UAE remains a strategically important market for HSBC, attracting more net inflows of millionaires than any other country in the world.

Mr Al Jarmani brings 25 years of financial services experience, including 13 years at HSBC servicing sovereign and corporate clients in the UAE. In his expanded role he will drive closer alignment across HSBC's UAE private banking teams, faster decision-making and a more integrated, consistent client experience, while maintaining clear governance and accountability.

Aladdin Hangari, Head of HSBC Private Bank, MENA, said: "Feras is a highly experienced leader who understands the UAE and the needs of our clients here. Bringing our UAE private banking teams under his leadership sharpens our focus on what matters most: helping clients build, protect and grow their **wealth**. This is an important step as we deliver on our ambition to be the leading private bank in the region."

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Document DTMNTR0020260822em8k0004v



Singapore's Big Three Banks Ride **Wealth** Boom to Records

Roger A. Agana

526 words

20 August 2026

News Ghana

NWGHA

English

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NewsGhana, Latest Updates and Breaking News of Ghana, Roger A. Agana,
<https://newsghana.com.gh/singapores-big-three-banks-ride-wealth-boom-to-records/>

Singapore's three largest banks have gained an average of 44% this year, powered by record **wealth-management** fees that are offsetting the squeeze on lending margins from falling interest rates.

DBS, OCBC and UOB together account for more than half the weight of Singapore's Straits Times Index, so their performance disproportionately shapes the benchmark. Their combined 44% average gain this year has outpaced both regional banking peers and Singapore's broader market, according to RHB's Singapore Research team in an August 18 report.

All three banks beat second-quarter 2026 net profit estimates, helped by sector-wide non-interest income that rose 11% quarter-on-quarter and 28% year-on-year. That growth offset continued pressure on lending profitability: net interest margin, the gap between what banks earn on loans and pay on deposits, fell 5% to 1.78% across the sector as lower rates squeeze traditional banking income.

DBS and OCBC have led both in share-price performance and non-interest income growth. OCBC crossed S\$30 a share for the first time in July, while DBS has traded above S\$75. DBS's **wealth management** income hit a record S\$5.70 billion in its 2025 financial year, up nearly 29% over two years, with **wealth** fees alone reaching a record S\$907 million in the first quarter of 2026. At OCBC, **wealth management** now accounts for roughly 37% of group income, making it a central pillar of the bank's earnings rather than a side business.

UOB has lagged its larger rivals despite posting 10% year-on-year growth in second-quarter net profit. RHB attributed the gap partly to asset-quality concerns and a more downbeat 2026 fee-income outlook the bank flagged at its August briefing. Separate market reporting has pointed to a rising non-performing loan ratio in UOB's Greater China portfolio as a specific factor behind investor caution. UOB is nonetheless pursuing the same fee-based shift as its rivals, targeting a roughly doubling of **wealth** income to S\$2.5 billion by 2030, even as it plays catch-up today.

Singapore's position as a regional **wealth-management** hub underpins the broader trend. RHB said continued net inflows into the city-state are supporting fees from **wealth management** and treasury-related client activity, as Singapore keeps drawing capital from family offices, entrepreneurs and high-net-worth individuals across Asia seeking exposure to regional markets.

The sector's rally reflects investor confidence in the banks' balance sheets and capital strength for now. But RHB and other analysts caution that asset quality could weigh more heavily on earnings if regional economic growth slows, a risk that would test how durable the current **wealth**-driven earnings mix proves to be once the interest-rate cycle stabilises.

NewsGhana, Latest Updates and Breaking News of Ghana, Roger A. Agana,
<https://newsghana.com.gh/singapores-big-three-banks-ride-wealth-boom-to-records/>

Document NWGHA00020260821em8k0000I

Standard Chartered expands hedge fund push as **wealth** clients seek volatility protection

274 words

20 August 2026

Hedge Week

HEDGEW

English

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Standard Chartered is increasing its focus on hedge fund strategies as it encourages **wealth management** clients to diversify portfolios and reduce their exposure to volatile markets, according to a report by Reuters.

The Areport cites Samir Subberwal, StanChart's global head of **wealth** solutions, retail products, data and analytics as saying that the Asia-focused bank is looking to allocate more of clients' assets to alternative strategies as investors increasingly seek returns beyond traditional equities and bonds.

Subberwal said hedge fund products can provide clients with an additional source of relatively stable, uncorrelated returns during periods of market turbulence.

Among the strategies being highlighted by the bank are equity market neutral and multi-strategy funds of hedge funds, which are designed to pursue absolute returns with limited correlation to broader markets.

The push comes amid a strong period for the global hedge fund industry. Hedge funds generated an average return of 7% during the first half of 2026, according to Goldman Sachs, comfortably ahead of their 10-year average of 4.1%.

Industry assets have also expanded sharply. HFR data showed global hedge fund assets under management increased by a record \$409 billion in the second quarter to \$5.6 trillion.

StanChart's greater emphasis on alternatives comes as its **wealth management** business continues to grow rapidly. The bank reported a 38% increase in **wealth** income in the first half of the year, contributing to a stronger-than-expected overall profit.

Investment products recorded particularly strong growth as clients increased inflows and opened more accounts, with market uncertainty driving demand for professional **wealth** advice.

Document HEDGEW0020260820em8k00002

ENTERPRISE

Timah Partners lands S\$60m debt facility; partners include UOB, RHB

Tessa Oh

319 words

20 August 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

print

A18

English

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TIMAH Partners, a holding company for small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), has secured a S\$60 million debt facility to support its acquisition strategy in Singapore.

The Singapore-based company said in a statement on Wednesday (Aug 19) that the debt facility is structured as an “umbrella delayed-drawdown agreement”, which will provide a “pre-negotiated agreement and framework to finance and execute multiple SME acquisitions over time”.

Dennis Chua, founder and CEO of Timah Partners, said: “What founders prefer is clarity, a straightforward and simple process, partners they can trust and are proud to be associated with, and confidence that their business and people will be taken care of.”

Facility partners include UOB, RHB Bank and Genesis Alternative Ventures. Kroll Agency and Trustee Services will act as the facility and security agent.

Timah Partners said it sees the facility “as the start of a broader effort to facilitate SME continuity in Singapore, alongside partners that have long supported local businesses”.

“Over time, Timah expects the relationship with its leading partners to extend beyond acquisitions, into wider financing and banking support across its portfolio, including founder **wealth**-planning needs, as these businesses continue to professionalise and grow.”

Timah Partners announced its first acquisition under a specialised waste management platform in July 2026. The financial terms and identity of the acquired company were not disclosed.

Said Eric Lian, UOB head of group commercial banking: “Our partnership with Timah Partners will catalyse greater resilience, supporting the renewal and sustained growth of strong local enterprises.”

RHB Bank’s head of commercial banking, Serena Hong, said: “We are pleased to support this innovative facility alongside like-minded financing partners, as it will help strengthen the next chapter of growth for high-quality local enterprises and reinforce the long-term resilience of Singapore’s SME ecosystem.”

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Document STBT000020260820em8k00005

TELECOMS

DBS Hong Kong Partners With Visa and Preface to Build AI Readiness for Intelligent Payments

875 words

19 August 2026

08:00

MarketLine News and Comment

DTMNTR

English

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As AI becomes more embedded in how consumers discover, compare and transact, DBS Bank (Hong Kong) announced a partnership with Preface to provide customers with practical AI readiness skills for everyday life and work.

As Artificial Intelligence (AI) becomes increasingly embedded in how consumers discover, compare and transact, DBS Bank (Hong Kong) Limited ("DBS Hong Kong") today announced a partnership with Preface, a leading tech-enablement company, to help customers build practical AI readiness for everyday life and work. The partnership is a natural extension of DBS's ongoing collaboration with Visa, a global digital payment leader, including its participation in Visa's Agentic Ready programme, which helps issuers and ecosystem partners prepare for the next generation of secure, AI-powered commerce. While DBS continues to work with Visa to explore secure, issuer-led payment experiences for AI-enabled transactions, DBS believes customers will also benefit from accessible education courses and AI tools offered by Preface, enabling them to better understand and use AI with confidence.

According to Visa's recent study[1], up to 74% of consumers in Asia Pacific have used AI-powered tools for product searches, price tracking or research. AI is evolving from "offering recommendations" to "proactive execution". Under Agentic Commerce, AI handles the entire shopping journey. In the next phase, AI agents will automate the entire purchase journey under secure authorisation, from searching and comparing prices to executing payments delivering an unprecedented seamless experience while ensuring consumers maintain clear visibility and control. Against this backdrop, DBS's partnership with Preface is designed to complement its payment innovation agenda by equipping customers with the knowledge and practical tools to participate confidently in an AI-enabled future.

As AI agents increasingly participate in consumption and payment flows, DBS believes the card of the future must be both intelligent and trusted. As the first issuer in Asia-Pacific to pilot Visa Intelligent Commerce, DBS has demonstrated through live pilot transactions how AI agents can securely complete everyday payments on behalf of customers using an issuer-led authentication process. This ongoing work with Visa forms the foundation for DBS's Agent Ready roadmap, while the new collaboration with Preface broadens the proposition by helping customers build the AI literacy and hands-on skills needed to benefit from these emerging capabilities.

Visa Agentic Ready programme combines its existing network infrastructure with advanced tokenisation, authentication, and risk controls. This initiative provides issuers with a comprehensive testing framework to safely explore how AI agents execute payments on consumers' behalf. Through DBS's ongoing collaboration with Visa, the bank is exploring how AI agents — backed by user consent and robust safeguards — can automatically identify rewards, search for offers, and complete purchases, establishing a trustworthy environment for consumers.

Emily Ip, Managing Director, Head of Cards and Unsecured Lending, Consumer Banking Group and **Wealth Management** of DBS Bank (Hong Kong) Limited, said: "AI is reshaping how customers live, work and transact. As we continue working with Visa to explore secure Agentic Commerce and make our cards Agent Ready, we also recognize that customers need practical knowledge and tools to take advantage of AI confidently. Our partnership with Preface brings this to life by making AI education more accessible, hands-on and relevant to customers' everyday needs."

Paulina Leong, General Manager of Visa Hong Kong and Macau, said: "Trust is the foundation for unlocking the full potential of agentic commerce at scale. Building that trust requires more than secure technology. It also means helping consumers better understand how AI can assist them while ensuring they remain in control.

Through Visa's trusted global network and payments infrastructure, we are helping to make AI-powered shopping safe, seamless and reliable, enabling a frictionless end-to-end shopping experience. We are proud to partner with DBS Hong Kong on this initiative and look forward to helping shape a future where consumers can embrace AI-powered commerce with confidence."

Through the partnership with Preface, DBS Hong Kong will launch exclusive hands-on AI experience workshops designed to translate complex technology concepts into practical, accessible learning. The workshops will help customers understand how to use AI tools more effectively, from improving prompts and tailoring AI responses to building customised AI assistants for everyday scenarios. During the launch briefing, Preface instructors demonstrated a range of practical AI applications, including prompt engineering, AI assistant design, Computer-using Agents and Agent Orchestrators. These demonstrations showed how AI tools can support learning, productivity and daily task coordination, giving attendees a firsthand view of how rapidly AI is becoming part of daily life and work.

DBS Credit Card Exclusive Offer Details

Starting September 2026, DBS Credit Cardholders subscribing to the designated AI tools, can get a free chance to access an exclusive AI Experience Workshop via the "DBS Credit Cards Subscription Bonus Club". Cardholders can also enjoy up to 15% off when enrolling in Preface AI courses with DBS Credit Card.

Additional privileges will be available later for DBS Visa Credit Cardholders when subscribing to the designated AI tools through the "DBS Credit Cards Subscription Bonus Club", further supporting customers as they explore and adopt AI tools in practical ways.

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Document DTMNTR0020260822em8j0005m

UOB; UOB advances **wealth** ambitions with strategic distribution partnership with Allianz Global Investors

750 words

19 August 2026

Mergers & Acquisitions Week

MAAW

47

English

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2026 AUG 19 (VerticalNews) -- By a News Reporter-Staff News Editor at Mergers & Acquisitions Week -- UOB Group has entered into an agreement for Allianz Global Investors (AGI) to acquire UOB Asset Management (UOBAM). The acquisition by AGI covers the UOBAM franchise across eight Asian markets - Singapore, Brunei, Indonesia, Japan, Malaysia, Taiwan region, Thailand and Vietnam. As part of the agreement, UOB and AGI will establish a long-term strategic distribution partnership that strengthens UOB's role as an open-architecture **wealth** distributor, expands the investment solutions available to customers, and reinforces the Bank's advisory-led approach to helping customers grow and preserve **wealth** over time.

Through the strategic partnership, UOB will work with AGI to curate a broader suite of investment products and solutions for the Bank's regional customer base of more than 8 million. The partnership builds on UOB's open-architecture strategy, enabling the Bank to draw from a wide universe of investment capabilities while remaining focused on advice, suitability and long-term customer outcomes. It also supports UOB's **wealth** growth ambitions by broadening customers' choice and offering diversified solutions aligned with their investment profiles, life stages and financial goals.

Subject to the requisite regulatory approvals in all applicable markets, the deal is expected to be completed in 2027. UOBAM and AGI are committed to ensuring continuity and a smooth transition for all customers and employees. As part of the agreement, all 500 existing UOBAM employees across the region will transition to AGI, which pledges to maintain and continue their employment, while offering employees opportunities to be part of a larger global investment platform. During this transition period, UOBAM's operations will continue as usual. Customers can continue to access, invest in and redeem their UOBAM funds as usual, with no disruption to service.

Excluding one-off transaction costs, the deal, priced at S\$555 million, is expected to generate a pre-tax gain of approximately S\$330 million and increase the Group's CET1 ratio by an estimated 14 basis points. The transaction forms part of the Group's ongoing efforts to execute on its strategic priorities. By crystallising value from its asset management business and retaining strategic collaboration through a long-term partnership, the Group will be better positioned to strengthen its **wealth management** franchise, drive sustainable earnings growth, and enhance long-term shareholder value.

UOBAM, which has been part of the UOB Group for 40 years, has grown into a leading regional asset management franchise with operations across Asia. As of 31 December 2025, it had approximately S\$42 billion assets under management. Based on the unaudited pro forma consolidated balance sheet of UOBAM and its subsidiaries as at 31 December 2025, the net asset value attributable to the stake sold was S\$223 million.

Mr Wee Ee Cheong, Deputy Chairman and Chief Executive Officer, UOB, said, "UOB serves more than 8 million customers across ASEAN, whose **wealth** and investment needs are becoming increasingly diverse and sophisticated. This partnership sharpens our focus on **wealth** advisory and distribution. By combining UOB's advisory expertise and customer relationships with Allianz Global Investors' investment capabilities, we are well positioned to meet our customers' evolving needs and support their long-term **wealth** goals. This also enables us to accelerate **wealth management** growth while enhancing long-term shareholder value. During the transition period, maintaining continuity for customers and employees is our priority. We thank UOBAM's management team and employees for their dedication and contributions over the past four decades in building a trusted regional asset management franchise."

Mr Tobias Pross, CEO, Allianz Global Investors, said, "This transaction marks a significant milestone in Allianz Global Investors' growth journey in Asia Pacific. By bringing together UOB Asset Management's deep Southeast Asian investment expertise with our global active investment platform, we are creating a stronger business with an enhanced ability to serve clients across the region, providing them with access to an even broader range of

innovative **wealth management** and retirement solutions. Importantly, the announcement also establishes a long-term distribution agreement between Allianz Global Investors and UOB, a trusted financial institution serving millions of clients across Southeast Asia. Together, we will deepen and grow that client engagement further, through complementary capabilities and expanded market reach."

Keywords for this news article include: UOB, Finance and Investment, Investment and Finance, Mergers and Acquisitions.

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Document MAAW000020260819em8j0001k

Exclusive: HSBC Private Bank hires senior banker from JPM

Priyanka Boghani

215 words

19 August 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC Private Bank has hired a former JP Morgan ultra-high net worth banker, Citywire Asia can reveal.

Smith Jingkaojai has joined the bank as a senior relationship manager. He reports to Benjamin Wang, HSBC Private Bank's desk head for Thailand.

A spokesperson from the bank confirmed his appointment.

Jingkaojai was at [JP Morgan](#) for just over a year, where he covered the Thailand market. Prior to that, he was at UBS Global **Wealth Management**, where he was a banker for over six years. Jingkaojai has also had stints at BNP Paribas and Morgan Stanley in Hong Kong, as well as various roles in Thailand.

HSBC Private Bank recently [named](#) Tan Lay Hong as its new desk head in Singapore, reporting to Hammad Hashmi, the bank's market head for Singapore, Malaysia and Indonesia.

Its Southeast Asia desk has seen [changes](#), with Yatish Aron most recently leaving to join Bank of Singapore as a team head for the global South Asia unit.

According to the bank's latest earnings [report](#), HSBC's **wealth** fee and income jumped 18% in the first half of the year, with Asia a driving factor. The bank gathered \$64bn in net new money during the period, with \$57bn originating from Asia alone.

Document CWIRAS0020260819em8j00008

Exclusive: Malaysia's HLB makes string of senior appointments

Priyanka Boghani

293 words

19 August 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Hong Leong Bank (HLB) has announced a series of new appointments to bolster its regional **wealth management** unit, according to a memo seen by Citywire Asia.

The bank has hired May Lam as its new regional head of **wealth** commercialisation, performance and segment strategy, to lead cross-functional initiatives. Lam joined from OCBC Bank Malaysia, where she was head of segment management and helped build the OCBC premier private client platform. Lam reports directly to Jeffrey Yap, regional head of **wealth management**.

Joel Brown is the new head of investment research and advisory, responsible for bolstering the firm's regional investment philosophy through high-level macro strategies. He joined from JIA Asset Management, where he was chief investment officer. Brown reports to George Lam, the bank's head of investments and **wealth** products.

Former OCBC Malaysia private client team banker Shirley Ong has joined as desk head for HLB Private Bank Malaysia. She will spearhead the bank's onshore private banking business, scaling its UHNW client portfolio. Ong reports to Choon Wei, the bank's head of **wealth** Malaysia, RWM.

In addition, the bank has promoted Zizane Yong to expand her mandate to head of customer experience. All service relationship managers will report to her, while Yong continues to report to Wei.

The announcements were made in an internal memo sent by Yap.

The bank is rapidly scaling its private banking presence in Singapore, having more than [doubled](#) its RM headcount in less than a year.

Most recently, it launched two private market funds with Malaysian investment manager Gaia Investment Partners.

Yap aims to triple the size of HLB's private bank in Malaysia and Singapore, where combined AUM stood at about \$15bn.

Document CWIRAS0020260819em8j00005

StanChart PB hires team head from BOS, two RMs join

Priyanka Boghani

291 words

19 August 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Standard Chartered Private Bank is bulking up its Greater China team, hiring a senior banker from Bank of Singapore, along with two relationship managers from the industry, Citywire Asia can reveal.

Koo Kin Keong is joining the British lender as team head, reporting to Hu Hong, the bank's recently appointed group market head for Greater China. Iris Fang and He Fang Fang have also joined StanChart, under Hu's team.

Standard Chartered confirmed the hires.

Koo was at Bank of Singapore earlier as a team leader for Greater China for over four years. Prior to that, Koo worked at Credit Suisse for almost a decade in various positions in Singapore.

Fang joined StanChart from Julius Baer, where she worked for almost four years. Prior to that, she worked at Citibank, based in China.

He Fang Fang used to work at UOB Private Bank for two years before taking on the role as RM at Standard Chartered. Prior to that, He worked in various positions in China, including at China Merchant Bank and Chian Guangfu Bank, based in Shanghai.

The hires come after Hu was [appointed](#) group market head at the start of this year, with the focus of building a new Greater China team.

In March, the bank [hired](#) two bankers, Jit Chong Soh and Derick Tan, as relationship managers from UBS Global **Wealth Management** and Bank of Singapore respectively.

StanChart [grew](#) net new money by 15% to \$33bn in the first half. Total **wealth** AUM at the bank reached \$258bn, or \$473bn when including customer deposits. The bank hit \$84bn in affluent net new money over the last six quarters, of which two-thirds come from international clients.

Document CWIRAS0020260819em8j00003

DBS scales agentic AI to transform way of working for corporate bankers, freeing up time for more strategic client engagements

Distributed by Contify.com

868 words

19 August 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * DBS rolls out AI solution for 1,500 bankers to automate 70+ credit memo tasks.
- * AI generates review-ready first draft, freeing up time for strategic client engagements.
- * Pilot with 150 users successful, aiming to reduce time spent by at least 30%.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Aug. 19 -- DBS Bank Ltd issued the following news release:

- Agents tackle over 70 tasks to prepare a review-grade first draft of credit memo while bankers and credit risk managers deepen the assessment
- Innovative solution is now rolled out to some 1,500 bankers globally, following a successful pilot with 150 users

DBS today announced the rollout of an agentic AI solution to transform how its relationship managers and credit risk managers prepare complex credit assessments for large and mid-sized corporate clients. Powered by specialised agents tackling more than 70 different tasks, the innovative solution synthesises raw data into a review-ready first draft of a credit memo. This enables faster credit memo generation and more robust risk analysis, freeing up time for relationship managers to focus on more strategic engagements with clients.

After an initial pilot phase involving 150 participants, the capability has been rolled out to approximately 1,500 employees globally.

Reimagining corporate banking with agentic AI

Credit assessments are essential part of the due diligence process, helping banks evaluate a company's financial health, business prospects and risk profile before extending financing. They are also time-consuming and labour-intensive, requiring deeper research and detailed analysis.

For relationship managers, preparing credit memos and related credit activities can account for up to 40% of their time, requiring them to sift through vast amounts of structured and unstructured information from sources such as annual reports, industry research and internal records. The goal is to reduce time spent by at least 30%.

The solution allows relationship managers and credit risk managers to iterate with the agent to sharpen the review-ready first draft into the final credit memo with deeper research by the agents and incorporate industry expertise, client knowledge and business context of the team. This will free up time for relationship managers to focus on strategic client conversations, and for credit risk managers to focus more deeply on portfolio strategy, risk calibration and emerging risks.

Han Kwee Juan, Group Head of Institutional Banking, DBS said: "We believe that agentic AI can help to reimagine corporate banking. Through this capability, we have been able to capture the knowledge and insight of our best relationship managers and credit risk managers, turning these into a solution which enables us to level up the quality of our credit analysis at scale. This in turn helps our relationship managers to pivot their time and focus on partnering with our clients to drive growth for their business and for our credit risk managers to proactively manage risks."

This solution is part of DBS' broader ambition to become an AI-enabled bank with a heart, where human expertise is amplified through AI and enables employees to focus on what matters most. It also builds on the bank's wider effort to embed agentic AI across customer and employee journeys. Last month, DBS announced agentic AI enhancements to its virtual assistants, DBS Joy and DBS digibot, which will serve some 10 million customers across Singapore, Hong Kong and Taiwan.

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named "World's Best AI Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Digital Bank" by Euromoney and the winner of multiple digital assets awards. In addition, DBS has been accorded the "Safest Bank in Asia" award by Global Finance for 17 consecutive years from 2009 to 2025.

DBS provides a full range of services in consumer, **Wealth**, SME and corporate banking. As a bank born and bred in Asia, DBS understands the intricacies of doing business in the region's most dynamic markets.

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by uplifting lives and livelihoods of those in need. It provides essential needs to the underprivileged, and fosters inclusion by equipping the underserved with financial and digital literacy skills. It also nurtures innovative social enterprises that create positive impact.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

[Category: Investment Banking, New Offerings, Artificial Intelligence, Innovation]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd

Document ATINBK0020260819em8j000b6

Wealth

The next chapter for Singapore's banks: From resilience to growth

1,006 words

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Business Times Singapore

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English

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Singapore's three local banks delivered a strong first half, with DBS and OCBC posting record net profit of respectively, S\$6.01 billion and S\$4.19 billion, up 5 per cent and 13 per cent. UOB's net profit rose 3 per cent to S\$2.92 billion.

But the headline numbers do not tell the full story. DBS and OCBC saw stronger growth across their core businesses, with higher fee and other non-interest income helping to offset the impact of lower interest rates on lending income.

In contrast, UOB's profit growth was less reflective of underlying business momentum. Its total income fell 1 per cent, while profit growth was supported by lower provisions, higher contributions from associates and gains from asset sales.

The rate tide is turning

Interest rates have been a major headwind for banks over the past year. As rates fell through 2025, the gap between what banks earn on loans and pay on deposits narrowed, weighing on net interest income. Across DBS, OCBC and UOB, net interest income fell by around 3 per cent year on year in the first half, while net interest margins declined by 18 to 25 basis points.

That pressure, however, appears to be easing. Singapore's benchmark three-month compounded Singapore Overnight Rate Average (Sora) fell from above 3 per cent in early 2025 to around 1.1 per cent, but has since risen for three consecutive months to about 1.15 per cent at end-July.

Meanwhile, the US Federal Reserve's latest dot plot points to fewer rate cuts than previously expected. Together, these developments suggest that downward pressure on domestic interest rates may be diminishing.

The shift is already starting to show in the banks' results. Net interest income rose 2 per cent quarter on quarter at both DBS and OCBC, as loan growth more than offset the remaining pressure on margins. This marked a notable reversal after several quarters of pressure.

With margins appearing close to a floor – DBS and OCBC guiding for only a modest full-year decline in net interest income, while UOB's margin guidance of 1.75 to 1.8 per cent also points to limited further downside – a firmer Sora could provide some upside to current expectations.

Wealth is the structural engine – and scale decides who captures it

The more durable growth story is the shift towards fee income, particularly **wealth management**.

Singapore's growing role as a global **wealth** hub provides a strong structural tailwind, with continued geopolitical uncertainty encouraging more **wealth** to be placed in the city-state.

The benefits are already visible. DBS grew **wealth** fees 33 per cent to a record S\$1.83 billion, with **wealth** assets under management surpassing S\$500 billion. OCBC's **wealth** income rose 27 per cent to S\$3.29 billion, now accounting for 41 per cent of total income, with banking **wealth** assets reaching a record S\$350 billion.

Both have large private-banking businesses and are well-positioned to capture Singapore's growing **wealth** inflows.

UOB's **wealth** income grew 16 per cent, but from a smaller base, while overall fee income fell 2 per cent as weaker loan-related and investment-banking fees offset record **wealth** fees. Management consequently lowered its full-year fee-income guidance.

All three banks are investing to strengthen their **wealth** franchises. DBS is using generative artificial intelligence in its digiWealth platform and targeting S\$1 trillion in **wealth** assets by 2030.

OCBC plans to invest more than S\$1 billion a year in AI and data, add 600 relationship managers and expand its Asean footprint through the planned acquisition of HSBC's affluent-banking business in Indonesia.

Meanwhile, UOB is moving towards an advisory-led model with a broader range of third-party products following the agreed sale of its fund-management business to Allianz Global Investors.

UOB's Greater China property exposure warrants attention

Overall, asset quality remained sound across the three banks, with non-performing loan (NPL) ratios broadly stable and credit costs within guidance.

The main area to watch is UOB's exposure to Greater China property. UOB's NPL ratio for Greater China property rose sharply to 4.8 per cent from 3.5 per cent in just one quarter, while the level of provisions set aside against these loans fell to 42 per cent from 57 per cent.

The deterioration followed the downgrade of a large real-estate borrower, although a release of general provisions helped cushion the impact on reported credit costs.

For now, the issue remains contained. Greater China represents a relatively small part of UOB's overall loan book and has not materially affected group earnings.

Still, it highlights that the regional property cycle has yet to fully recover.

OCBC and UOB have also guided for second-half credit costs to be slightly higher than their first-half run-rates, suggesting some caution remains warranted.

What it means for investors

The sector is in a better place than a year earlier, with earnings growing, rate pressures easing and **wealth management** becoming a stronger growth engine.

The main constraint is valuation: All three banks now trade above their long-term historical averages after a strong rerating in 2026.

This leaves less room for further valuation gains, putting greater emphasis on dividends and sustained earnings growth. DBS and OCBC remain ahead of UOB on earnings momentum and quality, with DBS standing out for its sector-leading 17.5 per cent return on equity and more attractive dividend yield.

The worst of the rate adjustment may be behind Singapore's banks.

The next phase will be about turning stronger **wealth** franchises and a more supportive rate environment into sustained earnings growth, while dividends provide a steady return along the way.

The writer is a research analyst with the research and portfolio management team at FSM Global, the B2C division of iFast Financial, which is the Singapore subsidiary of iFast

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Wealth

The best time to buy bank shares

882 words

19 August 2026

Business Times Singapore

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English

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IF I had a dollar every time someone asks me if bank shares are a buy, I could be a very rich man.

For some context, two decades ago, DBS shares were changing hands at around S\$14 a pop. Four years later, they had dropped to around S\$7 a share.

It would seem that the great financial crisis of 2008 took no prisoners. It did not really matter which bank you were invested in. If you were a bank, you got hammered badly.

I can still remember a UK television chat show that I took part in at the time.

I was thrown into the deep end with an elderly private investor who had invested heavily in banks because he had thought that they would be safe. He claimed that he held a diversified portfolio. But it was a diversified portfolio that comprised only bank shares.

And therein lies the problem. There is nothing intrinsically wrong with investing in banks. But bank shares should be part of a diversified portfolio that comprises other counters, too.

What's more, a heavy weighting of banks within a portfolio could be considered unnecessarily risky.

How have banks performed

Let's look at how banks have performed in the aftermath of the great financial crisis. In a word, pedestrian.

DBS' shares did recover. The shares climbed from a low of S\$6.72 to S\$18 in 2015. In other words, they more than doubled, which would have delighted investors who had been brave enough at the time to take the plunge.

The shares then fluctuated between a high of S\$27 and a low of around S\$17, until the Covid pandemic took its toll on many risk assets.

Following the pandemic, shares in Singapore's largest bank climbed almost exponentially.

DBS shares are now around S\$75. They have even been within touching distance of S\$80. But it has been a roller-coaster ride since 2005.

With bank shares now at or near their all-time highs, it is fair to ask how much higher they can possibly rise.

For many investors who already own bank shares, it is not unreasonable to assume that their portfolios could be somewhat skewed in the direction of financials.

Those who don't have any exposure to bank shares could feel that they might have missed out on the thrilling journey. They could hold the key.

Wall of worry

Point is, bank shares could continue to rise until the last remaining sceptic has bought into the lenders.

When there are no more buyers available, then we can conclude that bank shares might have peaked. That is not to say that they have reached a top, forever. Provided banks can continue to deliver rising profit and rising dividends, then they could continue to be a good long-term investment.

As long as there are still investors who worry if they should be buying bank shares, then it could mean that there is still a pool of sceptics that remain to be converted.

So, bank shares could continue to rise until the wall of worry has been conquered or if their ability to generate higher profits starts to deteriorate.

The best time to buy

But that still doesn't address the question of when to buy bank shares. Probably the best time to buy banks is when their market value is below their net asset value. It doesn't happen often. But when it does, it could indicate that their shares are undervalued.

In the case of DBS, it happened around the time when the dotcom bubble burst. It happened again in 2008 during the great financial crisis.

Today, DBS shares are valued at about 2.3 times its book value.

Another good indicator could be the price-to-earnings (PE) ratio. It is a measure of how much we are paying for every dollar of profit that a bank makes.

When bank shares are trading at below 10 times earnings, then it could indicate that they are ostensibly cheap.

In the case of DBS, it has only happened a handful of times in the last 20 years. During the great financial crisis, we could buy DBS shares at around seven times earnings. Today, we are paying S\$18 for every dollar of profit that the bank makes.

We need to bear in mind that the price of a share is made up of the product of the PE ratio and earnings per share. The first reflects market sentiment. The second is how a bank performs.

Over the last few years, the share prices of banks have been driven by a combination of a rising PE ratio and rising earnings. This combination can be a strong driver of share prices.

At a PE ratio of 18, we could conclude that the valuation of banks is looking stretched. But provided banks can continue to deliver higher profits in the future, it is possible that their share prices could continue to be underpinned by earnings growth.

But as to what might happen to the PE ratio is anyone's guess. It does not take much to put a dent into market sentiment.

The writer is co-founder of The Smart Investor

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BANKING & FINANCE

UOB names Tan Choon Hin to new Asean, Greater China role

Renald Yeo

452 words

19 August 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

print

A12

English

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UOB has appointed Tan Choon Hin as its head of Asean and Greater China, a new senior role aimed at driving growth from increasing cross-border flows between the two regions.

Tan, currently the bank's deputy chief risk officer, will take on the role on Sep 1, UOB said on Tuesday (Aug 18).

He will oversee UOB's regional businesses across seven markets, including its subsidiaries in Malaysia, Indonesia, Thailand, Vietnam and mainland China, as well as its branches in Hong Kong and Taiwan.

Working with the respective country chief executives and management teams, Tan will be tasked with strengthening collaboration across the lender's regional businesses and accelerating cross-border and revenue opportunities, UOB said.

The appointment comes as UOB seeks to deepen connectivity between its Asean and Greater China franchises amid growing trade, investment and **wealth** flows, as well as continued supply-chain shifts into South-east Asia.

Tan will also oversee UOB's foreign direct investment (FDI) advisory unit, which helps companies expand across borders by connecting them with ecosystem partners and industry networks.

The unit has supported more than 300 cross-border expansion plans over the past six months, representing S\$5.6 billion in projected investments, UOB noted.

FDI into Asean has more than doubled over the past decade, even as global FDI declined by around 20 per cent over the same period, it added.

UOB CEO Wee Ee Cheong said Asean is "at the heart" of the bank's growth strategy and is becoming an increasingly important global economic hub.

"As trade, investment and **wealth** flows between Asean and Greater China deepen, new opportunities are emerging across the region," he noted.

"This new role reinforces our commitment to capturing these opportunities for customers and supporting them in their cross-border growth."

Tan will report directly to Wee and become a member of the bank's management executive committee.

He has more than 30 years of experience across banking, credit and risk management in Asean and Greater China.

Tan joined UOB in 2012 as head of group credit for retail, before becoming head of group business banking. He was appointed chief executive of UOB Thailand in 2016.

During his tenure, UOB Thailand grew to become the second-largest foreign bank in the country and one of its top-three card issuers, the lender said. Tan also worked on facilitating FDIs into Thailand and helping regional clients enter new markets.

He returned to Singapore in 2024 as deputy chief risk officer, where he has been responsible for strengthening the bank's risk management approach, governance and risk culture.

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Document STBT000020260819em8j00004

The Official Board

Standard Chartered Nepal - The organizational chart displays its 16 executives, including Gorakh Rana and Janak Sharma Poudyal

351 words

18 August 2026

The Official Board

OFBOAR

English

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In the Banking industry, there are 5,585 large companies in 188 countries, with a total of 104,325 top executives. Within those companies, 43,471 executive movements have been recorded in the last 12 months.

Company: Standard Chartered Nepal

URL: www.standardchartered.com/np

Industry: Banking

Standard Chartered Nepal is a subsidiary of Standard Chartered Asia.

Name: Gorakh Rana

Title: Chief Executive Officer and Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/gorakh-rana-71eg1>

Name: Janak Sharma Poudyal

Title: Independent Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/janak-sharma-poudyal-157e5>

Name: Vidya Kumar

Title: Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/vidya-kumar-d48d4>

Name: Avinash Agrawal

Title: Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/avinash-agrawal-239d5>

Name: Venugopal Ranganathan

Title: Chairman of the Board

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/venugopal-ranganathan-d34e7>

Name: Michael Siddhi

Title: Head, Transaction Banking

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/michael-siddhi-d5d92>

Name: Kabir Tamrakar

Title: Head of Audit

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/kabir-tamrakar-95e15>

Name: Rajan Udas

Title: Head of Human Resources

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Name: Alina Shrestha

Title: Head, Corporate Affairs, Brand and Marketing

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/alina-shrestha-70e28>

Name: Sarbendra Mishra

Title: Deputy Chief Executive Officer and Head, Treasury Markets

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/sarbendra-mishra-9687g>

Name: Mohamed Yasir Arafin

Title: Chief Financial Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/mohamed-yasir-arafin-0930g>

Name: Yemi Karki

Title: Senior Manager, Credit

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/yemi-karki-eg014>

Name: Sanjay Pant

Title: Chief Compliance Officer and Chief Risk Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/sanjay-pant-e1524>

Name: Arnab Roy Choudhury

Title: Head of **Wealth** and Retail Banking

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/arnab-roy-choudhury-d2964>

Name: Gopi Bhandari

Title: Company Secretary

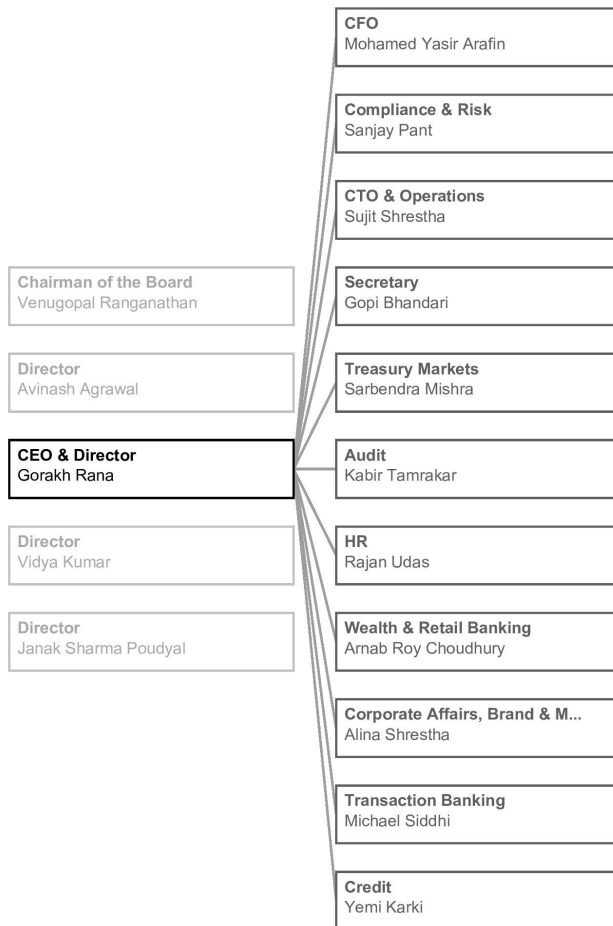
Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/gopi-bhandari-d2de1>

Name: Sujit Shrestha

Title: Chief Technology and Operations Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/sujit-shrestha-d0e90>

Organizational Chart Standard Chartered Nepal



The Official Board as of Aug 24, 2026 5:03:25 AM - Know more at contact@theofficialboard.com

Opinion & Features

The next chapter for Singapore's banks: From resilience to growth

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A record first half – but not all the growth was equal

Singapore's three local banks delivered a strong first half, with DBS and OCBC posting record net profit of respectively S\$6.01 billion and S\$4.19 billion, up 5 per cent and 13 per cent. UOB's net profit rose 3 per cent to S\$2.92 billion.

But the headline numbers do not tell the full story. DBS and OCBC saw stronger growth across their core businesses, with higher fee and other non-interest income helping to offset the impact of lower interest rates on lending income.

In contrast, UOB's profit growth was less reflective of underlying business momentum. Its total income fell 1 per cent, while profit growth was supported by lower provisions, higher contributions from associates and gains from asset sales.

The rate tide is turning

Interest rates have been a major headwind for banks over the past year. As rates fell through 2025, the gap between what banks earn on loans and pay on deposits narrowed, weighing on net interest income. Across DBS, OCBC and UOB, net interest income fell by around 3 per cent year on year in the first half, while net interest margins declined by 18 to 25 basis points.

That pressure, however, appears to be easing. Singapore's benchmark three-month compounded Singapore Overnight Rate Average (Sora) fell from above 3 per cent in early 2025 to around 1.1 per cent, but has since risen for three consecutive months to about 1.15 per cent at end-July.

Meanwhile, the US Federal Reserve's latest dot plot points to fewer rate cuts than previously expected. Together, these developments suggest that downward pressure on domestic interest rates may be diminishing.

The shift is already starting to show in the banks' results. Net interest income rose 2 per cent quarter on quarter at both DBS and OCBC, as loan growth more than offset the remaining pressure on margins. This marked a notable reversal after several quarters of pressure.

With margins appearing close to a floor – DBS and OCBC guiding for only a modest full-year decline in net interest income, while UOB's margin guidance of 1.75 to 1.8 per cent also points to limited further downside – a firmer Sora could provide some upside to current expectations.

Wealth is the structural engine – and scale decides who captures it

The more durable growth story is the shift towards fee income, particularly **wealth management**.

Singapore's growing role as a global **wealth** hub provides a strong structural tailwind, with continued geopolitical uncertainty encouraging more **wealth** to be placed in the city-state.

The benefits are already visible. DBS grew **wealth** fees 33 per cent to a record S\$1.83 billion, with **wealth** assets under management surpassing S\$500 billion. OCBC's **wealth** income rose 27 per cent to S\$3.29 billion, now accounting for 41 per cent of total income, with banking **wealth** assets reaching a record S\$350 billion.

Both have large private-banking businesses and are well-positioned to capture Singapore's growing **wealth** inflows.

UOB's **wealth** income grew 16 per cent, but from a smaller base, while overall fee income fell 2 per cent as weaker loan-related and investment-banking fees offset record **wealth** fees. Management consequently lowered its full-year fee-income guidance.

All three banks are investing to strengthen their **wealth** franchises. DBS is using generative artificial intelligence in its digiWealth platform and targeting S\$1 trillion in **wealth** assets by 2030.

OCBC plans to invest more than S\$1 billion a year in AI and data, add 600 relationship managers and expand its Asean footprint through the planned acquisition of HSBC's affluent-banking business in Indonesia.

Meanwhile, UOB is moving towards an advisory-led model with a broader range of third-party products following the agreed sale of its fund-management business to Allianz Global Investors.

UOB's Greater China property exposure warrants attention

Overall, asset quality remained sound across the three banks, with non-performing loan (NPL) ratios broadly stable and credit costs within guidance.

The main area to watch is UOB's exposure to Greater China property. UOB's NPL ratio for Greater China property rose sharply to 4.8 per cent from 3.5 per cent in just one quarter, while the level of provisions set aside against these loans fell to 42 per cent from 57 per cent.

The deterioration followed the downgrade of a large real-estate borrower, although a release of general provisions helped cushion the impact on reported credit costs.

For now, the issue remains contained. Greater China represents a relatively small part of UOB's overall loan book and has not materially affected group earnings. Still, it highlights that the regional property cycle has yet to fully recover.

OCBC and UOB have also guided for second-half credit costs to be slightly higher than their first-half run-rates, suggesting some caution remains warranted.

What it means for investors

The sector is in a better place than a year earlier, with earnings growing, rate pressures easing and **wealth management** becoming a stronger growth engine.

The main constraint is valuation: All three banks now trade above their long-term historical averages after a strong rerating in 2026.

This leaves less room for further valuation gains, putting greater emphasis on dividends and sustained earnings growth. DBS and OCBC remain ahead of UOB on earnings momentum and quality, with DBS standing out for its sector-leading 17.5 per cent return on equity and more attractive dividend yield.

The worst of the rate adjustment may be behind Singapore's banks. The next phase will be about turning stronger **wealth** franchises and a more supportive rate environment into sustained earnings growth, while dividends provide a steady return along the way.

The writer is a research analyst with the research and portfolio management team at FSM Global, the B2C division of iFast Financial, which is the Singapore subsidiary of iFast

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Companies & Markets

UOB names Tan Choon Hin to new Asean, Greater China role

Renald Yeo

454 words

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English

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[SINGAPORE] UOB has appointed Tan Choon Hin as its head of Asean and Greater China, a new senior role aimed at driving growth from increasing cross-border flows between the two regions.

Tan, currently the bank's deputy chief risk officer, will take on the role from Sep 1, UOB said on Tuesday (Aug 18).

He will oversee UOB's regional businesses across seven markets, including its subsidiaries in Malaysia, Indonesia, Thailand, Vietnam and mainland China, as well as its branches in Hong Kong and Taiwan.

Working with the respective country chief executives and management teams, Tan will be tasked with strengthening collaboration across the lender's regional businesses and accelerating cross-border and revenue opportunities, UOB said.

The appointment comes as UOB seeks to deepen connectivity between its Asean and Greater China franchises amid growing trade, investment and **wealth** flows, as well as continued supply-chain shifts into South-east Asia.

Tan will also oversee UOB's foreign direct investment (FDI) advisory unit, which helps companies expand across borders by connecting them with ecosystem partners and industry networks.

The unit has supported more than 300 cross-border expansion plans over the past six months, representing S\$5.6 billion in projected investments, UOB said.

FDI into Asean has more than doubled over the past decade, even as global FDI declined by around 20 per cent over the same period, it added.

UOB CEO Wee Ee Cheong said Asean was "at the heart" of the bank's growth strategy and was becoming an increasingly important global economic hub.

"As trade, investment and **wealth** flows between Asean and Greater China deepen, new opportunities are emerging across the region," he said.

"This new role reinforces our commitment to capturing these opportunities for customers and supporting them in their cross-border growth."

Tan will report directly to Wee and become a member of the bank's management executive committee.

He has more than 30 years of experience across banking, credit and risk management in Asean and Greater China.

Tan joined UOB in 2012 as head of group credit for retail, before becoming head of group business banking. He was appointed chief executive of UOB Thailand in 2016.

During his tenure, UOB Thailand grew to become the second-largest foreign bank in the country and one of its top three card issuers, the lender said. Tan also worked on facilitating foreign direct investments into Thailand and helping regional clients enter new markets.

He returned to Singapore in 2024 as deputy chief risk officer, where he was responsible for strengthening the bank's risk management approach, governance and risk culture.

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The Official Board

DBS Bank - The organizational chart displays its 48 executives, including Su Shan Tan and Bonghan Cho

1,014 words

17 August 2026

The Official Board

OFBOAR

English

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In the Banking industry, there are 5,585 large companies in 188 countries, with a total of 104,325 top executives. Within those companies, 43,471 executive movements have been recorded in the last 12 months.

Company: DBS Bank

URL: www.dbs.com

Industry: Banking

DBS Bank has 10 subsidairies, including DBS Singapore and DBS Bank Hong Kong.

Name: Su Shan Tan

Title: Chief Executive Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/su-shan-tan-e5d98>

Name: Anthony Lim

Title: Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/anthony-lim-d39d1>

Name: Kai Fong Chng

Title: Non-Executive Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/kai-fong-chng-78dg4>

Name: Tham Sai Choy

Title: Independent Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/tham-sai-choy-125g2>

Name: Lim Huat Seah

Title: Chairman of the Board

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/lim-huat-seah-09g21>

Name: Tse Ghow Lim

Title: Lead Independent Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/tse-ghow-lim-7g631>

Name: Judy Lee

Title: Non-Executive and Independent Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/judy-lee-795g9>

Name: Bonghan Cho

Title: Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/bonghan-cho-e8938>

Name: Punita Lal

Title: Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/punita-lal-654d5>

Name: Hing Yuen Ho

Title: Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/hing-yuen-ho-092e4>

Name: Jonathan Larsen

Title: Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/jonathan-larsen-d6852>

Name: Yuxiang Huang

Title: Chief Information Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/yuxiang-huang-7314d>

Name: Yan Hong Lee

Title: Group Human Resources Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/yan-hong-lee-eg37g>

Name: Ze Ling Chen

Title: Group Head of Corporate and Small and Medium Enterprise Banking

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/ze-ling-chen-9g162>

Name: Tse Koon Shee

Title: Head of Consumer Banking and **Wealth Management**

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/tse-koon-shee-g5645>

Name: Kwee Juan Han

Title: Group Executive and Group Head of Institutional Banking

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/kwee-juan-han-90edg>

Name: Kian Tiong Soh

Title: Chief Risk Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/kian-tiong-soh-278ge>

Name: Derrick Goh

Title: Group Chief Operating Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/derrick-goh-e3d63>

Name: Andrew Ng

Title: Global Financial Markets Group Executive

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/andrew-ng-g1d01>

Name: Soon Chong Lim

Title: Global Head of Transactions Services

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/soon-chong-lim-14e14>

Name: Lam Chee Kin

Title: Managing Director and Head of Legal, Compliance and Secretariat

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/lam-chee-kin-96e16>

Name: Sok Hui Chng

Title: Chief Financial Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/sok-hui-chng-718e2>

Name: Kar Siong Koh

Title: Group Head of Audit

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/kar-siong-koh-d4ed0>

Name: Ginger Cheng

Title: Chief Executive Officer, China

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/ginger-cheng-g8d28>

Name: Lim Soon Chong

Title: Group Head of Digital for Institutional Banking and Group Head of Global Transaction Services Product Management

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/lim-soon-chong-d2712>

Name: Philip Fernandez

Title: Managing Director, Corporate Treasury

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/philip-fernandez-d2d5g>

Name: Michelle Lin

Title: Chief Operating Officer, Transformation Group

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/michelle-lin-25eg2>

Name: Chee Kin Lam

Title: Managing Director and Head Group Legal, Compliance and Secretariat

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/chee-kin-lam-d5795>

Name: Sanjoy Sen

Title: Managing Director, Group Head of Consumer Franchise and Distribution, Consumer Banking and **Wealth** Group

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/sanjoy-sen-g5478>

Name: Rajat Verma

Title: Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer, India

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/rajat-verma-790g6>

Name: Tahsina Banu

Title: Chief Representative of Bangladesh

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/tahsina-banu-d4g74>

Name: Jitendra Tekchandani

Title: Executive Director, **Wealth Management** Platform & Solutions

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/jitendra-tekchandani-d4g74>

Name: Edwin Tan

Title: Market Head for Southeast Asia

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/edwin-tan-92g72>

Name: Tak Lap Leung

Title: Managing Director, Group Head of Treasury and Markets Advisory Sales

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/tak-lap-leung-52g47>

Name: Prakash Jaiswal

Title: Managing Director and India Head of Small and Medium Enterprises Banking

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/prakash-jaiswal-38g18>

Name: Raof Latiff

Title: Chief Executive Officer, Vietnam

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/raof-latiff-g9d69>

Name: Him Chuan Lim

Title: Managing Director, Singapore

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/him-chuan-lim-386g1>

Name: Sier Han Ng

Title: Chief Executive Officer of Taiwan (becomes Chief Executive Officer of Hong Kong on Mar 1 2027)

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/sier-han-ng-4d91d>

Name: Shilpa Gulrajani

Title: Managing Director, Sustainable Finance

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/shilpa-gulrajani-80g6d>

Name: Macy Chow

Title: Assistant Vice President, Global Transaction Services

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/macy-chow-20d60>

Name: Welson Jamin

Title: Managing Director, Group Head of Operations

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/welson-jamin-d6740>

Name: Carlos Vazquez

Title: Managing Director, Group Head, Product Management, Consumer Banking

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/carlos-vazquez-806g8>

Name: Kelvin Wong

Title: Chief Sustainability Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/kelvin-wong-ge0d6>

Name: Niraj Mittal

Title: Country Head of Australia

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/niraj-mittal-216e9>

Name: Louis Foo

Title: Managing Director, Head of Digital Banking Singapore, Consumer Banking Group

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/louis-foo-7e82e>

Name: Chu Chong Lim

Title: President, Indonesia (becomes President, Taiwan on Jan 1 2027)

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/chu-chong-lim-5d51d>

Name: Sebastian Paredes

Title: Chief Executive Officer, DBS Hong Kong and Head of North Asia (retiring on Mar 1 2027)

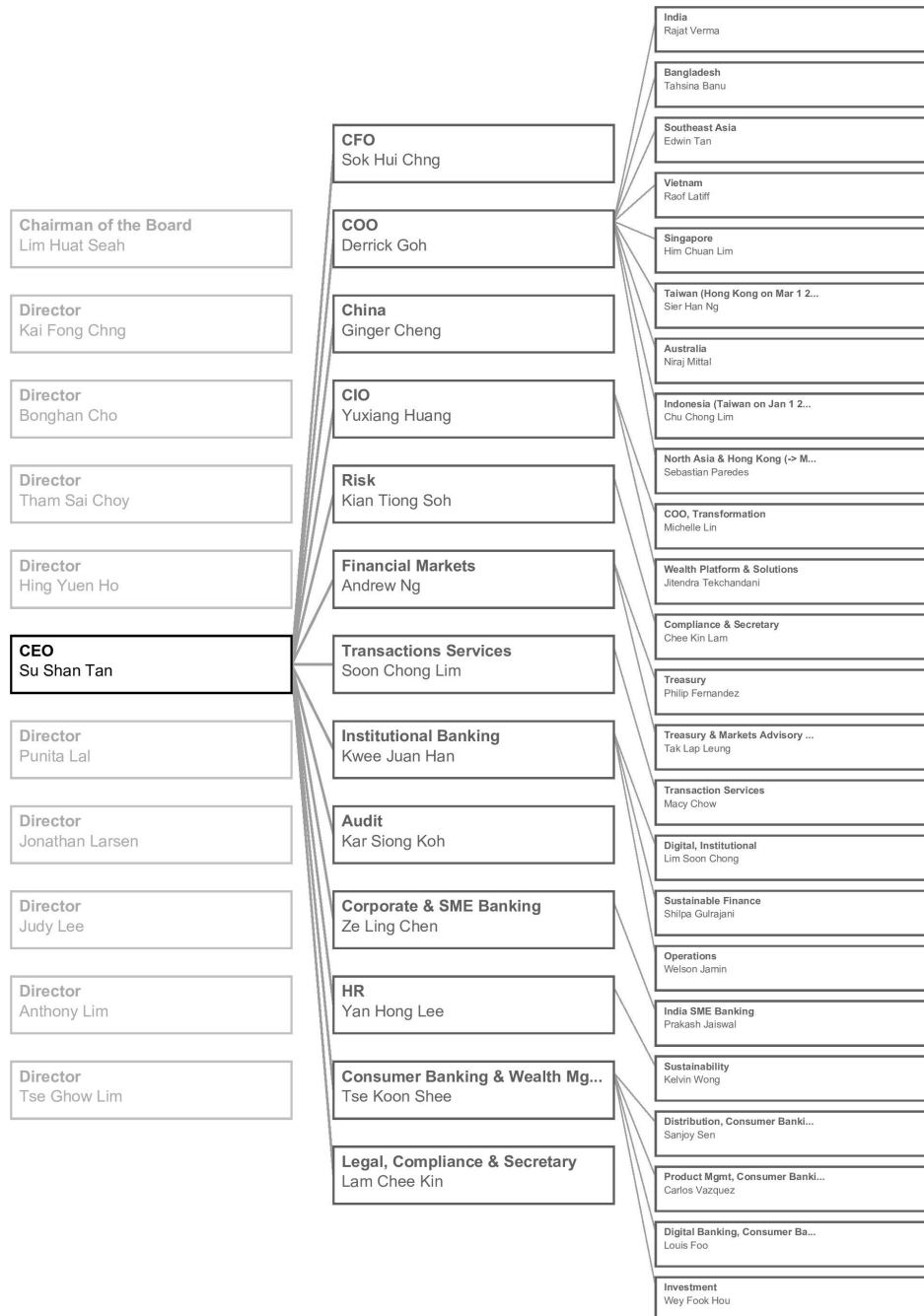
Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/sebastian-paredes-d4125>

Name: Wey Fook Hou

Title: Managing Director, Chief Investment Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/wey-fook-hou-g0785>

Organizational Chart DBS Bank



The Official Board as of Aug 24, 2026 3:02:48 AM - Know more at contact@theofficialboard.com

Large Singapore banks' NIM may stabilize as global interest rates rise

589 words

17 August 2026

Market Intelligence News

MKTINWS

English

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Net interest margins at Singapore's three largest banks are expected to stabilize after falling further in the second quarter of 2026, as global interest rates are projected to rise.

DBS Group Holdings Ltd.'s NIM fell 22 basis points year over year to 1.51% in the April-June period, while that of Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp. Ltd. decreased 17 bps to 1.26%, according to data compiled by S&P Global Market Intelligence. United Overseas Bank Ltd.'s NIM was 1.58% in the period, declining 16 bps on a yearly basis.

A "bias toward higher rates should support sequential improvement in earnings," DBS Group Research analyst Lim Rui Wen said in a July 21 report, noting that commercial interest rates are firming up following recent monetary policy tightening.

The margin declines followed a global easing cycle that started in 2024. Most global central banks are focused on inflation in 2026, especially energy prices, amid the US-Israel war with Iran. The European Central Bank and the Reserve Bank of Australia have already raised interest rates in 2026. The Bank of Japan is expected to raise rates further after taking its policy rate to 1.0% in June, the highest since 1995.

The Monetary Authority of Singapore also tightened monetary policy in April and July by setting the local dollar on a steeper path of appreciation against currencies of the island nation's key trading partners. The Singapore overnight rate average (SORA), a local benchmark that represents the volume-weighted average rate of borrowing transactions in the overnight interbank cash market, reached 1.46% on Aug. 13, compared to 1.01% at the start of the year, according to data on the central bank website.

The SORA "is expected to trend higher in the second half of this year, and that will support NIM," UOB group CFO Yung Chee Leong said during the bank's post-earnings call. "We continue to maintain a disciplined approach, balancing between NII optimization and NIM management."

OCBC group CFO Chin Yee Goh also expects NIM to stabilize in the second half on the expectation of a gradual strengthening of SORA toward the year-end.

"Robust growth in non-interest income more than compensated for the lower net interest income (NII). Strong momentum in **wealth management** drove the increase in fees, while customer flow treasury income was contributed by both **wealth** and corporate segments," Goh said at the bank's post-earnings conference.

Can fee income offset NIM pressure?

DBS reported a 9.2% year-over-year increase in net profit to S\$3.08 billion for the second quarter, while OCBC's net profit grew 22% to S\$2.22 billion. UOB, the smallest in the trio, saw its net profit rise 10.4% to S\$1.48 billion, Market Intelligence data shows.

The banks offset weaker net interest income with an increase in fee and commission income. DBS' net fee and commission income increased 24.8% year-over-year to S\$1.46 billion, while OCBC's jumped 27.6% to S\$740 million and UOB's rose 4.7% to S\$670 million, the data shows.

Other noninterest income also showed strong growth. OCBC led with a 53.8% year-over-year surge to S\$1.43 billion, while UOB's rose 26.4% to S\$670 million and DBS posted a 12.1% increase to S\$1.11 billion, Market Intelligence data show.

Document MKTINWS020260818em8h0002t

Cover Story: Analysts favour DBS, OCBC, while UOB's asset quality concerns resurface

By Felicia Tan (felicia.tan@bizedge.com)

1,484 words

17 August 2026

The Edge Singapore

EDGESI

English

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On Aug 6 to 7, all three Singapore banks posted strong results for the 2QFY2026 and 1HFY2026 ended June 30, mainly thanks to non-interest income, particularly **wealth** fees.

"**Wealth management** was a key growth driver for all three banks, supported by their expanding regional franchises and the rapid rise of private **wealth** in Asia," write analysts Tengfu Li, Venessa Leow and Alka Anbarasu from Moody's Ratings.

"Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation (OCBC) benefitted further from stronger trading, investment and insurance income. However, United Overseas Bank (UOB) reported lower net fee income driven by lending, credit card and investment banking, as well as weaker investment gains," they add.

DBS Group Holdings, which reported record earnings of \$3.08 billion for 2QFY2026, beat estimates on strong trading income, resilient **wealth** momentum and lower-than-expected provisions. OCBC, meanwhile, reported earnings of \$2.22 billion for the quarter, helped by robust loan growth, lower provisions and large trading and investment gains from Great Eastern, notes CLSA's Marcus Liu.

UOB's results were broadly in line with forecasts but proved a "dampener" as asset quality issues resurfaced. The lowered guidance was also a drag, Liu adds.

The bank's total allowance rose by 4% q-o-q to \$211 million, mainly reflecting the downgrade of a "closely monitored real estate account in Greater China". New non-performing assets (NPA) rose to \$902 million in 2QFY2026, up from \$341 million in the previous quarter, for the same reason.

UOB's group CFO Leong Yung Chee said that the additional general provision of \$615 million the bank set aside in 3QFY2025 had taken this into account.

UOB receives upgrades and downgrades

UOB's report card drew mixed reactions. Citi's Tan Yong Hong downgraded from "neutral" to "sell". The sale of UOB Asset Management, for one, will lower UOB's fee income by \$200 million a year, he figures. Cards and loan-related pressure will also weigh on non-**wealth** fee income growth, offset by better operating expense (opex) discipline.

Tan noted that UOB's earnings would have missed expectations if the one-off \$200 million gain from the disposal was stripped out. He also sees the possibility of a special dividend as "unlikely", particularly after the bank's share price underperformed its peers after its previous special dividend in 2HFY2024 and 1HFY2025.

So far, UOB has completed about 40% of its \$2 billion share buyback programme, which amounts to \$794 million or about 22.3 million shares. The remainder will be distributed through share buybacks or "other means" by the end of 2027, says Leong.

From \$41.80, Tan now values UOB at \$38, implying an FY2027 P/B of 1.2 times and a long-term return on equity (ROE) of 11.6%, down from 12.2%.

CLSA's Liu believes that UOB is unlikely to catch up with the other two until investors are more confident that credit risks have stabilised. He has downgraded UOB from "outperform" to "hold" along with a lower target price of \$39, from \$43.

On the other hand, RHB Bank Singapore has upgraded UOB to “buy” from “neutral” with a higher target price of \$46.60 from \$41.30. “Despite an unexciting set of numbers, we believe the valuation gap between UOB and peers is becoming too wide for investors to ignore,” says RHB.

Macquarie’s Jayden Vantarakis is keeping his “outperform” call. He describes UOB as a “value play” at a forward P/B multiple of 1.3 times, or a 48% discount to its domestic peer average. Still, the bank needs to produce a “clean quarter” to start closing the gap.

OCBC Investment Research’s Carmen Lee raised her fair value to \$42.35 from \$41 due to better-than-expected results, but lowered her call to “hold” from “buy” after the share price crossed her previous target.

CGS International’s Tay Wee Kuang and Tan Jie Hui maintained a “hold” call at \$42.60, while DBS Group Research’s Lim Rui Wen kept “hold” as she remains “cautious” of a further deterioration in asset quality, but has a higher target price of \$42.50 from \$35.70.

Phillip Securities’ Glenn Thum retained his “neutral” call and target price of \$43, as he notes that the bank’s NII needs to turn while its card fees need to stabilise before a re-rating.

JP Morgan remains “underweight” on UOB with a price target of \$35, noting that NII, fee and asset quality trends underperformed its peers.

Higher target prices for DBS; CGSI downgrades DBS to ‘hold’

Analysts are more bullish on DBS, with most raising their target prices. All the houses - except CGSI and OCBC with “hold” calls - have “buy”, “outperform” and “accumulate” calls.

Citi’s Tan is the most upbeat, as he lifts his target price to \$85 from \$73.50, based on an 11% compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of assets under management (AUM) from 2025 to 2030.

RHB has raised its FY2026 to FY2028 patmi estimates by 4%, 6% and 8% on higher non-interest income. It expects a 28% lift in FY2027’s dividend per share (DPS), as it now assumes the entire \$2.6 billion unutilised share buyback programme will be returned as dividends. As such, RHB raised its target price to \$81.20 from \$75.70, based on a higher ROE assumption of 17.5% from 16.75%.

Macquarie’s Vantarakis has a higher target price of \$80.74 from \$70.86, based on a higher return on tangible equity (ROTE) target of 21% from 20%. “DBS’s [over] 18% ROE and clear capital management initiatives justify a premium multiple,” he writes. “We see an environment of gradually increasing interest rates as supportive of both net interest and non-interest income.”

OCBC’s Lee has a higher fair value estimate of \$78 from \$60.93. “With the strong inflow of funds into Singapore and management’s focus on **wealth** income, DBS is likely to hold on to its premium over peers for its strong earnings,” she writes. That said, she adds that geopolitical uncertainties and a strong share price outperformance this year may limit further near-term upside.

Phillip Securities’ Glenn Thum has a higher target price of \$79 from \$76 after he ups his FY2026 earnings estimate by 7% on higher **wealth management** and lower provisions.

“We expect **wealth** and treasury customer sales to stay the primary growth driver while NII stabilises,” says Thum. “We continue to prefer DBS among the Singapore banks given its capital return plan (until FY2027), fixed DPS policy and high dividend payout ratio (dividend yield FY2026: 4.3%, FY2027: 4.6%).”

CLSA’s Liu has a \$69 target price, up from \$65. Meanwhile, CGSI’s Tay and Tan have an unchanged target price of \$77.10 but downgraded DBS to “hold” from “add” due to share price outperformance year to date.

Growth potential likely priced in for OCBC

Analysts kept their “buy”, “accumulate” and “hold” calls on OCBC, although some see its potential largely priced in.

DBS’s Lim, who raised her target price to \$36.60 from \$30, believes the bank is on the “cusp of transformation” under new group CEO Tan Teck Long. “We remain confident of management’s execution to deliver OCBC’s next leg of growth,” she says.

The RHB team, which also has a higher target price of \$32.85 from \$29.80, cheered the bank's record quarter and upgraded guidance, which was mainly around operating income.

PhillipCapital's Thum has a higher target price of \$31.70 from \$28.50 as the bank's 2QFY2026 earnings stood above estimates.

"We expect NIM (net interest margin) to stabilise in 2HFY2026 as OCBC slows treasury asset growth and Sora (Singapore overnight rate average) firms, leaving **wealth** to carry income growth," he writes. "We like OCBC for the change in income mix. Non-interest income is 44% of 1HFY2026 income and **wealth** 41%, both driven by customer volume rather than rates. Banking **wealth** AUM of \$350 billion is growing 13% y-o-y, and the HSBC Indonesia deal adds onshore scale from 2027."

CGSI's Tay and Tan upped their target price to \$29.80 from \$28.40, but warned that growth could slow in FY2027 as new Chinese tax regulations on offshore **wealth** may dampen the proposition of Hong Kong and Singapore as regional **wealth** hubs.

Citi's Tan also raised his target price to \$32 from \$28.40, although he believes OCBC's growth expectations are "in the price" following its re-rating of some 50% year to date and a dividend spread over bond yield of less than 1%.

Overall, the analyst believes a further re-rating in the sector will require Sora to rebound "materially" with accelerating loan growth.

Document EDGESI0020260818em8h00007

Linklaters advises UOB on proposed sale of UOB Asset Management to Allianz Global Investors

Distributed by Contify.com

412 words

17 August 2026

Contify Investment News

ATINVT

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Transaction supports UOB's shift to open architecture **wealth** model.
- * UOB and AllianzGI to form long-term distribution partnership.
- * UOBAM's asset management platform across eight Asian markets included.

Original Press Release:

Aug. 17 -- Linklaters LLP issued the following news release:

Linklaters has advised United Overseas Bank Limited (UOB) on the proposed sale of its regional asset management business, UOB Asset Management (UOBAM), to Allianz Global Investors (AllianzGI) for S\$555 million (approximately US\$434 million).

This transaction represents a significant strategic pivot for UOB, supporting its transition towards an open architecture **wealth** model focused on advisory and product distribution. As part of the transaction, UOB and AllianzGI will establish a long-term strategic distribution partnership to provide a broader suite of investment products and **wealth** solutions to UOB's customers across the region.

The transaction covers UOBAM's asset management platform across eight key Asian markets – Singapore, Brunei, Indonesia, Japan, Malaysia, Taiwan, Thailand and Vietnam. UOBAM has approximately S\$42 billion (approximately US\$32.8 billion) in assets under management as of 31 December 2025.

The Linklaters multi-jurisdictional, multi-disciplinary team was led by corporate partners Matthew Middleditch and Karen Phang. The transaction drew on the firm's corporate, financial regulation, TMT/IP, employment and tax expertise, with teams working seamlessly across Singapore, Hong Kong SAR, Jakarta, Bangkok, Shanghai and London. The wider core team included corporate partner Sophie Mathur, counsel Grace Wong and Daniel Tan, solicitor Stephanie Tsang and associate Yee Chong Ng. Specialist support was provided by TMT/IP partner Adrian Fisher with counsel Jia-Yi Tay and Sher Hann Chua; employment & incentives partner Laure de Panafieu and counsel Chaiyee Oh; and Eileen Tok on financial regulation matters, with tax support from Catherine Sam and Thomas Parish.

Linklaters' corporate partner Matthew Middleditch commented:

"This is a significant strategic transaction combining the sale of a leading regional asset management platform with a long-term distribution partnership, which marks a strategic evolution in UOB's **wealth management** strategy. It was a privilege to advise UOB on this transformative transaction that advances UOB's **wealth** ambitions across Asia."

With over five decades on-the-ground in Asia, Linklaters offers deep regional insight combined with the strength and depth of its leading integrated global platform to advice on complex, cross-border mandates involving multiple practice areas, jurisdictions and regulatory regimes.

[Category: Asset and **Wealth Management**, Investment Banking]

Source: Linklaters LLP

Document ATINVT0020260818em8h0008f

Page 57 of 220 © 2026 Factiva, Inc. All rights reserved.

Top Stories

UOB's digital **wealth** sales, transactions jump almost 50% as clients invest more online

Renald Yeo

905 words

17 August 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

print

A4

English

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UOB's digital **wealth** sales and transactions grew close to 50 per cent year on year in the 12 months up to April, driven by a wider regional roll-out and growing customer comfort with investing online.

UOB is starting to reap the benefits of expanding its digital **wealth** capabilities in the region, following the integration of the consumer banking businesses it acquired from Citi.

The lender is also handling a growing demand for investment strategies developed by its private bank's chief investment office (CIO), which it has made available to its broader retail customer base.

Jacquelyn Tan, the lender's head of group personal finances, told The Business Times in a recent interview that assets under management (AUM) in these CIO fund offerings grew about 60 per cent year on year in the first quarter of 2026, and surpassed S\$2 billion in May.

Its CIO income and growth funds are among the five most popular funds bought digitally by customers, she noted.

For UOB, digital **wealth** encompasses customers investing and managing their portfolios through its "UOB TMRW" banking app for activities ranging from buying investment products to setting up regular investments.

The bank's wealthier customers also use these capabilities along with the recommendations they get from their **wealth** advisers.

The bank also notes that customers are now committing larger sums as they become more comfortable investing online.

The average lump-sum investment among young adults in Singapore has risen to about S\$4,000; among young professionals, the figure is close to S\$8,000, Tan said.

Average ticket sizes for overall digital investments have grown about 20 per cent year on year, and customers making recurring investments are putting in nearly S\$450 a month on average.

UOB is looking to digital **wealth** to deepen relationships with its retail customers and support its broader target of doubling **wealth** income by 2030.

Its latest results showed continued momentum in the business. **Wealth management** income rose 16 per cent year on year to S\$717 million in the first half of 2026; high-net-worth AUM grew 7 per cent to S\$204 billion.

Stronger growth outside Singapore

Growth was stronger outside Singapore, with **wealth** income from Malaysia, Indonesia, Thailand and Vietnam rising 30 per cent over the same period.

More than half the customers who are new to **wealth** now make their first investments digitally in the four markets where UOB offers its digital **wealth** capabilities.

Digital adoption is not limited to younger investors. While customers aged 25 to 54 make up close to 80 per cent of those investing digitally, the number of pre-retirees almost doubled in the 12 months up to April, though this was from a smaller base.

Tan said digital **wealth** would play a “meaningful” role in UOB’s **wealth** growth, both by bringing emerging-affluent customers into investing, and by enabling its advisers serving wealthier clients to focus more on advice than on transactions.

Asked whether the shift towards digital investing could cannibalise UOB’s higher-end **wealth** businesses, she said the bank does not see the two as competing channels.

Instead, it looks at customers based on their overall relationship with UOB.

Those who accumulate more **wealth** can move into more sophisticated products and advisory services as their needs become more complex. “If a customer has sufficient AUM, needs a deeper access into a more complex **wealth** solution – by all means, they should be served on the private banking platform,” she said.

UOB’s Privilege Banking segment serves customers with investable assets of between S\$350,000 and S\$5 million; those with more than S\$5 million are served by its private bank.

Artificial intelligence has been incorporated into UOB’s push to deepen its **wealth** relationships, with the bank using customer activity to determine when an investment prompt may be relevant.

Its app can, for instance, prompt customers to consider investing after their salary is credited, or reinvesting after having received dividend income.

Tan said UOB uses transaction data and machine-learning models to better anticipate customers’ needs and determine when to send out such prompts.

The lender is also experimenting with generative AI to improve the productivity of its staff.

It has piloted an AI sales coach for its younger employees and built a generative AI chatbot that enables front-line staff to retrieve product, process and compliance information more quickly. Generative AI is also being piloted to create client pitch books.

But Tan does not expect the technology to replace **wealth** advisers.

“I think it will probably reimagine the way we advise. However, it will not replace advisers,” she said.

Instead, she envisages AI taking on more of the information gathering, preparation and routine work done by these advisers, freeing them to spend more time on client relationships and more complex financial decisions.

Self-service for simpler transactions

That shift mirrors the role the bank sees for digital **wealth** more broadly: making simpler transactions increasingly self-service, while reserving human advice for customers and decisions that require greater expertise.

As the bank works towards its 2030 **wealth** target, Tan said that the aim is ultimately to combine the scale of digital distribution with the judgment and relationship-building of its advisers – rather than have one replace the other.

yrenald@sph.com.sg

Document STBT000020260817em8h00003

The Official Board

HSBC Bank Qatar - The organizational chart displays its 11 executives, including Abdul Hakeem Mostafawi and Laura Dunn

280 words

16 August 2026

The Official Board

OFBOAR

English

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In the Banking industry, there are 5,578 large companies in 188 countries, with a total of 104,247 top executives. Within those companies, 43,312 executive movements have been recorded in the last 12 months.

Company: HSBC Bank Qatar

URL: www.hsbc.com.qa

Industry: Banking

HSBC Bank Qatar is a subsidiary of HSBC Bank MENA & Turkey.

Name: Abdul Hakeem Mostafawi

Title: Chief Executive Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/abdul-hakeem-mostafawi-138e5>

Name: Shreen Abeysekera

Title: Head of Securities Services

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/shreen-abeysekera-789e8>

Name: Aym Allah Seddik

Title: Head of Financial Crime Compliance and Money Laundering Reporting Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/aym-allah-seddik-d9829>

Name: Mohit Joshi

Title: Head of Commercial Banking

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/mohit-joshi-89de1>

Name: Mohammed Jassim Al Sultan

Title: Head of Human Resources

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/mohammed-jassim-al-sultan-89e19>

Name: Ranjith Punnose

Title: Chief Information Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/ranjith-punnose-512d1>

Name: Laura Dunn

Title: Chief Operating Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/laura-dunn-415g1>

Name: Abraham Varghis

Title: Chief Administrative Officer, Wholesale Banking

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/abraham-varghis-351e5>

Name: Ibrahim Abdul-Razak

Title: Head of Global Markets Sales

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/ibrahim-abdul-razak-381g8>

Name: Omar Al-Ansari

Title: Head of **Wealth** and Personal Banking

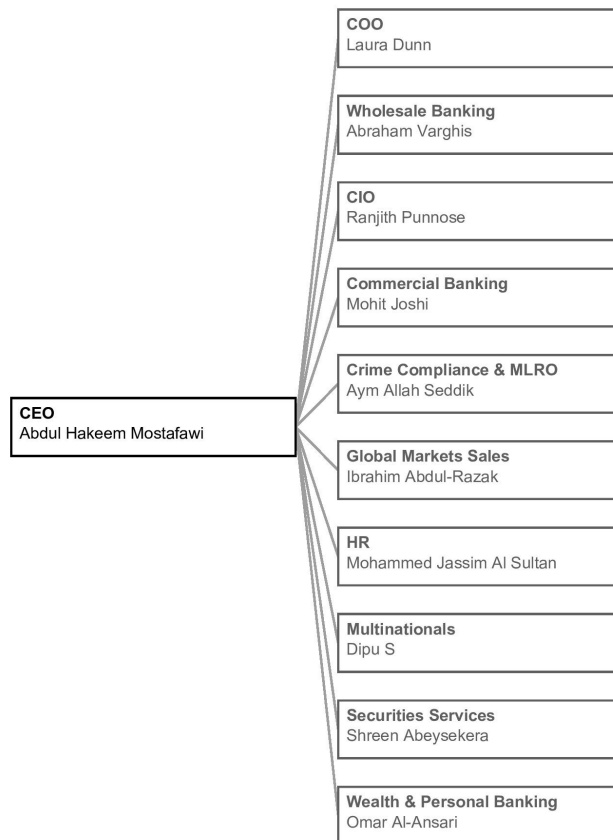
Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/omar-al-ansari-1650d>

Name: Dipu S

Title: Head of Multinationals

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/dipu-s-82e03>

Organizational Chart HSBC Bank Qatar



The Official Board as of Aug 17, 2026 12:01:16 PM - Know more at contact@theofficialboard.com

News

Heiress sues HSBC and Barclays for \$15billion saying they helped her late father plunder her \$650m trust fund after she found 350,000 document treasure trove in Jersey manor house

Eugene Costello

1,774 words

15 August 2026

22:55

Mail Online

DAMONL

English

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At her fairy tale wedding at a magnificent 400-year-old manor house on Jersey, heiress Tanya Dick-Stock appeared to possess everything money could buy.

But a chance discovery made while preparing for the 2012 celebration would plunge Tanya and her husband, investment banker Darrin Stock, into an extraordinary financial labyrinth.

Behind a locked door at St John's Manor, where Tanya had stayed since childhood, they found hundreds of boxes containing approximately 350,000 documents – the apparent records of a secretive offshore financial operation.

What they uncovered would lead Tanya to claim that her father, helped by some of the world's largest banks, plundered her \$650million trust and used it as the legitimate foundation for a vast international money-laundering machine.

Now the couple are seeking an astonishing \$15billion from Barclays, HSBC and associated trust companies.

Neither bank has been found liable and the allegations remain contested. A spokesman for HSBC said the claims are 'unfounded', while Barclays and Jersey trust company Zedra have declined to comment.

Tanya discovered the boxes around a month before her wedding while looking for somewhere to store the cake, lanterns and other paraphernalia.

Driving around the estate in a golf cart, she passed its disused squash courts and realised that the empty building would make an ideal storeroom.

She collected the key and opened the door.

'It was like the last scene in Raiders Of The Lost Ark, where they have the Ark of the Covenant boxed up and are driving it into a warehouse,' she recalls.

'There were crates and crates and boxes. My first reaction was: "Oh, hell's bells! They've filled this up too. What am I going to do now?"

'It was covered in dust, cobwebs and dead leaves. I thought it might be junk that somebody had forgotten about.'

As the boxes were moved to the stables, however, Tanya noticed that her name – and the names of her trusts – appeared on some of them.

Two years earlier, she says, her father, Canadian-born property tycoon John Dick Sr, had told her: 'Bad news, Tanya. The trusts are bust. Everything's gone.'

Tanya said: 'It certainly wasn't me. I didn't receive hundreds of millions of dollars, so I didn't spend it.'

She asked Darrin to examine the accounts after repeatedly being told that she simply did not understand their complexities.

'They said I was stupid and shouldn't worry my pretty little head,' she says. 'Then Darrin looked at them and said: "I've got bad news for you, Tanya. You are being robbed. You understand just fine."'

Among the recovered papers, the couple say, were banking records, wire-transfer confirmations, fabricated loan agreements and internal correspondence.

One folder carried the extraordinary title: 'Confidential - Do Not Retain.'

Tanya says it contained communications instructing clients to destroy documents after reading them. Yet La Hougue, the offshore Jersey operation at the centre of the allegations, had retained copies.

The couple also found memoranda which explained how to fabricate apparently historical documents using appropriately aged paper, ink, machinery and stamps.

Tanya's trust had been created in Colorado in 1984 following her parents' divorce and contained valuable assets across the state. According to the lawsuit, it was worth approximately \$650million by 1995, when Barclays was serving as trustee.

The trust deed explicitly required any replacement trustee to be a US-regulated bank or trust company and prohibited John Dick Sr from benefiting from its assets.

Yet, the couple allege, Barclays appointed La Hougue, the offshore Jersey operation which has since been purchased by Zedra, as its replacement.

Tanya and Darrin claim that La Hougue did not satisfy the trust's requirements, making its appointment invalid from the outset. On that argument, Barclays never legally relinquished its responsibilities as trustee.

The couple also allege that La Hougue had close personnel connections with the bank and was originally staffed by former Barclays executives.

Their lawyers invoke the doctrine known as 'fraud on a power'. Despite its name, it does not necessarily require proof of conventional fraud or theft; it concerns whether a legal power – in this case, the power to appoint a replacement trustee – was exercised for an unauthorised purpose.

Tanya says: 'Within the four corners of the document, it says very clearly that if Barclays stands down, it must appoint a US-regulated bank or trust company. They didn't.'

At first, Tanya says, she believed her father and the banks had themselves been victims of La Hougue. Only much later she says did the documents lead her to the devastating conclusion that the banks had been working with him.

'I didn't realise that HSBC and Barclays were partners with La Hougue,' she says.

'What a betrayal. Everybody was taking a little piece every time they moved money, made a fake loan or took interest or principal payments. Little pieces add up to big pieces.'

At the heart of the wider case is what Darrin describes as international banking's 'dirty little secret': secret or coded accounts provided without meaningful Know Your Customer checks.

He compares the operation to the Netflix crime drama Ozark, in which legitimate businesses such as a car wash and strip club are used to disguise criminal proceeds.

According to Darrin's analysis of the documents, each dollar of Tanya's legitimate **wealth** could have facilitated the movement of approximately seven dollars in illicit funds.

On that basis, he claims, her \$650million trust could have supported transactions involving around \$4.5billion.

No court has accepted that calculation and the banks deny wrongdoing.

The United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime estimates that between 2 and 5 per cent of global GDP – \$800billion to \$2trillion – is laundered annually.

The lawsuit also alleges connections between La Hougue and Ian and Kevin Maxwell, brothers of convicted sex trafficker Ghislaine Maxwell.

The amended complaint claims that La Hougue moved money, established shell companies and participated in financial schemes involving the brothers during the mid-1990s.

A spokesman for Ian and Kevin Maxwell declined to comment, but previously said they had no knowledge of tax avoidance or other schemes organised by La Hougue.

La Hougue has also attracted the attention of the US Senate Finance Committee during its investigation into the finances of Jeffrey Epstein. Its inclusion in that investigation does not infer that La Hougue or Tanya's trust participated in Epstein's crimes.

The \$15billion claim comprises approximately \$5billion for the alleged loss of the trust, damages and interest calculated at an annual court rate of 8 per cent.

The couple seeks a further \$10billion through claims of unjust enrichment or disgorgement, representing the benefit which it alleges the defendants obtained from using the money for approximately 30 years.

That does not include punitive damages, which the court could award separately if the couple establishes liability and the required level of misconduct.

The banks have always fought to have the dispute heard in the UK or Jersey, while Tanya and Darrin argue that it belongs in the US because the trust was created in Colorado and Tanya is an American beneficiary.

John Dick Sr died in 2023 without being reconciled with his daughter and having maintained his innocence.

He did not buy the couple a wedding present, Tanya says – not even a card. But Darrin believes the boxes he left behind proved far more consequential.

'He said my dad gave me the greatest wedding present of all time,' Tanya says, 'because now we had the proof.'

'They thought they could drown us in paper. They didn't recognise how stubborn we were going to be. We just kept at it and at it.'

Tanya says her motivation has expanded beyond recovering her inheritance.

'When it first started, I just wanted my stuff back,' she says. 'Now I want these guys exposed. There should be no upside for anyone engaging in this course of conduct.'

Other alleged victims of offshore trusts have contacted the couple. Tanya hopes that if the lawsuit succeeds, she can establish an organisation resembling the Innocence Project to help those who lack the money, health or stamina to fight.

'I'm not the only one,' she says. 'There are so many victims out there. There has got to be some way to give back and help these people.'

A source close to HSBC added that the claims against the bank relate to a Jersey loan made in 2012 that was repaid in 2019. 'The plaintiffs have pursued a number of claims concerning the same loan and those claims were dismissed by another Court,' they said.

A source close to the Dick-Stocks' legal team said: 'This is not merely a "bad loan" case against HSBC; it's a dishonest-assistance case charging that HSBC knowingly became a core banking partner of the La Hougue/Pantrust structure.'

'They stepped into the shoes of Barclays Bank and moved billions of dollars with little or none of the required paperwork. Both HSBC and Barclays engaged in creating illicit bank accounts, had inadequate KYC practices, lending structures, and international wire infrastructure, all of which kept this structure maintained for years.'

'The complaint illustrates clearly that HSBC and HSBC USA acted in concert with Barclays, Barclaytrust (Zedra), La Hougue/Pantrust and others; that it facilitated improper Colorado-linked wires that moved money from the trusts; and that it maintained coded or secret accounts, ignored KYC/AML requirements, and provided loans against improperly pledged trust assets.'

'All of this adds up to the fact that HSBC knowingly assisted in the stripping and dissipation of DFT1 [Tanya Dick-stock's trust] and related trust assets.'

Darrin Dick-Stock adds: 'John Edwards does not take on cases he doesn't believe he can win. Nothing in our claim has been in front of any court, anywhere, at any time. Nothing was "addressed" or "thrown out".

'It's as though fraudsters stole your supercar and used it for years to win a lot of money in races. They smash the car up, patch it up and say, "At least the tyres are still the same" when they return it. But not a word about the huge amounts of money they have made fraudulently using your asset.'

A spokesman for HSBC said: 'These claims are unfounded, and we will vigorously contest them.

'HSBC operates a robust financial crime compliance program with industry leading controls.'

Barclays and Zedra, on behalf of La Hougue, declined to comment.

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Impressionist art brings clients together for exclusive viewing

285 words

15 August 2026

Borneo Bulletin

AIWBOR

English

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Standard Chartered Brunei recently hosted an exclusive private viewing of the Impressionist Landscape Art Exhibition at Balai Khazanah Islam Sultan Haji Hassanal Bolkiah for its Priority clients.

The event brought together art, culture and client engagement through a specially curated programme that included a private dinner and guided viewing of rare Impressionist masterpieces by celebrated artists such as Claude Monet, Paul Cézanne and Paul Signac.

Hosted in intimate groups, guests were guided through the exhibition by gallery guides who shared insights into the artists, techniques and historical significance of the works on display. Guests were also given the opportunity to explore the exhibition's immersive experiences and galleries at their leisure.

Speaking at the event, Head of **Wealth** and Retail Banking, Standard Chartered Brunei Brenda Low said, "The works featured in this exhibition remind us that perspective, patience and the passage of time often reveal enduring value. Through this exclusive viewing, we wanted to provide our clients with a unique opportunity to experience these remarkable masterpieces while connecting over a shared appreciation for art and culture. The exhibition's theme of 'Seasons' also reflects the different stages of life's journey, and at Standard Chartered, we are privileged to support our clients through every season as they build, grow and preserve what matters most."

The exhibition's theme of 'Seasons' resonated strongly with the bank's philosophy of supporting clients through the different stages of their financial journey, from **wealth** creation and growth to preservation and legacy planning.

The event forms part of Standard Chartered Priority's efforts to deliver exclusive experiences and privileges that complement its **wealth** and banking offerings, while strengthening relationships with its clients.

Document AIWBOR0020260815em8f00004



KERALA

HSBC India opens new branch in city

100 words

15 August 2026

The Hindu

THINDU

English

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THIRUVANANTHAPURAM KERALA

This will be the second branch for the bank in Kerala after its branch in Kochi

HSBC India opened its new branch in the capital city on Thursday. This will be the second branch for the bank in the State. Although the bank earlier had a branch located at Vellayambalam, it was closed down some years ago. Sandeep Batra, Head of **Wealth** and Premier Banking, HSBC India, said that Kerala has a strong base of globally connected families and entrepreneurs backed by one of India's most significant NRI communities.

Document THINDU0020260815em8f000an



Leadership Track in Banks: Kavita Kulkarni Moves to StanChart as Chief Technology & Operations Officer

Distributed by Contify.com

76 words

14 August 2026

Banking Frontiers

ATBANF

English

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Kavita Kulkarni has joined Standard Chartered Bank as Chief Technology and Operations Officer, India and South Asia. She has been with Barclays Private Bank as CIO – Private Bank and **Wealth Management**. She has also worked at Credit Suisse and Morgan Stanley. Kavita holds a B.E in Computer Science and MBA in Finance from NYU Stern School of Business.

Document ATBANF0020260819em8e00094

RAM Ratings affirms HSBC Malaysia's AAA ratings

Distributed by Contify.com

375 words

14 August 2026

Islamic Finance News - Contify

ATISFN

English

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Key Highlights:

* Reflects strong franchise, credit fundamentals, and parental support.

* Pre-tax profit stays strong at RM2.1 billion in FY Dec 2025.

* Capitalisation remains robust with CET1 ratio of 15.8%.

Original Press Release:

Aug. 14 -- RAM Ratings issued the following news release:

RAM Ratings has affirmed the AAA/Stable/P1 financial institution ratings of HSBC Bank Malaysia Berhad (the Bank). The affirmation reflects the Bank's established franchise, healthy credit fundamentals and expected parental support from HSBC Holdings plc, given its strategic role in the Group's Asia and **wealth management** growth plans.

We expect HSBC Malaysia's asset quality to remain resilient, backed by prudent underwriting, a focus on affluent customers and strong provisioning buffers. As at end-March 2026, its gross impaired loan ratio improved markedly to 1.7% from 3.1% as at end-December 2024 (industry average: 1.4%), chiefly owing to the reclassification of loans previously under repayment relief to performing status after the prescribed curing period, and changes in the classification of rescheduled and restructured loans. The credit cost ratio rose to an annualised 22 bps in 1Q FY Dec 2026 (FY Dec 2025: net writeback of 2 bps), partly reflecting additional allowances for external risks.

HSBC Malaysia demonstrates earnings resilience despite its mid-size stature, supported by diversified income streams. Pre-tax profit stayed strong at RM2.1 bil in FY Dec 2025 even with margin pressure after a 25-bp OPR cut, a smaller loan base and reduced impairment writebacks. While net interest margin narrowed to 2.6% (FY Dec 2024: 2.8%), non-interest income helped offset the decline. In 1Q fiscal 2026, stronger non-interest income drove a 9% y-o-y increase in pre-tax profit to RM581 mil, lifting the annualised return on risk-weighted assets to 4.0%.

HSBC Malaysia's capitalisation remains robust, with a common equity tier-1 ratio of 15.8% as at end-March 2026. Funding and liquidity continue to benefit from a high proportion of current and savings account deposits, which accounted for 58% of total deposits compared with the industry's 36% average.

[Category: Investment Banking, Financial Performance, Credit Rating Updates]

Source: RAM Ratings

Document ATISFN0020260815em8e00009

News wire

HSBC India Offers Zero Forex Markup Across All Its Credit Cards

PNN

397 words

14 August 2026

Outlook Business

OUTLBS

English

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Mumbai (Maharashtra) [India], August 13: HSBC India has announced zero forex markup for all HSBC credit cards from 15 August 2026 to 15 September 2026 (both dates inclusive), aimed at providing better value for money to customers on international spending. The offer is extended across the entire HSBC credit card portfolio held by existing Indian residents.

The offer is valid on all HSBC credit cards—HSBC Premier Credit Card, HSBC Taj Credit Card, HSBC Live+ Credit Card, HSBC TravelOne Credit Card and HSBC Platinum Credit Card. HSBC Prive Credit Card and HSBC RuPay Cashback Card already offer zero forex markup on all international purchases since their launches in 2024 and 2025, respectively.

During the offer period, both merchant point-of-sale as well as online foreign currency transactions on eligible HSBC credit cards will carry zero forex markup, in addition to existing rewards and benefits. By removing the foreign exchange markup fee during the offer period, customers can benefit from lower costs on eligible international spends and easier budgeting, while continuing to enjoy existing card features and benefits.

Additionally, the bank also reiterated that HSBC credit card holders are not charged a Dynamic Currency Conversion (DCC) fee. Hence, HSBC customers who choose to pay in their home currency (INR) instead of the local currency while travelling overseas avoid that additional cost too. This existing benefit continues to be a standing benefit across all HSBC credit cards.

Commenting on the launch, Sandeep Batra, Head of International **Wealth** and Premier Banking, HSBC India, said, "At HSBC, we want our customers to get value on every international transaction whether they are travelling overseas, shopping on global websites, or paying for services overseas. By introducing zero forex mark-up across all HSBC Credit Cards, we are ensuring customers can spend internationally with greater clarity and value, while continuing to enjoy the rewards and benefits that are already built on their cards."

HSBC now has a network of 32 branches across 20 cities in India. HSBC has maintained a strong presence in India for over 170 years, supporting customers in their financial journeys both locally and globally.

If you object to the content of this press release, please notify us at pr.error.rectification@gmail.com. We will respond and rectify the situation within 24 hours.

Document OUTLBS0020260814em8e0008h

BANKING & FINANCE

StanChart customers to 'gain from wider range of services' after move to Trust Bank: digital bank CEO

Tan Nai Lun
759 words
14 August 2026
Business Times Singapore
STBT
print
A13
English
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Customers who will be transferred to Trust Bank from Standard Chartered (StanChart) will stand to gain from a wider range of rewards and services than they did before, said Trust Bank chief executive Dwaipayan Sadhu.

Lack of confidence is the biggest barrier to investing among non-investors in Singapore, according to Trust's Everyday Investor Report released on Thursday.

"The two banks are going to focus on what they are really good at," Sadhu said, noting that Trust is known for its digital retail financial services while StanChart focuses on **wealth management**.

This comes as customers are increasingly using Trust as their primary bank, Sadhu said in an interview on Thursday (Aug 13).

Its credit card activation rates are in excess of 85 per cent, and its cards are used on an average of 25 times a month, he noted.

Sadhu pointed out that Trust has built a "very strong suite" of digital innovation since its launch, and StanChart clients will be able to benefit from the whole suite once they move over in October.

Deepening combined abilities

In July, StanChart said that it will transfer part of its credit card and personal loan clients to Trust Bank in a bid to deepen both banks' combined abilities to serve retail banking clients in Singapore.

Sadhu declined to comment on the number of customers being moved, or how many of them are new to the bank.

Sadhu also could not comment on further collaborations, although he said that Trust will continue to "work very closely" with StanChart.

Sadhu was speaking at the sidelines of the launch of the bank's revamped credit card.

On Thursday, Trust announced that it was adding stockback benefits to its cashback card – where customers can earn rewards that go into fractional investment whenever they spend.

The bank is also looking to offer miles as rewards in the next two to three months.

To increase flexibility and convenience, a single card will offer all benefits – customers just need to choose the rewards programme they want, with the option to switch every quarter.

Trust is the first in Singapore to offer stockback as a rewards programme for credit cards, although online brokerage Tiger Brokers has a similar offering for debit cards. The Tiger Boss debit card awards fractional shares per spending.

Commenting on competition, especially in the investing space, Sadhu said that Trust "cannot be compared" with any other fintechs or financial organisations, given its range of products and services.

Since its launch in 2022, the digital bank has grown from offering debit and credit cards, to providing unsecured personal loans, distributing funds and insurance, and facilitating trading and investment of US stocks and exchange-traded funds (ETFs).

"Clients are not using us only for one product; they are increasingly using us for multiple products, and they're using us very, very frequently," he explained.

Sadhu said that the bank has already started offering London-domiciled ETFs in July, and will look to offer Singapore-listed stocks some time in the next few months.

Investing habits

The revamped credit card rides on the results of its recent survey of investing habits among Singaporeans.

Lack of confidence is the biggest barrier to investing among non-investors in Singapore, according to Trust's Everyday Investor Report released on Thursday.

Some 44 per cent of respondents are worried about losing money, and 41 per cent said that they do not know enough to feel confident.

Some 38 per cent also said that they do not know where and how to start investing.

Meanwhile, life priorities and market uncertainty are the main drivers of investor attrition.

Some 40 per cent of those who stopped investing said that they needed money for other expenses. Some 30 per cent said that the market made them nervous, and 27 per cent said that they lost money and became cautious.

Nevertheless, Trust pointed out that investing is mainstream among young everyday Singapore residents, with 51 per cent aged 18 to 40 actively investing today.

Investors are also starting earlier, with 74 per cent of active 18 to 24-year-old investors making their first investment by age 20.

Artificial intelligence is becoming part of the investing journey, with AI chatbots the third most-used investing tool after watch lists and price alerts.

Trust's study was conducted among 1,050 Singapore residents aged 18 to 40 between May and June 2026.

tnailun@sph.com.sg

Document STBT000020260814em8e00009

Banking: HSBC Sees Vietnam Wealth Rising 125% by 2034 as Management Needs Grow

229 words

14 August 2026

Vietnam News Brief Service

VIETNB

English

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HSBC sees Vietnam shifting from **wealth** creation toward professional **wealth management** as total **wealth** is forecast to rise 125% by 2034, with its Vietnam executive pointing to changing needs among the country's growing affluent population.

Vietnam had about 19,000 U.S. dollar millionaires by the end of 2023, nearly twice the level a decade earlier, according to data cited by Ranganath Ananth, Senior Director of **Wealth** and Personal Banking at HSBC Vietnam.

Ananth said much of Vietnam's **wealth** is first-generation, built through entrepreneurship, real estate and business growth, creating rising demand for **wealth** protection, portfolio growth, retirement planning and inheritance solutions.

Deposits, real estate and gold remain favored assets, but affluent clients are increasingly seeking professional portfolio management, risk management and opportunities beyond traditional investment channels.

HSBC said **wealth management** should start with financial goals, investment horizons and risk tolerance before products are selected, rather than using a product-first approach and building financial plans around individual investments.

Ananth called for goal-based financial advice, greater product transparency and suitability, and regular portfolio reviews and rebalancing to develop more disciplined investment practices.

Banks, asset managers, insurers and regulators also need to develop standards, training and innovation together, as Vietnam's next phase of **wealth** growth will require more professional management of accumulated assets.

Document VIETNB0020260813em8e000b5

DBS Hong Kong CEO Sebastian Paredes to retire next year, successor groomed from within

Distributed by Contify.com

1,193 words

13 August 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * DBS Hong Kong CEO Sebastian Paredes retiring March 2027.
- * Ng Sier Han appointed as successor, currently CEO of DBS Taiwan.
- * Paredes led DBS Hong Kong to record profits and industry recognitions.

Original Press Release:

Hong Kong, Aug. 13 -- DBS Bank Ltd issued the following news release:

After an illustrious 16-year career with DBS, Sebastian Paredes, Head of North Asia and CEO of DBS Bank (Hong Kong) Limited ("DBS Hong Kong") will be retiring from executive duties on 1 March, 2027. He will stay on as Senior Advisor. Reflecting the strength of its leadership bench and longstanding commitment to developing talent from within, DBS also announced Ng Sier Han, presently CEO of DBS Taiwan, will be appointed as CEO of DBS Bank (Hong Kong) with effect from 1 March 2027, subject to regulatory approval.

Standing as the longest serving active bank CEO in Hong Kong's current banking industry, Sebastian has led DBS Bank (Hong Kong) since September 2010. He has been on the DBS Bank (China) board since 2011 and served as the Chairman of DBS China since April 2023. Sebastian has also overseen the Group's North Asia franchise covering Mainland China, Hong Kong and Taiwan. Under his leadership, DBS Bank (Hong Kong) delivered record net profit of HKD 9.6 billion (SGD 1.61 billion) in 2025, while earning industry recognitions as Best International Bank in Hong Kong by FinanceAsia and Bank of the Year by Bloomberg Businessweek for five consecutive years from 2022 to 2026. With him at the helm, DBS' Greater China operations beyond Hong Kong also performed strongly, achieving a record net profit of SGD 791 million in 2025.

During his tenure at DBS, Sebastian has brought an ambitious vision to redefine the bank's scale and capabilities. Over the past 15 years, DBS Hong Kong has delivered sustained growth and resilient profitability, successfully navigating economic cycles and market turmoil. DBS Hong Kong's total income in 2025 was 2.5 times of what it was 15 years ago, and its net profit had almost tripled since 2010. DBS Hong Kong has risen to establish as one of the largest banks in Hong Kong by income and net profit, anchoring Hong Kong as a significant revenue engine for DBS Group outside of Singapore.

Sebastian has also led the bank to continue to transform and gear up for the future of banking, leveraging digitalisation, data and AI to improve business performances, customer journey and employee experience. The bank will bring Generative AI and agentic AI capabilities to over 1 million users in Hong Kong, enhancing their ability to retrieve and analyse transactions, payment status and banking fee information through a single conversation, while delivering faster, more intuitive support and selected task fulfilment within secure, governed journeys.

As Hong Kong continues to be the leading international financial centre and a world-class **wealth** hub, Sebastian spearheaded strategic shifts and strengthened DBS Hong Kong by strategically positioning the bank for **Wealth**, covering the entire **wealth** continuum from affluent to ultra-high-net-worth clients. This transformation has led to DBS Hong Kong's current diversified business mixture, with approximately one-third of its portfolio in **wealth**, small and medium enterprises, and large corporate segments, which is well-balanced for a sustainable long-term growth.

Sebastian Paredes, CEO of DBS Bank (Hong Kong) and Head of North Asia of DBS Group said, "Serving as CEO of DBS Hong Kong has been the greatest privilege of my professional journey. Since taking on this role, I have had the honour of leading the franchise to build out a solid balance sheet, embrace digital transformation, enhance our customer experience, deliver consistent shareholder value, and give back to the local communities in Hong Kong. I am deeply grateful to our board, our clients and our incredible team for their trust. Sier Han, my successor groomed from within, is a testament to the strength of DBS' leadership bench. I am confident that our franchise in Hong Kong as well as in North Asia are exceptionally well-positioned for the next chapter of growth."

Tan Su Shan, Chief Executive Officer of DBS Group and Vice Chairman of the Board of Directors of DBS Hong Kong said, "Over the past 16 years, Sebastian has played a pivotal role in transforming DBS Hong Kong into a leading franchise. Through his strategic vision and leadership, he also strengthened DBS' position in North Asia, deepened customer relationships and fostered a culture of innovation that has positioned the franchise strongly for the future. While he will only hand over the reins next March, I would like to take this opportunity to express my gratitude for his leadership and the lasting impact he has had on DBS, our customers and our people."

A banker of over 40 years, a citizen of Ecuador and Spain, Sebastian has a strong track record in building franchises across multiple markets and is highly experienced in managing complex situations and leading through different cycles of the economy. Prior to joining DBS, Sebastian was the President Director of PT Bank Danamon Indonesia, where he successfully solidified the bank's position in retail, SME and commercial banking. Before Danamon, he spent 20 years at Citigroup in South America, Central America, Turkey and Central Asia and acted as Head of Sub-Saharan Africa.

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named "World's Best AI Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Digital Bank" by Euromoney and the winner of multiple digital assets awards. In addition, DBS has been accorded the "Safest Bank in Asia" award by Global Finance for 17 consecutive years from 2009 to 2025.

DBS provides a full range of services in consumer, **wealth**, SME and corporate banking. As a bank born and bred in Asia, DBS understands the intricacies of doing business in the region's most dynamic markets.

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by uplifting lives and livelihoods of those in need. It provides essential needs to the underprivileged, and fosters inclusion by equipping the underserved with financial and digital literacy skills. It also nurtures innovative social enterprises that create positive impact.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

[Category: Investment Banking, Digital Transformation Initiatives, Management Changes, Digital Economy]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd

Document ATINBK0020260818em8d000em

The Official Board

Standard Chartered - The organizational chart displays its 62 executives, including Bill Winters and David Tang

1,299 words

13 August 2026

The Official Board

OFBOAR

English

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In the Banking industry, there are 5,579 large companies in 188 countries, with a total of 104,266 top executives. Within those companies, 43,312 executive movements have been recorded in the last 12 months.

Company: Standard Chartered

URL: www.sc.com

Industry: Banking

Standard Chartered has 48 subsidiaries, including Standard Chartered Bank Singapore and Standard Chartered Mauritius.

Name: Bill Winters

Title: Group Chief Executive Officer and Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/bill-winters-d8413>

Name: David Tang

Title: Independent Non-Executive Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/david-tang-5e1g5>

Name: Phil Rivett

Title: Chairman of the Audit Committee and Senior Independent Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/phil-rivett-1785d>

Name: Linda Yueh

Title: Chairman of the Culture and Sustainability Committee and Independent Non-Executive Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/linda-yueh-712eg>

Name: Maria Ramos

Title: Chairman of the Board

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/maria-ramos-7852g>

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Name: Diane Jurgens

Title: Independent Non-Executive Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/diane-jurgens-234d3>

Name: Shirish Apte

Title: Chairman of the Remuneration Committee and Independent Non-Executive Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/shirish-apte-8egd8>

Name: Jacqueline Hunt

Title: Independent Non-Executive Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/jacqueline-hunt-d4de6>

Name: Lincoln Leong

Title: Independent Non-Executive Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/lincoln-leong-9gee9>

Name: Tanate Phutrakul

Title: Independent Non-Executive Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/tanate-phutrakul-d68e4>

Name: Robin Lawther

Title: Independent Non-Executive Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/robin-lawther-408e4>

Name: Steve Brice

Title: Chief Investment Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/steve-brice-d3e61>

Name: Judy Hsu

Title: Chief Executive Officer, **Wealth** and Retail Banking and Head of Association of Southeast Asian Nations and South Asia Markets

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/judy-hsu-5g309>

Name: Paul Day

Title: Group Head of Internal Audit

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/paul-day-35e04>

Name: Jason Forrester

Title: Chief Risk Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/jason-forrester-75e0d>

Name: Scott Corrigan

Title: Group General Counsel and Company Secretary

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/scott-corrigan-3ge25>

Name: Tanuj Kapilashrami

Title: Group Chief Operating Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/tanuj-kapilashrami-e64g2>

Name: Benjamin Hung

Title: President, International

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/benjamin-hung-2g7d4>

Name: Alex Manson

Title: Chief Executive Officer, Ventures

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/alex-manson-2e0g6>

Name: Noelle Eder

Title: Group Head of Technology and Operations

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/noelle-eder-39g48>

Name: Manus Costello

Title: Chief Financial Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/manus-costello-24g14>

Name: Roberto Hoornweg

Title: Chief Executive Officer, Corporate & Investment Banking

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/roberto-hoornweg-3814g>

Name: Daniel Hodge

Title: Deputy Chief Financial Officer

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Title: Head of Asset Management Transformation

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Title: Trade Chief Operating Officer, Europe and Americas

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Title: Global Head of Foundation and Corporate Philanthropy

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Title: Global Head of Enterprise Data Governance, Risk Management, and Partnering

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Title: Global Head, Private Banking

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/didier-von-daeniken-78d13>

Name: Manpreet Gill

Title: Chief Investment Officer, Africa, Middle East and Europe

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/manpreet-gill-72e09>

Name: Robbie Sommerville

Title: Managing Director, Global Head of Corporate Communications

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/robbie-sommerville-56d73>

Name: Alvaro Garrido

Title: Chief Operating Officer, Technology and Operations and Chief Security, Data and Artificial Intelligence Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/alvaro-garrido-g65e6>

Name: Daniel Furer

Title: Head of Discretionary Portfolio Management and Asset Allocation

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Title: Global Head, Small and Medium Enterprise Banking

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Name: Valerie Tay

Title: Executive Director, Business Communications

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Name: Thomas Schindler

Title: Managing Director, Global Head of Financial Planning and Analysis and Stress Testing

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Name: Andy MacLean

Title: Global Head of Organisation and People Capability

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Name: Jonathan Liang

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Title: Global Head of Digital Assets

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/rene-michau-3687g>

Name: John-Paul Parker

Title: Head of Securitized Product Trading

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/john-paul-parker-g0e70>

Name: Nathalie Revillion-Castro

Title: Managing Director and Global Head of Trading Operations and in-Country Oversight

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/nathalie-revillion-castro-67gd2>

Name: Rosalind Ng

Title: Global Chief Operating Officer, **Wealth** and Retail Banking

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/rosalind-ng-70g50>

Name: Nicholas Hatherall

Title: Managing Director, Global Head, Liquidity

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/nicholas-hatherall-929dg>

Name: Guillermo Veiga

Title: Group Chief Information and Operations Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/guillermo-veiga-3e0g4>

Name: Prashant Hampihallikar

Title: Head of Credit and Portfolio Management, Europe, Middle East and Africa and Americas

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/prashant-hampihallikar-d09e0>

Name: Bongiwe Gangeni

Title: Head of Consumer, Private and Business Banking, Africa, Middle East and Europe

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/bongiwe-gangeni-d2814>

Name: Dhruva Tandon

Title: Executive Director, Corporate and Investment Banking

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/dhruva-tdandon-e9784>

Name: Farisa Zarin

Title: Global Head, Regulatory and Public Affairs

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/farisa-zarin-10d40>

Name: David Howes

Title: Group Head of Compliance, Financial Crime and Conduct Risk

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/david-howes-d86g2>

Name: Marisa Drew

Title: Chief Sustainability Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/marisa-drew-7469g>

Name: Shaun Gamble

Title: Executive Director, Group Media Relations

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Name: Adrian Munday

Title: Global Head of Operational, Technology and Cyber Risk

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Name: Raymond Ang

Title: Global Chief Executive, Private and Affluent Banking

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/raymond-ang-e13g1>

Name: Shebani Baweja

Title: Group Chief Data Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/shebani-baweja-e1461>

Name: Julianne Lee

Title: Managing Director, Global Head of Government Affairs, Group Public and Regulatory Affairs

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/julianne-lee-730e4>

Name: Mohamed Keraine

Title: Global Head of Digital

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/mohamed-keraine-89gd1>

Name: Nushrat Gunnoo

Title: Head of Subsidiary Governance

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/nushrat-gunnoo-60g61>

Name: Will Brown

Title: Group Head of Human Resources

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/will-brown-279e2>

Name: Shelley Boland

Title: Global Head, Corporate Real Estate and Services

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/shelley-boland-06g24>

Name: Michael Spiegel

Title: Global Head of Transaction Banking

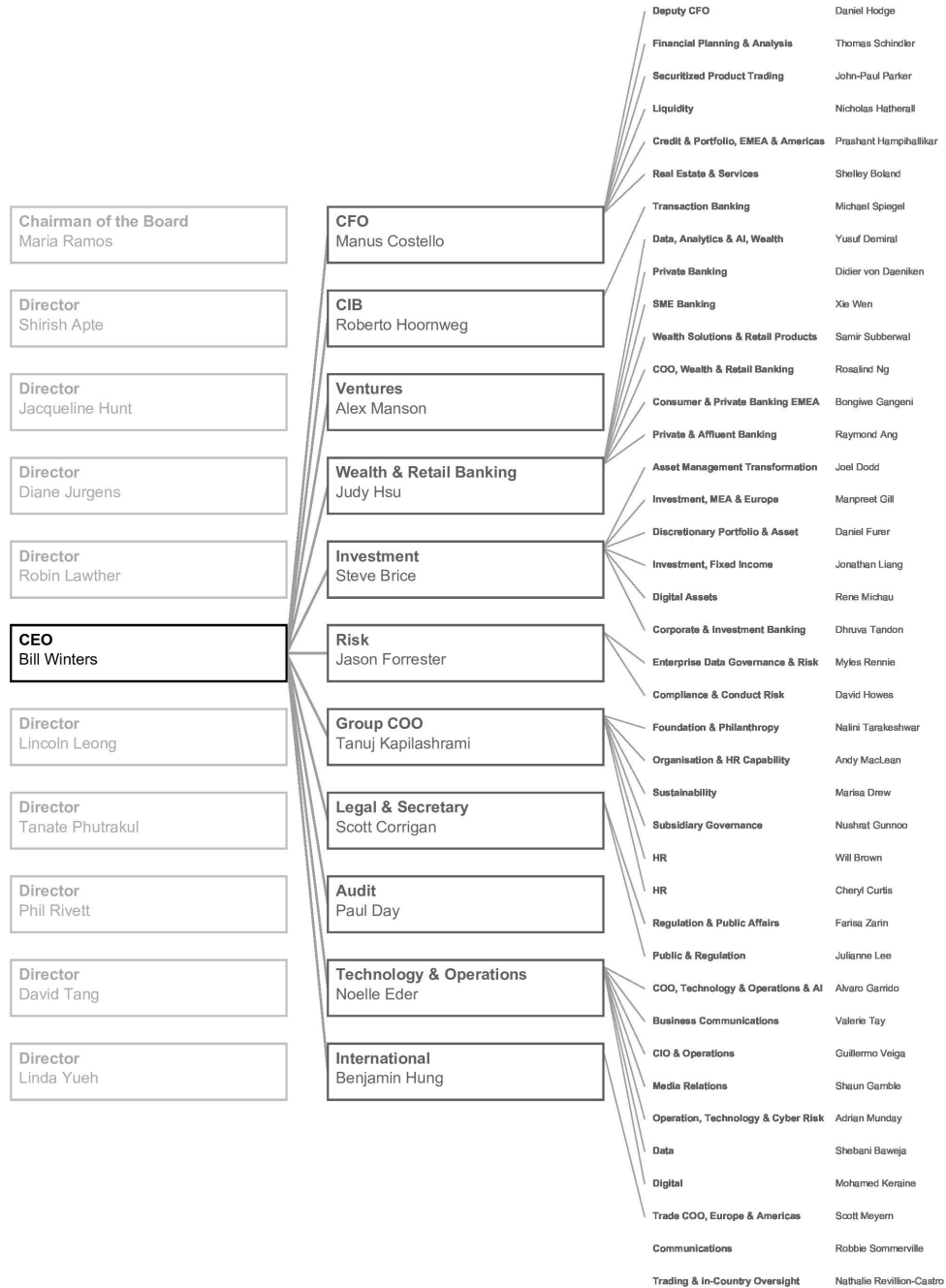
Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/michael-spiegel-32g72>

Name: Cheryl Curtis

Title: Head of Human Resources

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/cheryl-curtis-e1951>

Organizational Chart Standard Chartered



The Official Board as of Aug 17, 2026 4:00:53 AM - Know more at contact@theofficialboard.com

Standard Chartered Accelerates India's GCC Growth with its Global Banking Expertise and 25 Years of GCC Experience

Distributed by Contify.com

713 words

13 August 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * India's GCC market projected to reach US\$105 billion by 2030.
- * Bank supports GCC expansion with global banking expertise and local experience.
- * Standard Chartered operates own GCC in India for 25 years.

Original Press Release:

Bengaluru, Aug. 13 -- Standard Chartered PLC issued the following news release:

Standard Chartered convened industry leaders, policymakers and Global Capability Centre (GCC) executives at its GCC Conference in Bengaluru, to reaffirm its commitment to supporting the next phase of India's GCC growth story.

The event was graced by Dr. Manjula N, IAS, Secretary, Department of Electronics, Information Technology, Biotechnology and Science & Technology, Government of Karnataka, Tanuj Kapilashrami, Group Chief Operating Officer, Standard Chartered and P D Singh, Chief Executive Officer, India & South Asia, Standard Chartered, who shared perspectives on India's growing prominence as the world's preferred destination for global capability centres and the opportunities that lie ahead.

India today hosts the world's largest GCC ecosystem, attracting leading organisations to build capabilities beyond traditional service delivery. Industry estimates indicate that India's GCC market is projected to reach approximately US\$105 billion by 2030, reinforcing the country's position as the world's leading global capability hub. Further, with 183 new GCCs established during the first half of 2026 (as per industry estimates), India continues to strengthen its position as the preferred global destination for capability centre investments.

As organisations expand their GCC footprint, Standard Chartered supports their banking requirements through a connected banking experience spanning both offshore and onshore operations. Leveraging its international network, digital banking platforms and deep expertise in supporting treasury centres, cross-border corporates and evolving GCC operating models, Standard Chartered helps organisations simplify financial operations while supporting growth across global markets.

Speaking at the conference, Tanuj Kapilashrami, Group Chief Operating Officer, Standard Chartered said, "India's GCC story is entering a new phase; one defined by greater global ownership, innovation and strategic impact. As organisations build increasingly connected and enterprise-critical capability centres, they need partners that combine global banking expertise with first-hand operational experience. As the super-connector bank, Standard Chartered is uniquely positioned to support this next wave of GCC growth by bringing together global connectivity, deep local expertise and over 25 years of experience operating one of our own GCCs in India."

P D Singh, Chief Executive Officer, India & South Asia, Standard Chartered, added, "India's GCC story represents one of the most significant business opportunities globally today. As organisations look to build globally connected, innovation-led capability centres, they need a banking partner that understands both the operational realities of running a GCC and the financial complexities of scaling one across markets. Having operated our own GCC in India for over 25 years while partnering with leading multinational clients worldwide,

Standard Chartered brings a unique perspective that enables us to support clients throughout every stage of their GCC journey.”

Over the last few decades, GCCs have progressed from cost-efficient delivery centres to strategic enterprise hubs while driving critical business outcomes for global enterprises. As this transformation continues, Standard Chartered remains committed to enabling the next generation of GCCs, bringing deep expertise and firsthand insight shaped by its experience as both a banking operator to GCCs and the operator of one of its own.

Standard Chartered

Standard Chartered Bank has been operating in India with a continuous presence of over 165 years making it one of the oldest foreign banks in the country offering a full range of services across business segments including Corporate and Investment Banking and **Wealth** and Retail Banking. The Bank has an extensive branch network covering major cities. For more information, visit <https://www.sc.bank.in/>

Globally, we are a leading international banking group, with a presence in 55 of the world's most dynamic markets. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong stock exchanges.

[Category: Banking and Financial Services, Investment Banking, IT Services, Events and Conferences, Economic Performance and Projections]

Source: Standard Chartered PLC

Document ATINBK0020260814em8d000b7

business

Travelling abroad? HSBC makes all its credit cards zero-forex-markup for a month

439 words

13 August 2026

Moneycontrol.com

MONECT

English

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HSBC Prive Credit Card and HSBC RuPay Cashback Card already offer zero forex markup on all international purchases since its launch in 2024 and 2025, respectively

HSBC India has announced zero forex mark-up for all HSBC credit cards from 15 August 2026 to 15 September 2026 (both dates inclusive), aimed at providing better value for money to customers on international spending. The offer is extended across the entire HSBC credit card portfolio held by existing Indian residents.

The offer is valid on all HSBC credit cards, HSBC Premier Credit Card, HSBC Taj Credit Card, HSBC Live+ Credit Card, HSBC TravelOne Credit Card and HSBC Platinum Credit Card. HSBC Prive Credit Card and HSBC RuPay Cashback Card already offer zero forex markup on all international purchases since its launch in 2024 and 2025, respectively.

During the offer period, both merchant point-of-sale as well as online foreign currency transactions on eligible HSBC credit cards will carry zero forex markup, in addition to existing rewards and benefits. By removing the foreign exchange mark-up fee during the offer period, customers can benefit from lower costs on eligible international spends and easier budgeting, while continuing to enjoy existing card features and benefits.

Additionally, the bank also reiterated that HSBC credit card holders are not charged a Dynamic Currency Conversion (DCC) fee. Hence, HSBC customers who choose to pay in their home currency (INR) instead of the local currency, while travelling overseas avoid that additional cost too. This existing benefit continues to be a standing benefit across all HSBC credit cards.

Also read: [The hidden cost of reward points: Are you spending more to save more?](#)

Sandeep Batra, Head of International **Wealth** and Premier Banking, HSBC India, said, "At HSBC, we want our customers to get value on every international transaction whether they are travelling overseas, shopping on global websites, or paying for services overseas. By introducing zero forex mark-up across all HSBC Credit Cards, we are ensuring customers can spend internationally with greater clarity and value, while continuing to enjoy the rewards and benefits that are already built on their cards."

HSBC now has a network of 32 branches across 20 cities in India. HSBC has maintained a strong presence in India for over 170 years, supporting customers in their financial journeys both locally and globally.

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Document MONECT0020260813em8d000rt

Business

HSBC's global insurance arm chief resigns amid overhaul

ARJUN NEIL ALIM

308 words

13 August 2026

Financial Times

FTFTA

1; Main

10

English

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Banks

The head of one of HSBC's most important businesses has resigned, as the bank continues to overhaul its global operations and the industry grapples with uncertainties around a Beijing insurance-tax crackdown.

Edward Moncreiffe, global chief executive of HSBC's insurance arm, has left after more than two years in his current role and 20 years at the bank, according to a person familiar with the matter.

The move comes as Europe's largest bank presses on with an overhaul of its global portfolio, including in insurance, having recently announced the sale of its Singapore insurance business to Allianz for \$2.1bn and having sold its UK life insurer to Chesnara last year.

It also comes amid a period of uncertainty for insurance in Hong Kong. Reports of a possible tax crackdown on returns from insurance policies sold in the territory to mainland Chinese savers had alarmed the industry.

Insurance is a significant business line for HSBC and a key part of its drive to manage Chinese **wealth**.

The business recorded \$1.1bn in pretax profits in the first half of this year out of \$19.5bn for the whole bank globally, up 38 per cent compared with the same period last year.

HSBC, including its subsidiary Hang Seng, is one of the largest sellers of insurance in Hong Kong. Much of the sales come from mainland Chinese visitors who purchase life insurance policies that function similarly to long-term investment products.

The UK bank's shares fell as much as 6 per cent last week amid fears that Beijing's moves could make the products less attractive. Its shares are still up 30 per cent this year.

Analysts at Citigroup this month downgraded the bank from "buy" to "neutral".

HSBC declined to comment.

Document FTFTA00020260813em8d0006y

Top Stories

After a strong Q2, what's next for Singapore banks? Analysts see DBS, OCBC ahead on **wealth**

Tan Nai Lun
892 words
13 August 2026
Business Times Singapore
STBT
print
A1
English
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Analysts are increasingly split on the outlook for Singapore's three banks after their second-quarter results, as **wealth management** becomes a key differentiator in a lower interest rate environment.

They were more upbeat on DBS and OCBC as their strong **wealth management** performances were accompanied by a more positive broader earnings outlook.

UOB, meanwhile, faces questions over the execution of its **wealth** strategy, alongside persistent asset-quality concerns and a weaker fee income forecast.

Regardless, all three banks posted second-quarter net profits that beat market expectations. DBS had a 9 per cent on-year gain to S\$3.08 billion, OCBC posted a 22 per cent increase to S\$2.22 billion, while UOB's net profit climbed 10 per cent to S\$1.48 billion.

Higher non-interest income helped offset weaker net interest income across the trio. Even as **wealth** was a key driver for all three, UOB's gains were boosted by a non-recurring asset divestment.

Thilan Wickramasinghe, head of Singapore research and regional financials at Maybank Investment Banking Group, noted that DBS is "delivering on all fronts" and has managed to leverage growth engines across **wealth**, corporate banking, SME and trading, despite significant external uncertainty.

This gives "strong visibility" of the bank delivering more than 17 per cent return on equity in the medium term, which justifies the premium valuation, he said.

OCBC is also showing signs of strong execution in its pivot to capital-light led growth, said analysts.

"We like OCBC for the change in income mix," said Phillip Securities Research analyst Glenn Thum.

Non-interest income is 44 per cent of first-half income and **wealth** makes up 41 per cent, both driven by customer volume rather than rates, he noted.

Wealth should carry income as net interest margins stabilises amid slower treasury asset growth and firm interest rates, he added.

Furthermore, OCBC's private banking presence onshore in China may become its advantage against other global banks and fintechs, given current uncertainty surrounding China's regulatory directives on onshore **wealth**, Wickramasinghe said.

Meanwhile, UOB's execution of its **wealth** strategy is "still (in the) early days", he added.

While Q2 earnings beat expectations, he noted that it would have been a slight miss if it excluded the non-recurring asset disposal of S\$200 million.

"Operationally, UOB is at a building stage to extract deeper value from (its) consumer banking franchise," he said. "This may take time to gestate, and carries execution risks."

Growth in UOB's **wealth** momentum was also likely offset by renewed concerns around Greater China commercial real estate and a weaker broader fee outlook.

Goldman Sachs analysts Melissa Kuang and Wayne Wang expect credit costs to remain at the higher end of the bank's 25 to 30 basis point guidance for 2026, and be an overhang for the stock.

This comes as UOB's management expects that a full recovery in the Greater China commercial real estate market could still take several years, they said in a note.

Kuang and Wang were also "disappointed" by the downward revision to fee income guidance, particularly as peers have generally maintained or upgraded their guidance.

"The pressure on card fees is notable, given that cards remain one of the bank's largest fee income contributors and a key pillar of the Citi Asean acquisition story," they said.

Nevertheless, several analysts noted high valuations at DBS.

CGS International analyst Tay Wee Kuang downgraded DBS to "hold" from "buy" on Aug 6 following the results due to its share price outperformance year to date, even though yields remain attractive.

But many still kept their "buy" call on the counter. For Maybank's Wickramasinghe, DBS will likely continue to grow absolute ordinary dividends, while the unutilised S\$2.6 billion from the bank's share buy-back mandate could be paid as a special dividend.

The Goldman Sachs team also noted that **wealth** and fee momentum – combined with benign asset quality, ample provisioning buffers and strong capital – keeps a supportive earnings outlook for DBS.

Meanwhile, some analysts expect UOB could be a "value play", given its cheaper valuations.

The RHB Singapore research team said the valuation gap between UOB and the other two banks is "too wide to ignore", and upgraded their call on the counter to "buy" from "neutral".

Jayden Vantarakis, head of Asean equity research at Macquarie Capital, also noted in an Aug 7 note that UOB was trading at around a 48 per cent discount to peers.

Regardless, Vantarakis expects the bank needs to produce a clean quarter with improving **wealth** momentum and contained asset quality to start closing the gap.

As for OCBC, analysts noted the bank's upbeat outlook.

Wickramasinghe, who has a "buy" call on the counter, expects OCBC could post return on equity of 14 per cent by 2028, from 12.6 per cent in 2025.

"An accelerating return on equity trajectory and a supportive yield deserves a higher valuation," he said.

On Wednesday, shares of DBS fell S\$1.14 to close at S\$75.85, OCBC dropped S\$0.17 to end at S\$31.19, while UOB was down S\$0.21 at S\$41.95.

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Document STBT000020260813em8d0000f

THE STRAITS TIMES

Business

DBS, OCBC shares could go higher; asset quality fears resurface at UOB

Sheila Chiang

1,044 words

13 August 2026

The Straits Times

STIMES

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A18

English

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DBS Bank and OCBC Bank shares have hit fresh highs but could climb further, while asset quality concerns at UOB could affect near-term profitability, analysts said.

This comes after the three Singapore banks reported second-quarter profit growth, with **wealth management** and other fee income offsetting pressure on lending margins.

Saxo chief investment strategist Charu Chanana said Singapore banks are no longer simply a proxy for interest rates. They are becoming regional **wealth** platforms – and that may prove to be the more durable investment story, she said.

DBS closed 1.5 per cent lower at \$75.85 on Aug 12, while OCBC dipped 0.5 per cent to close at \$31.19.

Both banks raised their targets.

UOB's shares closed 0.5 per cent lower at \$41.95.

The bank last week flagged a large non-performing asset linked to a real estate account in Greater China, kept its 2026 guidance largely unchanged and cut its fee-income growth target.

Upbeat on DBS and OCBC

Analysts were upbeat about DBS' strong second-quarter earnings and its raised targets for the year.

The bank expects total income for 2026 to exceed 2025 levels, upgrading its previous flat-growth forecast, among other targets.

RHB raised its price target for DBS to \$81.20 from \$75.70 on Aug 7, while maintaining its "buy" call on the stock.

RHB and CGSI expect DBS to pay higher dividends at the end of 2027, funded by unutilised excess capital of \$2.6 billion from its \$3 billion share buyback programme.

Macquarie head of ASEAN equity research Jayden Vantarakis on Aug 6 raised DBS' price target to \$80.74 from \$70.86.

CGSI, however, downgraded DBS to "hold" from a "buy" on Aug 6, while keeping its price target unchanged at \$77.10, as the stock's strong gains so far in 2026 have reduced its upside potential.

Analysts are positive on OCBC, too.

RHB kept its "buy" rating on OCBC while raising its price target to \$32.85 from \$29.80 after the bank reported a record quarter and upgraded its guidance.

OCBC raised its 2026 financial targets, including total income growth, from its previous stable-to-growing outlook.

Chanana of Saxo said that OCBC arguably delivered the best current balance of earnings momentum, diversification and operating efficiency among the Singapore banks.

Fee income, **wealth**, trading and insurance all contributed to its strong second-quarter earnings.

"Its earnings growth was broad rather than reliant on one source. That diversification is particularly valuable as net interest margins (NIMs) fall because OCBC has more earnings engines available to absorb the pressure," she said.

Macquarie maintained an "outperform" rating with a price target of \$27.76, as second-quarter loan growth and income from insurance and trading exceeded the research house's estimates.

CGSI reiterated its "hold" call while lifting its price target to \$29.80 from \$28.40, assuming a higher return on equity from OCBC's integration of its **wealth** and insurance businesses.

But CGSI sees limited room for net interest income to grow in the second half of the year, as lower asset yields continue to weigh on margins.

OCBC also noted slowing investment activity in July, which could translate into softer non-interest income growth in the second half, said CGSI.

Mixed outlook on UOB

Citi Research downgraded UOB to "sell" from "neutral" on Aug 11, with a target price of \$38. Analyst Tan Yong Hong noted that NIM expectations should be tempered as fixed-rate assets reprice at lower rates.

It comes as OCBC Group Research downgraded the stock to "hold" from "buy" on Aug 6, even as it raised its fair-value estimate to \$42.35 from \$41.

The downgrade reflected limited upside in UOB shares, with OCBC head of equity research Carmen Lee saying "the share price is now trading close to our valuation".

CGSI maintained its "hold" call on UOB at a \$42.60 target price, citing asset quality concerns that have resurfaced.

"We believe elevated credit costs will continue to drag UOB's near-term profitability," said CGSI analyst Tay Wee Kuang.

UOB's new non-performing assets hit \$902 million in the second quarter, up 90 per cent year on year due to one real estate account in Greater China. UOB said adequate provisions have been pre-emptively set aside to buffer against this exposure.

In the third quarter of 2025, UOB had also reported a surge in allowances for credit and other losses to \$1.36 billion – including \$615 million in pre-emptive general provisions – causing net profit to plunge 72 per cent year on year to \$443 million.

Total credit costs normalised in the fourth quarter, falling to 19 basis points from the previous quarter's 134 basis points. Total allowances halved on lower specific allowances.

Not all analysts are bearish on UOB.

RHB noted positively that UOB is comfortable with its coverage and expects non-performing assets to trend lower from here.

It upgraded its rating on UOB to "buy" and lifted the price target to \$46.60 from \$41.30 as the valuation gap versus its peers' is "too wide and should narrow".

Vantarakis said that while UOB's eight-basis-point quarter-on-quarter net interest margin decline was the largest among its peers, he is maintaining an "outperform" rating at a price target of \$45.16.

UOB's **wealth** fee income rose 29 per cent year on year, driving overall fee growth of 5 per cent year on year. Other income from disposals of assets – namely Novena Square and 230 Orchard Road – boosted total revenues, he noted.

Saxo's Chanana said that while UOB lags its peers on several metrics, it could still attract value-oriented investors who seek ASEAN growth optionality and are willing to accept weaker current profitability and higher execution risk while waiting for the regional franchise to deliver.

"UOB offers the strongest direct ASEAN expansion story and is moving towards a more capital-light distribution model," she said. A prime example is UOB's Aug 5 announcement that it would sell its asset management business to Allianz Global Investors for \$555 million.

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Document STIMES0020260813em8d0000s

News

HSBC rejigs insurance unit after CEO resigns

Enoch Yiu

493 words

13 August 2026

South China Morning Post

SCMP

A2

English

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Two Asia-based executives will replace outgoing global division head Edward Moncreiffe, internal memo reveals

HSBC, the biggest lender in Hong Kong and Europe, has launched a major reshuffle of its insurance unit, with two senior executives appointed to replace outgoing global insurance CEO Edward Moncreiffe, according to an internal company memo seen by the South China Morning Post.

Daisy Tsang, CEO of HSBC Life Hong Kong, and Kai Zhang, Asia head of international **wealth** and premier banking, had been named co-CEOs of insurance, effective immediately, the memo stated. The pair would continue to undertake their current responsibilities in addition to their new roles, it said.

The reshuffle came as Moncreiffe resigned from HSBC “to pursue external opportunities”, according to the memo, which was jointly issued by Barry O’Byrne, CEO of international **wealth** and premier banking, and the lender’s co-CEOs for Asia and the Middle East, David Liao Yi-chien and Surendra Rosha.

The departure of Moncreiffe has taken the market by surprise, as insurance and **wealth management** are key focuses of HSBC’s expansion plans. Its global **wealth management** arm saw revenue jump 18 per cent in the first half of 2026, while its insurance business grew 32 per cent, according to results announced last week.

“Insurance is integral to delivering our strength to become the leading international **wealth** manager for affluent to ultra- high-net-worth clients in key markets and corridors,” the memo said. “We’re confident that under Daisy and Kai’s combined leadership, we’ll continue to build on our strong momentum and deliver even better outcomes for our customers.”

Tsang began her insurance career with HSBC in 2000, rising to become CEO of HSBC Life in Hong Kong in 2024. Zhang was previously president and CEO of Manulife- Sinochem Life Insurance on the mainland for seven years before joining HSBC as head of **wealth** and personal banking for South and Southeast Asia in 2023. She took up her current role in 2024.

The pair will have to steer HSBC’s insurance division through a challenging period for the industry, as Beijing steps up controls over wealthy mainland families’ use of cross-border **wealth** and insurance products. Authorities began levying a 20 per cent tax on gains from offshore insurance policies as part of that push earlier this month.

The reshuffle came a month after HSBC agreed to sell its Singapore life and health insurance business to Germany’s Allianz for S\$2.7 billion (HK\$16.5 billion), with the deal expected to be completed in 2027. The disposal was expected to generate a pre-tax gain of US\$1.8 billion, the bank said.

Moncreiffe, who was with HSBC for 20 years, led the company to become a market leader, with the largest market share in terms of new life insurance policy premiums over the past four years.

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Document SCMP000020260812em8d0000m

Brokers

OCBC goes mobile on platinum and palladium trading

Stuart Fieldhouse

625 words

12 August 2026

thearmchairtrader.com

THEA065

English

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Singapore bank OCBC is making platinum trading available to clients through its mobile app, but there is a bigger plan afoot.

Asian **wealth** manager OCBC is making platinum and palladium available to ordinary retail investors through its mobile app. The minimum purchase – 0.01 ounce – is tiny. At recent prices, that means roughly S\$23 for platinum and S\$18 for palladium. The bigger significance is that Singapore's second-largest lender is turning two specialist commodities into mass-market **wealth** products.

The move extends OCBC's digital precious-metals offering beyond gold and silver, which have been available to retail clients since 2021. It also brings assets that banks have traditionally reserved for affluent customers within reach of a much broader audience.

The strategy is straightforward: fractional ownership plus a smartphone interface lowers the psychological and financial barrier to entry. For a bank seeking a larger share of customers' investment wallets, that is useful. The harder question is whether investors need more platinum and palladium exposure in the first place.

Why trade platinum?

Unlike gold, whose price is heavily influenced by its role as a store of value and by central-bank demand, platinum and palladium are predominantly industrial metals. Platinum is used in vehicles, industrial processes and hydrogen fuel-cell technologies. Palladium is particularly important in vehicle emissions-control systems. That makes their investment case more cyclical and potentially more volatile.

OCBC's own research is bullish. It expects platinum to exceed US\$2,000 an ounce and palladium to top US\$1,500 in the first half of 2027, from US\$1,833 and US\$1,389 respectively at the end of June 2026.

Those forecasts offer an obvious marketing hook. But the same industrial exposure that creates upside also makes these metals less obvious portfolio substitutes for gold. Their fortunes depend on automotive demand, industrial activity and the energy transition, while supply is concentrated across relatively few producing regions. That combination can produce price movements that diverge sharply from precious metals more familiar to retail investors.

OCBC acknowledges as much. Tan Siew Lee, its head of group **wealth management**, describes platinum and palladium as "high-beta metals". Investors with a tolerance for greater volatility may use them to gain exposure to resource scarcity, industrial demand and the global energy transition. That is a different proposition from buying gold as insurance against uncertainty.

OCBC's **wealth management** strategy

The expansion nevertheless fits neatly with OCBC's broader **wealth-management** strategy. The bank says adoption of its existing digital metals platform has been strong: the number of customers investing in gold and silver through the app was 2.5 times higher in 2025 than a year earlier, with demand remaining resilient during periods of volatility in 2026.

That suggests there is already a customer habit to build on. Once investors are comfortable buying fractions of a metal through an app, adding two more commodities is a relatively cheap way to broaden the product shelf. For OCBC, the real asset may therefore be the customer relationship rather than the bullion.

The competitive advantage of a bank in digital **wealth management** is increasingly less about offering a unique asset and more about making multiple assets easy to access. Fractional trading helps turn commodities from specialist purchases into another line on an investment screen.

There is a risk, though, that convenience obscures complexity. A S\$23 minimum purchase makes platinum feel as accessible as a stock or ETF, but its price drivers are anything but simple. OCBC is betting that retail investors want that complexity and in small, tradable pieces. For the bank, the bet is modest. For the metals, retail access could be more consequential.

Document THEA065020260820em8c0000c

Stock Market: Vietnam Wealth Management Market Shifts from Products to Client Advisory

165 words

12 August 2026

Vietnam News Brief Service

VIETNB

English

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HSBC Vietnam's senior **wealth management** director, Ranganath Ananth, said the country's asset management market is entering a new phase where clients increasingly seek long-term planning over simple product advice.

Vietnam had about 19,000 USD millionaires by the end of 2023, nearly double a decade ago, and total **wealth** is forecast to grow 125% by 2034, he said. Most **wealth** is first-generation, built through entrepreneurship, real estate and business growth, creating demand for portfolio diversification, risk management, education planning and succession.

"Trust is the foundation," Ananth said, adding that clients will only diversify when they believe the financial institution is strong, transparent and consistent. He called for a shift from product distribution to a planning-centered approach that starts with goals, time horizon and risk tolerance.

Ananth said the most valuable contribution to wealthy families in Vietnam is not just access but the confidence to make sound, sustainable decisions.

Document VIETNB0020260813em8c00077

Global recognition for HSBC manager

By Natasha Baluchi, natasha@allisland.media

238 words

12 August 2026

The Jersey Evening Post

JERPO

English

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A TOTAL of eleven employees from across HSBC Channel Islands and the Isle of Man were represented at the bank's annual global recognition awards, with two employees receiving special commendation.

Charlie Ovenden, area premier relationship manager at HSBC in Jersey, won the Global People Leader Award, receiving special recognition at HSBC's Circle of Excellence event, held last month in Kuala Lumpur.

She was one of just seven global winners, selected from 360 overall attendees from across the bank.

Jersey-based James Bacon, premier relationship director, was a runner-up in the Customer Centricity Award.

The Circle of Excellence is HSBC's global recognition programme for the top 1% to 2% of customer-facing employees across its global international **wealth** and premier banking business, celebrating those who deliver exceptional service and customer experience across the bank.

The theme this year was Celebrate. Connect. Grow, a four-day event with a mix of business breakout sessions and experiences designed to connect employees to "something bigger".

Alvaro Teixeira, head of international **wealth** and premier banking, Channel Islands and Isle of Man, said: "Attending the Circle of Excellence is already a major achievement. Winning a global award is an even greater distinction.

"Congratulations to Charlie, as well as James and all 11 colleagues from Jersey, Guernsey and the Isle of Man for making

it into the Circle of Excellence."

Document JERPO00020260813em8c0000v

RAM Ratings assigns first-time AAA rating to Great Eastern Labuan Company Limited

Distributed by Contify.com

459 words

12 August 2026

Islamic Finance News - Contify

ATISFN

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Rating reflects 'very high' likelihood of parental support from Great Eastern Holdings Limited (GEH).
- * GELL's strategic role as offshore life insurance and reinsurance platform for GEH.
- * GELL's profitability from inception, driven by reinsurance treaty with Great Eastern Life Assurance (Malaysia) Berhad (GELM).

Original Press Release:

Aug. 12 -- RAM Rating Services Berhad issued the following news release:

RAM Ratings has assigned AAA/Stable/P1 insurer financial strength ratings to Great Eastern Labuan Company Limited (GELL or the Insurer), a wholly owned subsidiary of Great Eastern Holdings Limited (GEH or the Group). GEH is a leading insurance group in Singapore and Malaysia and is 93.7%-owned by Overseas-Chinese Banking Corporation Limited (OCBC Ltd).

The ratings are aligned with GEH's, reflecting a 'very high' likelihood of extraordinary parental support given the Insurer's strategic role as the Group's offshore life insurance and reinsurance platform, and strong operational and governance linkages with the Group. Incorporated in July 2025, GELL complements the Group's broader protection and **wealth** proposition through foreign-currency solutions while supporting the Group's asset-liability management objectives through reinsurance activities. GELL also benefits from shared back-office infrastructure and group oversight of key functions including risk management, treasury and capital management, which reduces execution risk associated with newly established insurers.

While GELL's standalone credit profile is constrained by its limited operating history and the lack of a track record in offshore life insurance, these are partly mitigated by GEH's extensive expertise and execution capabilities in **wealth** solutions and life protection products. The Insurer's earnings will initially be driven by its reinsurance treaty with Great Eastern Life Assurance (Malaysia) Berhad (GELM), which provides a stable earnings base and helps mitigate the impact of reserving requirements and acquisition costs that typically weigh on the earnings of early-stage insurers. This enables profitability from inception, although earnings performance will remain dependent on GELL's ability to scale the offshore life business while maintaining underwriting and pricing discipline.

Currency and asset-liability duration mismatches are also key risks, as the Insurer lengthens the duration of the inward-reinsured ringgit-denominated portfolio with foreign assets. These risks are mitigated by hedging strategies, active duration-gap monitoring and group-level oversight of asset-liability management.

GELL expects to maintain healthy capital buffers, with its capital adequacy ratio staying comfortably above internal and supervisory target capital levels as the business grows (end-March 2026: 300%-350%). We anticipate growth to be measured, supported by technical resources from its sister company GELM, which has a strong operating track record.

[Category: Insurance, Credit Rating Updates]

Source: RAM Rating Services Berhad

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Banking group offers help with resilience

Rupert Metcalf

387 words

12 August 2026

Western Morning News

WMN

1ST

20

English

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Prolonged dry conditions and periods of heat stress are changing the way farmers across the UK are running their businesses, HSBC UK has acknowledged.

Weather conditions are creating operational and financial pressures for farming businesses in many regions nationwide, with the greatest impact being felt in parts of the South, the Midlands and the East of England.

HSBC UK's agriculture team reports that the current weather pattern is likely to cause working capital pressure later in the year. It is affecting decisions around production, inputs and forward planning.

At the same time, many farmers in the UK are increasing investment in infrastructure and/or alternative crop types, including using more heat-tolerant and drought-tolerant varieties, to build resilience against drier conditions, the banking group has recognised.

To help manage these pressures, many farmers have been and continue to diversify their income streams, both inside and outside agricultural systems, the group recognises. Some are reducing reliance on a single crop or farming type, helping to protect revenues through a more varied business model.

Martin Hanson, Head of Agriculture at HSBC UK, said: "Farming businesses are used to managing uncertainty, but the frequency and intensity of extreme weather are making resilience an everyday commercial priority. We're seeing real pressure. Arable yields and quality are impacted in many areas, and livestock producers are facing earlier forage use and higher supplementary feed costs.

"No two farms are the same. For some, the priority is short-term cash flow support to manage through a difficult season. For others, it's about planning and investing to strengthen the business for the years ahead – whether that's water, soils, technology or infrastructure that helps reduce exposure to heat and drought. Our role is to be a long-term partner to UK agriculture, supporting customers to invest with confidence, whatever the weather."

Eligible farmers can access HSBC UK's Sustainable Farming Pathway through HSBC UK's agricultural banking team, with eligibility aligned to participating sustainability schemes.

HSBC UK serves over 15 million active customers across the UK, supported by over 23,000 colleagues. HSBC UK offers a complete range of retail banking and **wealth management** to personal and private banking customers, as well as commercial banking for small to medium businesses and large corporates.

Document WMN0000020260812em8c00013

COMPANIES & MARKETS

OCBC opens up in-app platinum, palladium trading to retail investors

Shikhar Gupta
432 words
12 August 2026
Business Times Singapore
STBT
print
A6
English
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OCBC has expanded the precious metals trading capabilities on its mobile application, allowing retail investors to trade platinum and palladium bullion.

Starting from Tuesday (Aug 11), mass retail customers can digitally invest in platinum and palladium starting from a minimum of 0.01 ounce. Based on pricing from Friday, this micro-investing threshold translates to about S\$23 for platinum and S\$18 for palladium.

The new offerings build upon the bank's digital gold and silver trading features, which were introduced to retail clients in October 2021.

They also democratise access to assets that local banks have traditionally reserved for affluent clients.

OCBC Group Research maintains a bullish outlook for both metals, forecasting spot prices for platinum to exceed US\$2,000 and palladium to top US\$1,500 by the first half of 2027.

Prices stood at US\$1,833 and US\$1,389, respectively, at the end of June 2026.

Unlike gold, which is heavily influenced by central bank reserves and its status as a store of value, platinum and palladium are largely driven by industrial applications.

Platinum is a key material in automotive manufacturing, industrial processes and hydrogen fuel cell technologies, while palladium is critical for vehicle emissions-control systems.

Because demand for these metals is tethered to the automotive, industrial and clean energy sectors – coupled with highly concentrated global supply chains – their price movements often diverge from those of gold and silver.

Lower barrier to entry

The inclusion of platinum and palladium is part of a broader strategy by Singapore's second-largest lender to lower the threshold for retail investors.

Tan Siew Lee, head of group **wealth management** at OCBC, stated that combining fractional investment with a digital interface lowers the barrier to entry for all customers.

"We are strengthening our position as a leading **wealth management** player and as the go-to bank for precious metals," she said.

However, Tan also highlighted the risk profile of the new assets, noting that platinum and palladium are high-beta metals.

She added that investors willing to tolerate higher volatility might use these metals to gain exposure to themes intersecting resource scarcity, industrial activity and the global energy transition.

OCBC added that it has seen robust adoption of its existing digital metals platform.

In 2025, the number of customers investing in gold and silver via the app was up 2.5 times year on year, with demand remaining resilient through periods of heightened volatility in 2026, the bank said.

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Document STBT000020260812em8c0000f



HK a 'treasure trove of international **wealth**': HSBC

289 words

12 August 2026

The Standard

HKIMAL

English

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Staff reporter

HSBC's (0005) co-chief executive of Asia and the Middle East David Liao Yi-chien described Hong Kong as a treasure trove of international **wealth**, saying the city's financial industry serves far more than over seven million local citizens, as it also caters to substantial capital from the mainland, the Middle East, Europe, and the United States.

Hong Kong is the largest global **wealth management** center, while its fundraising amount in the initial public offering market for the first half ranked second globally, he said. Liao added that these achievements mark only the start, with significant potential for future growth.

He pointed out that as a leading offshore yuan business hub, Hong Kong processes about 75 percent of global offshore yuan payments and settlements.

In terms of gold trading, HSBC plans to expand its physical gold storage capabilities to 200 tons in Hong Kong to support the government's broader 1,000-tonne storage hub vision, Liao noted.

On the privatization of the Hang Seng Bank, Liao said this marked one of the biggest mergers in the Hong Kong banking sector, representing HSBC's confidence in the city.

Also, the group will integrate digital assets and digital currency into Hong Kong's financial system and actively plan for the establishment of an artificial intelligence research institute in the city, he said.

As HSBC earlier lifted Hong Kong's full-year economic growth forecast to 4.5 percent, Liao noted that the bank holds a positive view on Hong Kong's macroeconomic outlook, adding that the city's "One Country, Two Systems" framework can enhance stability in Asian economic growth amid a reshaping global geopolitical landscape.

Source : The Standard.

Document HKIMAL0020260811em8c00002

HSBC Holdings Plc

MarketLine Company Profiles, 11 August 2026, 18184 words, (English)

HSBC Holdings PlcHSBC Holdings Plc (HSBC) is a global banking and financial services group. The group engages in a wide range of financial activities, including retail banking, wealth management, commercial banking, and investment banking. ...

Standard Chartered and Allianz Global Investors Launch Gold Income Fund

544 words

11 August 2026

08:00

MarketLine News and Comment

DTMNTR

English

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Standard Chartered announced the launch of its ninth Variable Capital Company (VCC) sub-fund, with Allianz Global Investors appointed as sub-manager.

Standard Chartered ("the Bank") today announced the launch of its ninth sub-fund under its Variable Capital Company (VCC) platform, with Allianz Global Investors ("AllianzGI") as the sub-manager. The launch further expands the Bank's suite of exclusive, custom-curated investment strategies available to eligible clients.

The Signature Select Enhanced Gold Income Fund offers investors a unique combination of gold exposure and enhanced income generation. Through investments in gold exchange-traded funds (ETFs) and a covered call strategy, the fund seeks to deliver regular income while maintaining participation in the long-term appreciation potential of gold. Gold, a well-regarded alternative asset known for its low correlation with traditional asset classes, can help diversify portfolios and provide resilience during periods of geopolitical, monetary and market uncertainty.

As a global asset manager with more than 700 investment professionals worldwide (as at 31 March 2026), AllianzGI brings scale, breadth and institutional strength to the fund. AllianzGI's Global Multi Asset Team, who will be responsible for the options selection and the day-to-day management of the portfolio, has strong credentials and deep expertise in portfolio construction and derivatives implementation and risk management, supported by extensive experience managing multi-asset portfolios across market cycles.

The fund is available to Accredited and Professional Investors across Standard Chartered's Priority, Priority Private and Private Banking segments in Hong Kong, Singapore, the UAE, Jersey, Kenya and Nigeria from this month, with Taiwan to follow later this year.

Sumeet Bhambri, Global Head, Advisory and Managed Investments, **Wealth** Solutions, Standard Chartered, said: "We are pleased to partner with Allianz Global Investors, whose global investment expertise strengthens our latest VCC fund. As clients seek greater diversification amid an increasingly uncertain market environment, the fund provides access to a differentiated strategy that combines gold's portfolio diversification benefits with enhanced income potential. The launch reflects our commitment to enhancing our **wealth** platform through strategic partnerships and delivering innovative solutions that support clients on their **wealth** journey, while reinforcing Standard Chartered's position as a leading international **wealth** manager."

Marc Gualandi, Head of Global Banks, Allianz Global Investors, said: "We are delighted to partner with Standard Chartered to bring the Signature Select Enhanced Gold Income Fund to clients across its international **wealth** network. We believe gold can play an important role as a long-term allocation within a well-diversified portfolio. The fund is designed to participate in gold's long-term value proposition and generate income through an active options strategy. Leveraging our expertise in income strategies, portfolio construction and risk management, we seek to help investors pursue both income and long-term portfolio resilience."

Standard Chartered set up its VCC platform in June 2024 to harness synergies between the industry's leading fund managers and the Bank's team of global asset class specialists, delivering hard-to-access, custom-curated investment strategies exclusively to the Bank's clients and reinforcing its commitment to enhancing **wealth** solutions through strategic partnerships. This is the Bank's ninth sub-fund launched to date, and its fourth fund launch in 2026.

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Document DTMNTR0020260814em8b0006c

UOB and Allianz Global Investors Form Strategic Distribution Partnership as AGI Acquires UOB Asset Management

743 words

11 August 2026

08:00

MarketLine News and Comment

DTMNTR

English

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UOB Group has agreed to the sale of UOB Asset Management to Allianz Global Investors, covering UOBAM's operations in eight Asian markets.

UOB Group has entered into an agreement for Allianz Global Investors (AGI) to acquire UOB Asset Management (UOBAM). The acquisition by AGI will cover UOBAM's operations in eight Asian markets: Singapore, Brunei, Indonesia, Japan, Malaysia, Taiwan, Thailand, and Vietnam. As part of the agreement, UOB and AGI will establish a long-term strategic sales partnership. This will strengthen UOB's role as an open-architecture asset management distributor, expand the investment solutions it offers to clients, and enhance its advisory-driven approach to supporting clients' long-term **wealth** building and preservation.

Through this strategic partnership, UOB will collaborate with AGI to curate and expand its range of investment products and solutions for its more than 8 million clients in Asia. This partnership is based on UOB's open architecture strategy, enabling it to leverage its broad investment capabilities while focusing on advice, suitability, and long-term results for its clients. It will also support UOB's **wealth management** growth objectives by expanding client choices and providing diversified solutions tailored to each client's investment profile, life stage, and financial goals.

Subject to obtaining necessary regulatory approvals in all relevant markets, this transaction is expected to close in 2027. UOBAM and AGI are committed to ensuring business continuity and a smooth transition for all customers and employees. As part of this agreement, all 500 of UOBAM's current employees in the region will transfer to AGI. AGI is committed to retaining and continuing employment and will offer employees the opportunity to become part of a larger global investment platform. During this transition period, UOBAM's operations will continue as usual. Customers will be able to access, invest in, and redeem UOBAM funds as before, and there will be no disruption to services.

Excluding one-time transaction costs, this transaction, valued at S\$555 million, is expected to generate pre-tax profits of approximately S\$330 million and increase the Group's CET1 ratio by an estimated 14 basis points. This transaction is part of the Group's ongoing efforts to advance its strategic priorities. By realizing value in its asset management business and maintaining strategic alignment through long-term partnerships, the Group will further strengthen its **wealth management** business foundation, drive sustainable earnings growth, and enhance long-term shareholder value.

Having been part of the UOB Group for 40 years, UOBAM has grown into one of the region's leading asset management companies, operating across Asia. As of December 31, 2025, its total assets under management were approximately S\$42 billion. Based on the unaudited pro forma consolidated balance sheets of UOBAM and its subsidiaries as of December 31, 2025, the net asset value attributable to the sale of equity was S\$223 million.

Wee Ee Cheong, Vice Chairman and CEO of UOB, stated: "UOB serves more than 8 million clients across ASEAN, and their asset management and investment needs are becoming increasingly diverse and sophisticated. This partnership will further strengthen our focus on **wealth management** advisory and sales. Combining UOB's advisory expertise and client relationships with Allianz Global Investors' investment capabilities will enable us to meet our clients' evolving needs and support their long-term **wealth** building goals. This will accelerate the growth of our asset management business while also enhancing long-term shareholder value. During this transition period, our top priority is maintaining continuity for our clients and employees. We thank the UOBAM management team and employees for their dedicated contributions over the past 40 years in building a trusted regional asset management business."

Tobias Pross, CEO of Allianz Global Investors, stated: "This transaction marks a significant milestone in Allianz Global Investors' growth in the Asia Pacific region. By combining UOB Asset Management's extensive investment expertise in Southeast Asia with our global active investment platform, we will build a stronger business structure, enhance our ability to serve clients across the region, and offer a wider range of innovative **wealth management** and post-retirement solutions. Importantly, today's announcement establishes a long-term sales partnership between Allianz Global Investors and UOB, a trusted financial institution serving millions of clients across Southeast Asia. By leveraging each other's strengths and expanding our market reach, we will further deepen and develop our relationship with our clients together."

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Document DTMNTR0020260812em8b000ff

OCBC expands precious metals offering with Platinum and Palladium on the OCBC app

Distributed by Contify.com

837 words

11 August 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* OCBC expanded its digital Precious Metals offering to include platinum and palladium bullion, alongside gold and silver.

* Retail access: Customers can invest digitally from 0.01 ounces, costing about S\$23 for platinum and S\$18 for palladium as of 7 August 2026.

* Price outlook: OCBC Group Research forecasts platinum above US\$2,000/oz and palladium above US\$1,500/oz by H1 2027, versus US\$1,833 and US\$1,389, respectively, at end-June 2026.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Aug. 11 -- OCBC Bank issued the following news release:

At a glance

* Retail investors can now trade platinum and palladium on the OCBC app, in addition to gold and silver.

* Platinum and palladium offer investors further diversification opportunities within precious metals as an asset class.

* This builds on OCBC's **wealth management** capabilities to make investing accessible through lower entry points and widened access to a range of asset classes.

OCBC has expanded the Precious Metals offering on its mobile app to include platinum and palladium bullion, providing retail customers with a lower entry point and greater choice to diversify within the asset class. These new additions build on the Bank's existing digital gold and silver capabilities, which have been available to retail customers since October 2021.

Despite being globally traded precious metals, access to platinum and palladium through the local banks has been limited to affluent customers. OCBC now enables mass retail customers to invest in platinum and palladium bullion digitally from as little as 0.01 ounces, priced at about S\$23 for platinum and S\$18 for palladium as of 7 August 2026.

Unique demand and supply dynamics

While demand for gold tends to be driven by its role as a currency-neutral store of value asset, and by central bank buying for reserves, platinum and palladium derive a significant portion of their demand from industrial applications.

Platinum is widely used in automotive manufacturing, hydrogen fuel cell technologies and industrial processes, while palladium plays a critical role in vehicle emissions-control systems. Demand for these metals is therefore closely linked to developments in the automotive, industrial and clean energy sectors. Combined with the concentration of global supply in a handful of countries, these factors can drive price movements that differ from those of gold and silver, exposing investors to a broader set of market influences.

OCBC Group Research forecasts spot prices of platinum and palladium to exceed US\$2,000 and US\$1,500 respectively by the first half of 2027 – up from US\$1833 and US\$1389 as of end-June this year.

Ms Tan Siew Lee, Head of Group **Wealth Management**, OCBC, said, "We are strengthening our position as a leading **wealth management** player and as the go-to bank for precious metals. By combining fractional investment with a seamless digital experience, we have lowered the barrier to entry for investing in precious metals for all our customers.

It is nonetheless important to recognise that platinum and palladium are high-beta metals. Investors who are willing to tolerate higher volatility may find in them a unique way to gain exposure to themes that sit at the intersection of industrial activity, resource scarcity, and the evolving global energy transition."

Broadening investments for retail investors

The addition of platinum and palladium to OCBC's Precious Metals Account builds on the Bank's efforts to make investing more accessible, lowering entry barriers and widening access to a range of asset classes through the OCBC app.

Since October 2021, OCBC customers have been able to trade gold and silver paper bullion in real time via the OCBC app, with a minimum investment of just 0.01 ounces. Investor participation has grown steadily. In 2025, the number of customers investing in gold and silver through the platform increased 2.5 times year-on-year, while demand has remained resilient in 2026 despite periods of heightened volatility and sharp price corrections in both metals.

Beyond precious metals, OCBC has made investing accessible across a wider range of investment products on the OCBC app. Customers can invest in structured deposits with a minimum placement of S\$1,000, the lowest entry point in the market. Customers can also build diversified portfolios through the OCBC Blue Chip Investment Plan (BCIP) and OCBC RoboInvest, which offer regular investments in selected Singapore stocks, exchange-traded funds, and themed portfolios, with monthly contributions starting from as little as S\$100 for BCIP and US\$100 for OCBC RoboInvest.

How to buy platinum or palladium on the OCBC app:

1. Log in to the OCBC app > select Investments > Precious Metals
2. See real-time pricing of precious metals, select 'Buy'
3. Specify the quantity to be purchased and select the funding account
4. Confirm the investment purchase details
5. Purchase is completed and visible in the Precious Metals Account

[Category: Asset and **Wealth Management**, Investment Banking, Metals and Mining, New Offerings]

Source: OCBC Bank

Document ATINBK0020260811em8b000mu

Standard Chartered Survey Reveals Affluent Hongkongers See 'Immersive Travel' as Life Goal

Distributed by Contify.com

1,455 words

11 August 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* Travel as investment: More than 50% view travel as an investment; this rises to 72% among high-net-worth individuals. Nearly one-third spend more annually on travel than on discretionary categories such as dining, entertainment and fashion.

* Travel spending: Average monthly travel expenditure among high-net-worth respondents is nearly HK\$30,000.

* Lifestyle priorities: Nearly 50% consider immersive travel a life goal, more than twice the share prioritising property ownership. 80% say their biggest regret when younger was not travelling more.

Original Press Release:

Hong Kong, Aug. 11 -- Standard Chartered PLC issued the following news release:

- High-Net-Worth Individuals View Travel as an Investment, Spending Nearly HK\$30,000 A Month on Exploring the World

- A Decade of Partnership Between Standard Chartered, Cathay and Mastercard Reflects the Evolution of Hong Kong's Travel Habits

Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Limited ("Standard Chartered Hong Kong") today released its Hong Kong Travel Value Report 2026[1], surveying more than 1,000 affluent[2] and high-net-worth[3] Hong Kong residents to explore how travel habits have evolved over the past decade, and how travel is reshaping lifestyles, spending priorities and approaches to raising children. The survey found that nearly half of respondents regard "immersive travel" as one of their life goals, more than double the proportion who identified "property ownership" as a priority. The findings suggest that the memories and experiences accumulated through travel, as a form of "experiential asset", deliver a greater sense of fulfilment than owning property. As Standard Chartered, Cathay and Mastercard celebrate a decade of partnership, the survey also examines how affluent Hongkongers are defining the value of **wealth** through travel. Travel Goes Beyond Leisure

The survey found that more than half of respondents view travel as a form of investment, with the figures rising to 72% among high-net-worth individuals. Nearly one-third of respondents said their annual spending on travel exceeds that on discretionary expenses such as dining, entertainment and fashion. Among high-net-worth individuals, average monthly travel expenditure approaches HK\$30,000.

A New Perspective on the Value of Travel

As lifestyles and attitudes evolve, the survey found that 80% of respondents said their greatest regret in their younger years was not travelling more and seeing more of the world, rather than not saving enough money. The findings suggest that "experiential assets" are becoming an increasingly important measure of quality of life for Hong Kong consumers, while exclusive experiences are playing a growing role in travel planning. More than 70% of respondents expressed interest in travelling abroad to attend sporting events or cultural occasions, with sports-related experiences (50%) and arts and cultural events (43%) emerging as the most popular options.

Travel Experiences as a Legacy Asset

The shift in attitudes towards travel is influencing not only travel spending and motivations, but also how parents approach the upbringing of the next generation. More than 70% of respondents believe the value derived from

travel experiences can rival or even exceed that of traditional investments. More than 90% of parents surveyed regard overseas travel as one of the most meaningful and valuable investments in their children's development, placing it above tutoring and extracurricular activities. The concept of asset inheritance is no longer confined to traditional forms of **wealth**. Increasingly, parents believe that giving their children a global perspective and the ability to adapt through travel is more important than academic achievement alone.

Anshul Sabherwal, Head of Products (Credit Cards and Personal Loans) and Payment at Standard Chartered Hong Kong, said "As the preferred banking partner for affluent clients' **wealth** and lifestyle needs, Standard Chartered has partnered with Cathay and Mastercard since 2016 to deliver exclusive travel and spending experiences tailored to clients' evolving travel and spending habits. As of June this year, the number of Standard Chartered Cathay Mastercard – affluent tier [^] cardholders increased by more than 30% year-on-year, while their credit card spending up by over 40%. The survey found that nearly 60% of respondents use miles to upgrade to a higher cabin class or travel to more distant destinations. More than half also use their credit card spending alongside banking products and services to maximise miles earning opportunities. Looking ahead, the Standard Chartered Cathay Mastercard will continue to offer clients with the most comprehensive way to earn miles, helping them turn their dream journeys into lasting memories and realise the long-term value of every mile earned."

Flora Hui, General Manager Asia Miles at Cathay, said "Since its launch, Standard Chartered Cathay Mastercard has accompanied Hong Kong people as they explore the world. Over the past decade, cardholders have collectively redeemed and purchased over 7.5 million flight tickets using Asia Miles. While Japan and Thailand remain among the most popular destinations, we have also seen strong demand for Singapore and the United Kingdom. This demonstrates how Asia Miles enables cardholders to explore different corners of the world and create travel experiences that are uniquely their own. One of our highestspending cardholders accumulated more than 13 million miles over the past decade and redeemed them for 130 journeys. This is a powerful illustration of the value and appeal of turning everyday spending into rewarding travel experiences."

Helena Chen, Senior Vice President, General Manager, Hong Kong & Macau, Mastercard, said "Mastercard is proud to partner with Standard Chartered and Cathay on one of the largest co-brand portfolios in Hong Kong, which also delivers the highest monthly average spending in the category. The Standard Chartered Cathay Mastercard continues to set the benchmark for co-brand innovation, delivering scale and enabling richer, more seamless experiences for globally minded consumers. According to Mastercard research, demand for experience-led travel is growing among affluent consumers, with 59% preferring experiences over material purchases and 46% naming quality time with loved ones as a leading personal goal, reflecting a clear shift towards more meaningful journeys." Standard Chartered Cathay Mastercard Celebrates 10th Anniversary: Turning Miles into Extraordinary Experiences for Hongkongers

To mark the 10th anniversary of the Standard Chartered Cathay Mastercard, Standard Chartered Hong Kong and Cathay are launching the "A Decade of Miles. A Wider World Reimagined" themed campaign, featuring a series of exclusive offers and rewards [4] for cardholders. These include the "Blind Box Surprise Lucky Draw", featuring prizes worth more than 30 million miles, overseas spending rewards of up to HK\$2 = 1 mile, a 20% mile off on flight reward redemptions and an exclusive Seoul charter flight experience in partnership with Cathay Pacific. Through these initiatives, Standard Chartered Hong Kong aims to help clients create more memorable travel experiences and enjoy greater fulfilment from every journey. Beyond travel rewards, the Standard Chartered Cathay Mastercard also brings the spirit of exploration into everyday life through the "One Dines Free" dining programme. Cardholders can savour global flavours at selected premier and Michelinstarred restaurants in Hong Kong, and enjoy a complimentary bespoke set menu per table, bringing world-class culinary experiences closer to home. For more details, please visit the campaign webpage <https://www.sc.com/hk/creditcards/cathay/10thanniversary/>.

Standard Chartered

We are a leading international banking group, with a presence in 54 of the world's most dynamic markets. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good. Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong stock exchanges.

The history of Standard Chartered in Hong Kong dates back to 1859. It is currently one of the Hong Kong SAR's three note-issuing banks.

Standard Chartered incorporated its Hong Kong business on 1 July 2004, and now operates as a licensed bank in Hong Kong under the name of Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Limited, a wholly owned subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC.

Footnotes:

[1] Standard Chartered commissioned consultancy Human8 to conduct the market survey, interviewing 1,058 Hongkongers aged 30 or above. 60% of the respondents are parents. [Click here to view the full survey report.](#)

[2] Affluent Hong Kong consumers refer to individuals with liquid assets of HK\$200,000 or above, or have investable assets of between HK\$1 million and less than HK\$7.8 million.

[3] High-net-worth Hong Kong consumers are defined as individuals with investable assets of HK\$7.8 million or above.

[4] For offer details, please visit the Standard Chartered website. Terms and conditions apply.

[^] Affluent tier refers to Standard Chartered Cathay Mastercard - Priority Banking and Standard Chartered Cathay Mastercard - Priority Private cardholders.

[Category: Asset and **Wealth Management**, Investment Banking, Travel and Tourism, Wellness]

Source: Standard Chartered PLC

Document ATINBK0020260811em8b000md

business

HSBC to offer global investment access to HNI clients via India INX platform in GIFT City

267 words

11 August 2026

Moneycontrol.com

MONECT

English

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The offering will give eligible clients structured access to overseas equities, debt and other international products via the IFSCA-regulated Global Access Provider platform

HSBC's GIFT City banking unit is set to enable its high-net-worth and **wealth** clients to invest in global markets through India INX Global Access, according to people familiar with the development. The link is yet to go live on their official website (initially scheduled for today) as certain technical glitches are being taken care of in the background.

The offering will give eligible clients structured access to overseas equities, debt and other international products via the IFSCA-regulated Global Access Provider platform. HSBC is positioning the service primarily for its HNI and **wealth** segment.

Because HSBC operates a full International Banking Unit in GIFT City, the proposition is expected to provide a smoother remittance experience for clients transferring funds from India into the IFSC ecosystem compared with pure brokerage platforms. The bank can also extend the service to family members of existing clients.

A dedicated client link for the product is expected to appear on the HSBC India website. A similar arrangement is already live for clients of State Bank of India's GIFT City unit.

While the formal partnership between HSBC IBU and India INX Global Access was announced in March 2026, the client-facing product enablement and website rollout mark the next stage of the collaboration.

HSBC India has not yet publicly confirmed the launch details. Official response is awaited from their end.

Document MONECT0020260811em8b000uq



Standard Chartered launches gold fund with AllianzGI

Martina Markosyan

140 words

11 August 2026

22:26

SeeNews Banking

SEBNK

English

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August 11 (SeeNews) - British lender Standard Chartered Plc (LON:STAN) has launched its ninth sub-fund under its Variable Capital Company (VCC) platform in partnership with Allianz Global Investors, offering eligible clients exposure to gold alongside enhanced income generation.

The Signature Select Enhanced Gold Income Fund invests in gold exchange-traded funds and uses a covered call strategy to generate regular income while maintaining exposure to gold's potential long-term appreciation.

The fund is available to accredited and professional investors through Standard Chartered's **wealth management** businesses in Hong Kong, Singapore, the UAE, Jersey, Kenya and Nigeria from this month, with Taiwan to follow later this year.

The launch marks Standard Chartered's fourth fund launch in 2026 and expands its range of custom-curated investment strategies offered through the VCC platform.

Document SEBNK00020260811em8b0005I

StanChart launches gold income fund with AllianzGI

James Phillipps

210 words

11 August 2026

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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Standard Chartered has introduced a gold income strategy in conjunction with Allianz Global Investors, as it continues to expand its fund offering.

The Signature Select Enhanced Gold Income fund blends investments in a gold exchange-traded fund with a covered call approach designed to add yield.

The fund is the ninth launched under StanChart's variable capital company (VCC) umbrella and fourth this year. Previous strategies include an Apac multi-asset portfolio run by BlackRock, which debuted last month, a collateralised loan obligation strategy, managed by Barings, and a multi-sector credit fund with Pimco.

Sumeet Bhambri, global head of advisory and managed investments, **wealth** solutions at Standard Chartered, said of the latest launch: 'As clients seek greater diversification amid an increasingly uncertain market environment, the fund provides access to a differentiated strategy that combines gold's portfolio diversification benefits with enhanced income potential.'

Covered call option strategies sell some of the upside potential to provide income and dampen volatility.

The fund is available to accredited and professional investors in StanChart's priority, priority private and private banking segments in Hong Kong, Singapore, the UAE, Jersey, Kenya and Nigeria this month. It will be opened to customers in Taiwan later this year.

Document CWIRME0020260811em8b00002

Stock Market: Vietnam's TCBS Securities Secures \$60 Million International Loan

175 words

11 August 2026

Vietnam News Brief Service

VIETNB

English

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Techcom Securities Joint Stock Company (TCBS) has closed a \$60 million three-year unsecured loan, with an option to increase the facility to \$120 million, making it the first Vietnamese securities firm to raise medium- and long-term international debt under this structure.

The loan was arranged by Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Limited, with Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Limited acting as agent and lender, and was approved by the State Bank of Vietnam. TCBS said the funds will support margin lending, bond investment operations, and investment in technology, data, and artificial intelligence infrastructure as part of its **wealth management** strategy.

The transaction precedes Vietnam's official upgrade to a secondary emerging market by FTSE Russell in September 2026, which is expected to attract foreign capital and increase demand for securities firms' financial capacity. Standard Chartered's general director for Vietnam, Nguyen Thuy Hanh, said the loan reflects international institutions' confidence in TCBS's strategy and Vietnam's capital market ahead of the upgrade.

Document VIETNB0020260811em8b0008o

DBS proudly supports Indonesia's Inaugural Panda Bonds Issuance | Bahasa

Distributed by Contify.com

1,203 words

10 August 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Indonesia issues RMB7 billion panda bonds, first sovereign bond in China's market
- * DBS acts as Joint Lead Underwriter and Joint Bookrunner, first mandate for non-bank issuer from Southeast Asia
- * Bonds issued in two tranches, attracting diverse investors, rated AAA by China Lianhe Credit Ratings Co., Ltd.

Original Press Release:

Indonesia, Aug. 10 -- DBS Bank Ltd issued the following news release:

Indonesia reached an important milestone in the capital markets with the successful issuance of RMB7 billion worth of panda bonds, making it the country's first sovereign bond issuance in China's domestic bond market. Supporting this landmark transaction, DBS acted as Joint Lead Underwriter and Joint Bookrunner, marking DBS's first mandate for a panda bond issuance by a non-bank issuer from Southeast Asia. The transaction demonstrated the Indonesian Government's commitment to diversifying its development financing sources while expanding access to investors across different markets and currencies. It also strengthened Indonesia's access to long-term financing while deepening financial connectivity with China.

Further strengthening Indonesia's debut in China's capital markets, the bonds were issued in two tranches: a three-year 5.6 billion-RMB bond with a 1.90% coupon and five-year 1.4 billion-RMB bond with a 2.19% coupon. The transaction attracted strong participation from a diverse range of institutional investors, including domestic banks, **wealth management** institutions, securities firms, asset managers and investment funds, as well as foreign banks and government investment institutions from Southeast Asia, the Middle East, and other regions. As the only foreign bank appointed Joint Lead Underwriter for the bonds, DBS, together with the other Joint Lead Underwriters, supported the issuer by conducting both virtual and in-person roadshows and coordinating efforts with credit rating agencies. These collaborative efforts have earned the issuer and the bonds an AAA rating from China Lianhe Credit Ratings Co., Ltd.

President Director of PT Bank DBS Indonesia Lim Chu Chong said, "By accessing China's highly liquid bond market, we are supporting Indonesia in expanding its access to new RMB-based investors. DBS's unique network connecting Southeast Asia and China positions us as a strategic financial bridge, enabling more ASEAN issuers to access China's capital markets while facilitating regional financing and investment, further strengthening financial connectivity across the region."

As the largest economy in ASEAN, Indonesia has set a record for the value of its panda bond issuance in China's bond market. The successful transaction reflected strong investor confidence in Indonesia's economic fundamentals. In its inaugural issuance, the panda bonds generated approximately RMB17 billion in investor demand, equivalent to around 2.4 times the issuance size, enabling the government to secure competitive funding costs. The bonds were also assigned an AAA (Stable) rating by China Lianhe Credit Rating Co., Ltd., further strengthening Indonesia's credibility among domestic Chinese investors.

The panda bonds were issued amid uncertainty in global financial markets, driven by elevated global interest rates, exchange rate volatility, and evolving international market conditions. Against this backdrop, diversifying financing sources has become increasingly important to reduce reliance on any single currency or capital market. Beyond broadening diversification, this approach also provides the government with a wider range of financing

options while enhancing flexibility in managing sovereign debt. This strategy is aligned with the government's efforts to build a more resilient financing structure that can better withstand external volatility.

President and Chief Executive Officer of DBS China Ginger Cheng said, "This inaugural panda bond issuance marked an important milestone for Indonesia in expanding its access to one of the world's largest bond markets. We are proud to support the Government of Indonesia in this landmark transaction while further strengthening financial connectivity between Indonesia and China."

The panda bond issuance marked another significant milestone in Indonesia's RMB financing journey, following the issuance of RMB9.25 billion worth of dim sum bonds in Hong Kong SAR in February. At the same time, the successful inaugural issuance sent a positive signal that international investors continue to have confidence in Indonesia's fiscal stability and long-term economic growth prospects despite the challenging global economic environment.

The success of this partnership further demonstrates Bank DBS Indonesia's commitment as a trusted partner in supporting national economic growth. In recent years, DBS has also actively leveraged its qualification as an Appointed Cross-Currency Dealer (ACCD) for the Chinese renminbi and Indonesian rupiah (IDR), supported by close collaboration among DBS teams in China, Indonesia, and across the region. This synergy aims to facilitate cross-border capital flows while strengthening multilateral economic, trade, and financial cooperation between China and ASEAN.

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named "World's Best AI Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Digital Bank" by Euromoney and the winner of multiple digital assets awards. In addition, DBS has been accorded the "Safest Bank in Asia" award by Global Finance for 17 consecutive years from 2009 to 2025.

DBS provides a full range of services in Consumer, **Wealth**, SME and corporate banking. As a bank born and bred in Asia, DBS understands the intricacies of doing business in the region's most dynamic markets.

Established in 1989 as part of the Singapore-based DBS Group, PT Bank DBS Indonesia (Bank DBS Indonesia) is one of the banks with the longest history in Asia.

Currently operating 1 Operational Head Office, 13 Branch Offices, 14 Sub-Branch Offices, 32 ATMs spread across major cities and 2,861 active employees in 15 major cities in Indonesia, Bank DBS Indonesia provides comprehensive banking services that focus on the customer experience to 'Live more, Bank less'. We also see a purpose beyond banking and are committed to supporting our customers, employees, and the community towards a sustainable future.

PT Bank DBS Indonesia is licensed and supervised by The Indonesian Financial Services Authority (OJK), and an insured member of Indonesia Deposit Insurance Corporation (LPS).

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by uplifting lives and livelihoods of those in need. It provides essential needs to the underprivileged, and fosters inclusion by equipping the underserved with financial and digital literacy skills. It also nurtures innovative social enterprises that create positive impact.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

[Category: Investment Banking, Debt Issuance, Monetary Policy and Inflation]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd

Document ATINBK0020260822em8a00003

The Official Board

HSBC Private Banking - The organizational chart displays its 10 executives, including Ida Liu and Gabriel Castello

272 words

10 August 2026

The Official Board

OFBOAR

English

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In the Banking industry, there are 5,579 large companies in 188 countries, with a total of 104,264 top executives. Within those companies, 43,312 executive movements have been recorded in the last 12 months.

Company: HSBC Private Banking

URL: www.privatebanking.hsbc.com

Industry: Banking

HSBC Private Banking is a subsidiary of HSBC International **Wealth** and Premier Banking.

Name: Ida Liu

Title: Chief Executive Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/ida-liu-d8248>

Name: Gabriel Castello

Title: Vice Chairman

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/gabriel-castello-e45g4>

Name: Mike Hordley

Title: Chief Operating Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/mike-hordley-4230e>

Name: David De La Cruz

Title: Head of Commercial Execution

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/david-de-la-cruz-d9649>

Name: Karl Faivre

Title: Regional Head of Investments and **Wealth** Solutions, Europe International and Middle East and North Africa

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/karl-faivre-38d28>

Name: Willem Sels

Title: Global Chief Investment Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/willem-sels-e02d0>

Name: Edward Chiu

Title: Onshore Taiwan Market Head

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/edward-chiu-30e10>

Name: Robert Embury

Title: Head of Collaboration for Europe, The Middle East and Africa

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/robert-embury-4g84g>

Name: Mathieu Forcioli

Title: Global and Asia Pacific Head of Alternatives

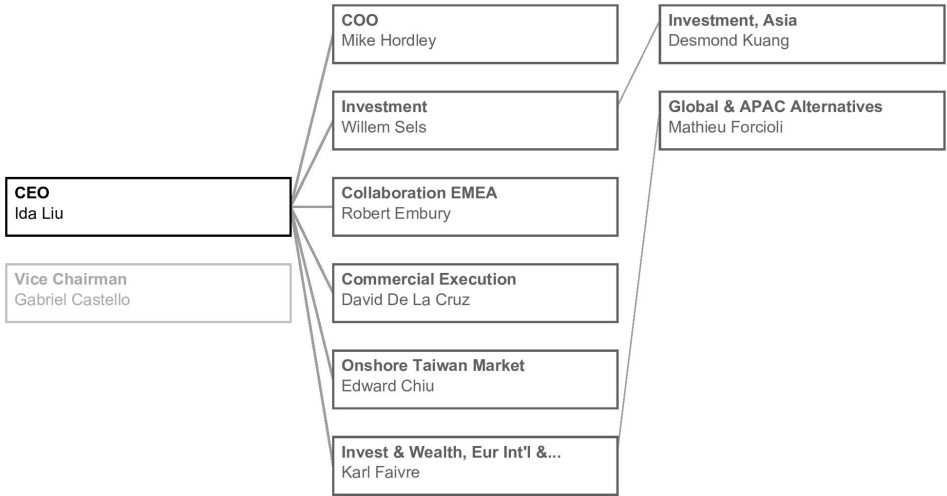
Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/mathieu-forcioli-6g28g>

Name: Desmond Kuang

Title: Chief Investment Officer for Asia, Private Bank and Premier **Wealth**

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/desmond-kuang-83g6d>

Organizational Chart HSBC Private Banking



The Official Board as of Aug 17, 2026 11:00:21 AM - Know more at contact@theofficialboard.com

The Official Board

Standard Chartered Asia - The organizational chart displays its 25 executives, including Benjamin Hung and John Thang

664 words

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The Official Board

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English

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In the Banking industry, there are 5,579 large companies in 188 countries, with a total of 104,264 top executives. Within those companies, 43,312 executive movements have been recorded in the last 12 months.

Company: Standard Chartered Asia

URL: www.sc.com/en/banking/asean/

Industry: Banking

Standard Chartered Asia is a subsidiary of Standard Chartered. Standard Chartered Asia has 15 subsidiaries, including Standard Chartered Bank Singapore and Standard Chartered Hong Kong.

Name: Benjamin Hung

Title: Chief Executive Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/benjamin-hung-d4e34>

Name: John Thang

Title: Managing Director, Head of Markets and Strategic Client Management and Solutions, Hong Kong and Greater China and North Asia

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/john-thang-e7g37>

Name: Heidi Toribio

Title: Managing Director, Global Head, Client Enablement and Lending Operations

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/heidi-toribio-76e96>

Name: Eva Ang

Title: Head of Corporate Affairs

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/eva-ang-594e8>

Name: Mary Huen

Title: Chief Executive Officer, Hong Kong and Greater China and North Asia

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/mary-huen-64d78>

Name: Prabdev Singh

Title: Chief Executive Officer, India and South Asia Markets

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/prabdev-singh-e38eg>

Name: Patrick Lee

Title: Chief Executive Officer, Singapore and ASEAN Markets

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/patrick-lee-450d3>

Name: Manoj Piplani

Title: Global Head, Credit Cards and Personal Loans

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/manoj-piplani-48g58>

Name: Kian-Jin Khoo

Title: Head of Southeast and South Asia for Private Markets Group

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/kian-jin-khoo-24g74>

Name: Andrew Chia

Title: Head **Wealth** and Retail Bank

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/andrew-chia-d3603>

Name: Jacob Berman

Title: Chief Executive Officer, Australia

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/jacob-berman-791e9>

Name: Park Jong Bok

Title: Chief Executive Officer, Korea

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/park-jong-bok-de3ge>

Name: Ankur Kanwar

Title: Head of Cash Management, Singapore and The Association of Southeast Asian Nations, Global Head of Structured Solutions Development

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/ankur-kanwar-78ge8>

Name: Muska Chiu

Title: Team Lead of Investment Advisory, Private Bank

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/muska-chiu-1652d>

Name: Jean Lu

Title: Chief Executive Officer, China

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/jean-lu-952d5>

Name: SV Shivshanker

Title: Head of Human Resources, India and South Asia

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/sv-shivshanker-589g8>

Name: Karby Leggett

Title: Head of Digital Assets, Greater China North Asia, South Asia and Association of Southeast Asian Nations

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/karby-leggett-e7ed2>

Name: Yigen Pei

Title: Head of Transaction Banking and Head of Cash Management, China

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/yigen-pei-795g9>

Name: Aditya Mandloi

Title: Managing Director, Head of **Wealth** and Retail Bank, India and South Asia

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/aditya-mandloi-d6136>

Name: Jim Wang

Title: Chief Executive Officer, China Securities

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/jim-wang-105e0>

Name: Anthony Lin

Title: Head of Greater China & North Asia and Global Head of Market Management, Transaction Banking

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/anthony-lin-7183g>

Name: Maisie Chong

Title: Global Head of Receivables Purchase and Head of Trade and Working Capital for The Association of Southeast Asian Nations and South Asia

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/maisie-chong-d2e52>

Name: Eugene Puar

Title: Regional Head of **Wealth Management** Association of Southeast Asian Nations and South Asia

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/eugene-puar-d6846>

Name: Peter Horng

Title: Managing Director and Regional Head of Investment Advisory and Product Advisory, Private Banking, Greater China and North Asia

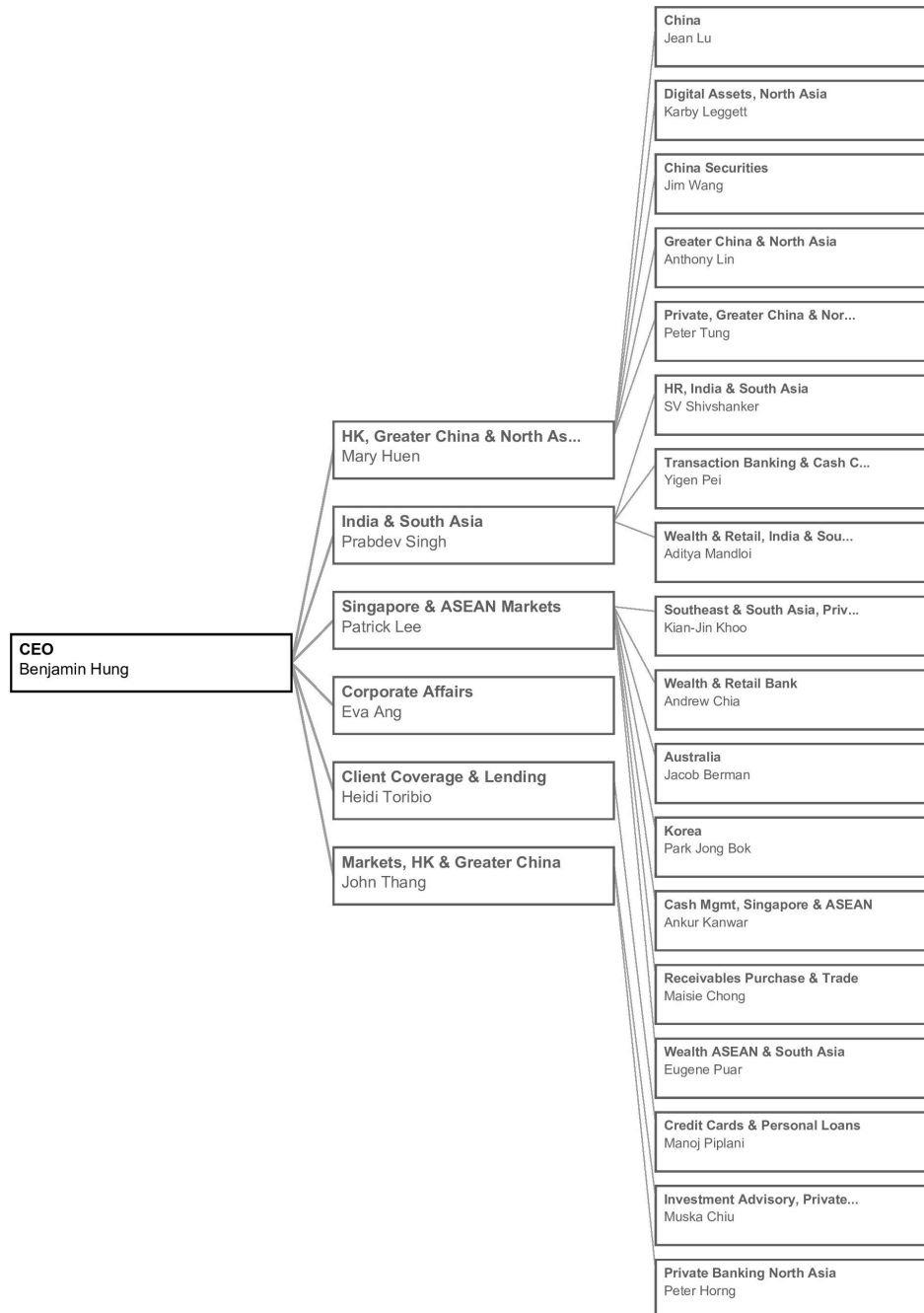
Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/peter-horng-28e69>

Name: Peter Tung

Title: Regional Head, Private Banking, Greater China and North Asia

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/peter-tung-d7d47>

Organizational Chart Standard Chartered Asia



The Official Board as of Aug 17, 2026 10:03:41 AM - Know more at contact@theofficialboard.com

HSBC UK steps up support for farmers as extreme weather drives cashflow pressures

Distributed by Contify.com

506 words

10 August 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * HSBC UK supports farmers facing cashflow pressures due to extreme weather.
- * Weather impacts production, inputs, and forward planning.
- * HSBC offers repayment holidays, debt restructuring, and finance for climate adaptation.

Original Press Release:

Aug. 10 -- HSBC Group issued the following news release:

HSBC UK is stepping up support for agricultural customers as prolonged dry conditions and periods of heat stress increase pressure on farm businesses across the UK, impacting crop yields, feed availability and cashflow.

Weather conditions are creating operational and financial pressures for farming businesses in many regions nationwide, with the greatest impact being felt in parts of the South, the Midlands and the East of England.

HSBC UK's agriculture team reports that the current weather pattern is likely to cause working capital pressure later in the year. It's affecting decisions around production, inputs and forward planning. At the same time, several farmers are increasing investment in infrastructure and/or alternative crop types, including more heat- and drought-tolerant varieties, to build resilience against drier conditions.

To help manage these pressures, many farmers have been and continue to diversify their income streams, both inside and outside agricultural systems. Some are reducing reliance on a single crop or farming type, helping to protect revenues through a more varied business model.

Martin Hanson, Head of Agriculture at HSBC UK, said: "Farming businesses are used to managing uncertainty, but the frequency and intensity of extreme weather is making resilience an everyday commercial priority.

No two farms are the same. If farmers are experiencing difficulties meeting day-to-day working capital needs or keeping up with repayments on existing borrowing, we'll look at the best ways to support them including, if appropriate, repayment holidays and restructuring existing debt.

Beyond those short-term needs, it's also important that we engage with farmers to explore the need for finance to invest in climate change mitigation and adaptation actions to make farms more resilient in the seasons ahead, and HSBC UK is very supportive of such approaches."

Eligible farmers can access HSBC UK's Sustainable Farming Pathway through HSBC UK's agricultural banking team, with eligibility aligned to participating sustainability schemes.

HSBC UK

HSBC UK serves over 15 million active customers across the UK, supported by over 23,000 colleagues. HSBC UK offers a complete range of retail banking and **wealth management** to personal and private banking customers, as well as commercial banking for small to medium businesses and large corporates. HSBC UK is a ring-fenced bank and wholly-owned subsidiary of HSBC Holdings plc.

HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 56 countries and territories. With assets of US\$3,438bn at 30 June 2026, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

[Category: Asset and **Wealth Management**, Investment Banking, Agriculture, Agricultural Products, Climate Change]

Source: HSBC Group

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INDUSTRY SNAPSHOTS - UNITED KINGDOM BANKING 10 AUG 26_EN

10,731 words

10 August 2026

Acquisdata Global Industry SnapShot Online

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English

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LATEST COMPANY NEWS

This Week's News

Mortgage Strategy - NatWest to cut more than 200 rates on Monday - 7/8/2026

NatWest is making more than 200 rate cuts across its new business range on Monday, with prices falling by up to 24 basis points, but some existing customer rates are rising.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.mortgagestrategy.co.uk/news/natwest-to-cut-more-than-200-rates-on-monday/>

Bloomberg.com - Lazard Hires Barclays Veteran Sheth for European Tech Push - 7/8/2026

Lazard Inc. is hiring veteran Barclays Plc banker Jessel Sheth to boost its technology advisory team, as more of the firm's software clients.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-08-07/lazard-hires-barclays-veteran-sheth-for-european-tech-push?srd=all>

Bloomberg.com - Barclays, HSBC Say Inflation-Protected Bonds Appeal - 5/8/2026

Barclays Plc and HSBC Holdings Plc say concern the Federal Reserve is dragging its feet on inflation is giving investors another reason.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-08-05/barclays-hsbc-say-warsh-boosts-case-for-inflation-linked-bonds>

Other Stories

The Times - Bank of England staff worked from abroad for 13,000 days - 5/8/2026

Bloomberg.com - HSBC Resumes Buyback, Ramps Up Cost Saving After Profit Beat - 4/8/2026

The Guardian - Lloyds Bank should publish the human cost of its AI savings | Letters - 6/8/2026

Bloomberg.com - HSBC Weighs Offloading Billions in UK Pension Assets to Insurer - 30/7/2026

Reuters - Lloyds reports first-half profit up 23%, outlines AI-driven cost-cutting plans - 30/7/2026

Media Releases

Standard Chartered plc (LSE: STAN) - Standard Chartered to launch Signature CIO Funds from GIFT City - 7/8/2026

Standard Chartered plc (LSE: STAN) - Islamic finance evolves into a 'super connector' for capital, trade and digital infrastructure - 6/8/2026

Latest Research

Challenges of Nigerian Fintech Startups Expanding into the United Kingdom By Ahmed, Ali

Overviews of Leading Companies

Atom Bank

Barclays plc (LSE: BARC)

HSBC Holdings plc (LSE: HSBA, NYSE: HSBC)

Lloyds Banking Group (LSE: LLOY)

OneSavings Bank (LSE: OSB)

Royal Bank of Scotland Group plc (LSE: RBS, NYSE: RBS)

Standard Chartered plc (LSE: STAN)

Secure Trust Bank (LSE: STB)

Virgin Money UK plc (LSE: VMUK, ASX: VUK)

Associate: Laura Eva

News and Commentary

Mortgage Strategy - NatWest to cut more than 200 rates on Monday - 7/8/2026

NatWest is making more than 200 rate cuts across its new business range on Monday, with prices falling by up to 24 basis points, but some existing customer rates are rising.

For the complete story, see:

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Bloomberg.com - Lazard Hires Barclays Veteran Sheth for European Tech Push - 7/8/2026

Lazard Inc. is hiring veteran Barclays Plc banker Jessel Sheth to boost its technology advisory team, as more of the firm's software clients.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-08-07/lazard-hires-barclays-veteran-sheth-for-european-tech-push?srd=all>

Bloomberg.com - Barclays, HSBC Say Inflation-Protected Bonds Appeal - 5/8/2026

Barclays Plc and HSBC Holdings Plc say concern the Federal Reserve is dragging its feet on inflation is giving investors another reason.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-08-05/barclays-hsbc-say-warsh-boosts-case-for-inflation-linked-bonds>

The Times - Bank of England staff worked from abroad for 13,000 days - 5/8/2026

More than 1,000 staff members at the Bank of England spent a total of 12,889 days working overseas under its remote work policy.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.thetimes.com/business/economics/article/bank-of-england-work-from-abroad-sschljtjr>

Bloomberg.com - HSBC Resumes Buyback, Ramps Up Cost Saving After Profit Beat - 4/8/2026

HSBC Holdings Plc announced a fresh stock buyback and raised its cost-cutting target as it reported second-quarter earnings that beat.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-08-04/hsbc-announces-fresh-1-billion-share-buyback-after-profit-beats>

The Guardian - Lloyds Bank should publish the human cost of its AI savings | Letters - 6/8/2026

Your report (Lloyds Bank to cut £2bn in costs as part of AI-powered strategy, 30 July) raises a question that financial targets alone cannot answer: who absorbs the work when automation fails?

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.theguardian.com/technology/2026/aug/06/lloyds-bank-should-publish-the-human-cost-of-its-ai-savings>

Bloomberg.com - HSBC Weighs Offloading Billions in UK Pension Assets to Insurer - 30/7/2026

HSBC Holdings Plc has held early talks to offload billions of pounds in UK pension assets after being approached by insurers, according to people familiar with the matter.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-07-30/hsbc-weighs-offloading-billions-in-uk-pension-assets-to-insurer>

Reuters - Lloyds reports first-half profit up 23%, outlines AI-driven cost-cutting plans - 30/7/2026

Lloyds Banking Group (LLOY.L), opens new tab reported a better than expected statutory pretax profit of £4.3 billion for the first half of 2026, as CEO Charlie Nunn also outlined the lender's next plan to grow its core businesses and harness technology such as AI to cut costs.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.reuters.com/business/finance/lloyds-reports-first-half-profit-up-23-outlines-new-strategy-2026-07-30/>

Media Releases

Standard Chartered plc (LSE: STAN) - Standard Chartered to launch Signature CIO Funds from GIFT City - 7/8/2026

Singapore – Standard Chartered (“the Bank”) today announced that it will begin offering **wealth** solutions from India’s Gujarat International Finance Tec-City (GIFT City) following an in-principle approval from the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) to distribute Capital Market products. The approval marks an important milestone in the Bank’s efforts to broaden access to its global **wealth** capabilities.

The Bank expects to launch its Signature CIO Funds from GIFT City for eligible clients in the coming weeks, with additional **wealth** solutions to follow over time. The Signature CIO Funds are a suite of four funds designed to provide access to the Bank’s Chief Investment Office (CIO) investment strategies through diversified multi-asset portfolios spanning equities, fixed income, commodities, alternatives and cash.

Samir Subberwal, Global Head, **Wealth** Solutions, Retail Products, Data & Analytics, Standard Chartered, said: “We are seeing growing demand from affluent clients for internationally diversified portfolios, expert advice and seamless access to opportunities across markets. GIFT City provides a compelling platform to serve these needs, drawing on India’s growing role in global **wealth** creation and investment flows. This approval marks an important step in expanding our **wealth** capabilities through GIFT City, starting with the launch of our Signature CIO Funds and followed by a broader suite of **wealth** solutions over time. As a leading international **wealth** manager, we are well-positioned to connect clients to global investment opportunities through our network, CIO expertise and advisory capabilities.”

Since its launch in 2022, the Signature CIO Funds have attracted more than \$5 billion in assets under management and are available across 12 markets, including Standard Chartered’s Private Banking centres.

Standard Chartered was the first foreign bank to commence operations in GIFT City in 2020 and currently provides a comprehensive suite of banking services to corporate and institutional clients from the centre. The latest approval further strengthens the Bank's ability to serve clients across both their banking and **wealth management** needs through one of the world's fastest-growing international financial centres.

<https://www.sc.com/en/press-release/standard-chartered-to-launch-signature-cio-funds-from-gift-city/>

Standard Chartered plc (LSE: STAN) - Islamic finance evolves into a 'super connector' for capital, trade and digital infrastructure - 6/8/2026

SINGAPORE – As geopolitical shifts, supply-chain diversification and regional trade realignment reshape global commerce, Islamic finance is emerging as a key enabler of international capital flows, trade finance and digital infrastructure. According to a new Standard Chartered report, the industry is evolving beyond its traditional role as a source of funding to become a strategic connector between liquidity-rich markets and fast-growing economies.

With approximately USD6 trillion in assets across nearly 100 jurisdictions, the industry is increasingly facilitating capital flows between the GCC, ASEAN, South Asia, Africa and other emerging markets.

The report, 'Islamic Banking for Financial Institutions: The Islamic Finance Connector Era', finds that shifting trade patterns, geopolitical uncertainty and growing demand for regional resilience are reshaping economic connections. As businesses and governments diversify trade and investment relationships, Islamic finance is playing an increasingly important role in linking liquidity-rich markets with economies seeking long-term investment.

Rather than being driven solely by asset growth, the next phase of Islamic finance will increasingly be defined by its ability to mobilise liquidity, connect regions and facilitate investment across emerging economic corridors.

"Islamic finance is becoming a critical enabler of cross-border connectivity. As its role in facilitating trade, investment and capital flows, continues to grow, financial institutions must place Islamic finance firmly on their strategic agenda," said Khurram Hilal, CEO of Group Islamic Banking at Standard Chartered.

"As trade routes become increasingly interconnected, institutions need recognised financing structures and operational capabilities that enable Shariah-compliant capital to move seamlessly across borders."

Connecting liquidity with opportunity

While Islamic finance liquidity continues to deepen, capital deployment remains uneven. Despite substantial infrastructure and development funding requirements across South Asia and Africa, only 6 per cent of global sukuk capital currently reaches these markets, presenting a significant opportunity for institutions to strengthen financing links between liquidity-rich and capital-constrained markets.

Reshaping trade corridors and private credit

Rapidly evolving trade routes are generating new opportunities for Islamic finance. GCC-centred, China-centred and Middle East-Türkiye corridors are emerging as priority channels for trade, investment and working capital, helping financial institutions strengthen the resilience of trade, treasury, payment and settlement flows.

Beyond public capital markets, the report also highlights the growing role of private credit as an additional channel for capital deployment. Islamic finance structures can support investment across infrastructure, receivables, trade-linked assets and mid-market businesses while maintaining strong governance and asset-backed principles.

Digital assets and institutional governance

Alongside physical trade corridors, digital infrastructure is expected to become an increasingly important enabler of Islamic finance. Tokenisation and digital assets have the potential to improve efficiency and expand cross-market investment, provided legal certainty, interoperability, robust custody arrangements and trusted governance frameworks continue to develop.

"The challenge for many markets today is not a shortage of liquidity, but how to connect that liquidity with opportunity more effectively across borders," Khurram Hilal added. "Financial institutions that build trusted connections between capital, markets, and digital infrastructure will be best positioned to support sustainable growth across emerging economies."

As the only international bank with a global Islamic banking franchise, Standard Chartered supports clients across these evolving trade and investment corridors through Shariah-compliant solutions, deep market connectivity and cross-border capabilities.

<https://www.sc.com/en/press-release/islamic-finance-evolves-into-a-super-connector-for-capital-trade-and-digital-infrastructure/>

Latest Research

Challenges of Nigerian Fintech Startups Expanding into the United Kingdom

Ahmed, Ali

Abstract

The study uses a qualitative approach based solely on secondary data. Sources include academic articles, publications from the Financial Conduct Authority and Bank of England, industry reports, and company documents. Four Nigerian fintech firms: Kuda Bank, PalmPay, Paystack, and Kora are examined as cases. The analysis applies population ecology theory, resource-based view, and internationalization theory, alongside PESTEL, Porter's Five Forces, SWOT, and Bowman's Strategy Clock.

The findings show that Nigerian fintech possess useful strengths: solid technical abilities, cost effective products, and experience reaching unbanked people. However, these strengths alone do not guarantee success. Four entry pathways emerge: using the FCA Regulatory Sandbox, partnering with UK licensed firms, focusing on the Nigerian diaspora niche, or starting with a narrow remittance licence.

The study concludes that fitting into the UK regulatory environment matters more than technological strength. The findings support population ecology theory, extend the resource based view by highlighting diaspora ties as a strategic asset, and challenge the Uppsala model's step by step entry assumptions.

<https://www.theseus.fi/handle/10024/929343>

The Industry

U.K. Banking Outlook 2025 Entering The Year With Solid Earnings And Balance Sheets

Key Takeaways

- Our stable outlooks on all U.K. bank ratings show that we expect banks to remain resilient over 2025, possibly with limited positive rating actions over the medium term if a more supportive economic outlook and banks' controlled credit risk appetites lead to an improvement in our BICRA economic risk trend.
- Strong earnings driven by stable margins should allow rated U.K. banks to maintain their robust capital positions and prioritize distributions via share buybacks and special dividends.
- Despite mixed reactions to the government's autumn budget, we think the U.K. economy will deliver steady growth in 2025* on the back of expected rate cuts and a strong labour market. These factors should support banks' loan growth and asset quality.
- We expect credit loss charges to normalize for banks, with a steady but manageable flow of lending into arrears and overall cost of risk increasing toward the long-run average.
- Historical motor finance commissions remediation could dent earnings and shareholder distributions for rated banks with material exposures, but we expect minimal impact on their capital ratios.
- We expect rated banks' funding and liquidity metrics to remain stable as deposit migration slows and central bank borrowing is refinanced using existing liquidity and limited wholesale issuance

Our Ratings On U.K. Banks

- The outlooks on all our U.K. bank ratings are currently stable and we see stable trends for economic and industry risk under our U.K. Banking Industry Country Risk Assessment (BICRA).
- Bank fundamentals remain solid, including healthy capital levels, good liquidity, and contained credit losses.

- We could consider positively revising our BICRA economic risk trend and certain outlooks on rated banks, in the medium term, if the economic outlook is more favorable and inflation remains low, while the banking system maintains a controlled credit risk appetite.
- Conversely, we could selectively take negative rating actions if downside risks to the economy crystallize, triggering a materially sharper asset quality deterioration than we currently expect.

Source: S&P Global

<https://www.spglobal.com/assets/documents/ratings/research/101611959.pdf>

Banking in the United Kingdom (UK) - statistics & facts

The banking industry in the UK has witnessed notable developments and trends in recent years, reflecting changes in banking system efficiency, structural transformations such as the declining number of bank branches, and shifts in consumer behavior toward online banking.

Banking system efficiency fluctuated, with total assets decreasing in 2023 following substantial growth in 2022. HSBC remains a global banking leader, holding over 2.4 trillion British pounds in assets as of 2024. The sector demonstrated resilience as primary capital ratios, after declining sharply in early 2022, stabilized by year-end and maintained that stability through 2023-2024, indicating confidence in the industry's strength. These developments have occurred alongside two major structural trends: the continued reduction in physical bank branches and the increasing prominence of digital banking solutions.

Branching out: the decline of traditional banking spaces

The UK banking sector has experienced significant structural changes over the past five years, marked by a considerable decrease in the number of credit institutions and physical bank branches, with the latter nearly halving in number. This trend extends beyond the UK, reflecting a broader European pattern where bank branches declined from approximately 206,000 to 129,000 between 2012 and 2023. Driving this transformation is the remarkable growth in online banking adoption. UK online banking usage has nearly doubled between 2009 and 2023, fundamentally altering consumer banking habits. Mobile and online platforms have now become the predominant channels for conducting banking activities. This digital shift has fundamentally reshaped the banking landscape, prompting financial institutions to consolidate and close physical locations as they adapt their service delivery models to align with customers' evolving preferences and behaviors.

Digital banking boom: customer surge amid profit struggle

Some of Europe's largest digital banks are based in the UK, including Revolut, Wise, Monzo, Starling, and Monese. Among them, Revolut stands out with the largest customer base, boasting 50 million user base worldwide. The majority of its users are in the UK, which also accounts for most of its downloads. While these digital banks have seen significant growth in their customer bases, profitability remains a challenge. Revolut reported its first profit in 2021, followed by Starling Bank in 2022 and Monzo in 2024. However, Atom Bank and Monese continue to report losses, underscoring the financial hurdles many digital banks face despite their increasing popularity and adoption.

The UK banking sector continues to evolve, shaped by digital adoption, structural consolidation, and shifting profitability dynamics. While traditional banks streamline operations and reduce branch networks, digital banks are expanding their customer bases, though many still face financial hurdles. The industry's resilience is evident in stable capital ratios and the presence of global leaders like HSBC. As online banking cements itself as the dominant channel, the future of UK banking will likely be defined by the balance between digital innovation and sustainable profitability. This text provides general information. Statista assumes no liability for the information given being complete or correct. Due to varying update cycles, statistics can display more up-to-date data than referenced in the text.

Source: Statista Research Department

<https://www.statista.com/topics/11974/banking-industry-in-the-uk/#topicOverview>

Financial services

The UK has one of the most open, innovative and dynamic financial services sectors in the world.

The UK is a global centre for finance. Companies can benefit from an exceptional business environment, regulatory and government support, physical and digital connectivity and highly skilled international talent. The government is aiming to make the UK open and competitive, at the cutting-edge of technology and innovation, and a world leader in green finance.

Opportunity highlights

Islamic finance

The UK is the leading Western centre for Islamic finance, ranking first among non-Muslim majority nations for Islamic finance. The UK has bolstered its position in this sector by issuing its second sovereign Sukuk in 2021. Investors can take advantage of one of the world's most attractive regulatory and tax environments for Islamic finance.

The UK has put in place a fiscal and regulatory framework intended to broaden the market for Islamic financial products. This includes the removal of double tax and extension of tax relief on Islamic mortgages and the reform of arrangements for issues of debt.

Fintech

The UK accounts for 11% of the global fintech industry. It is home to an estimated 2,500 fintech firms, with 6 of the top 10 fintech companies headquartered in London. It's at the cutting-edge of fintech innovation taking the lead in areas such as payment technology (Paytech), **wealth** technology (Wealthtech) and more.

The Fintech Pledge demonstrates government and industry commitment to accelerating the growth of the UK fintech sector. It establishes globally leading standards for efficient and transparent commercial partnerships between banks and fintech firms.

Environmental, Social, and Corporate Governance (ESG) and Green Finance

The UK is a leading centre for sustainable finance with London, ranking first in the Global Green Finance Index. The market for Environment, Social and Governance (ESG) investments in the UK has grown dramatically.

In 2020, the value of responsible investment (RI) funds under management almost doubled to £55 billion from the previous year. On the London Stock Exchange, there are 260 sustainability-related bonds from 23 countries, over 180 ESG Indexes and over 150 Green Funds and Exchange Traded Funds (ETFs).

The UK will become the first country in the world to make Task Force on Climate-Related Financial Disclosure (TCFD) - aligned disclosures mandatory across the economy from April 2022. The new requirements will help investors and businesses to better understand the financial impacts of their exposure to climate change, and price climate-related risks more accurately.

Capital markets

The London Stock Exchange is one of the world's most international capital markets and the destination of choice for both international firms and international investors. It accounts for 43% of global foreign exchange trading and is the leading centre for international bond trading with around 79% of global secondary market turnover.

Between 2014 to 2018, UK companies raised £750 billion in the bond, equity and leveraged loan market – almost half the total amount banks lent to all UK companies over the same period.

The UK is also the world's largest asset management centre outside the US with £8.5 trillion of assets under management. London is also an important destination for global asset managers seeking to attract international investors to their own products and services. These span all the main asset classes, including equities, fixed income and property, as well as a wide range of alternative investments.

Commercial maturity

The UK is an important and innovative financial services hub. It's the world's largest centre for international debt issuance, commercial (re)insurance and foreign exchange trading.

The UK is also the world's leading net exporter of financial services, generating an industry trade surplus of £63.7 billion in 2020.

A new chapter for financial services sets out the UK government's vision for an open, green and technologically advanced financial services sector that is globally competitive.

Key UK assets

The UK's time zone makes it easy to do business with major markets to both the east and west within the working day.

One in 14 UK workers (2.3 million in total) are employed in financial and related professional services, and 2 out of 3 of these jobs are outside of London.

Important financial centres across the UK include:

- * Edinburgh and Glasgow in Scotland
- * Birmingham, Bristol, Leeds, Liverpool, Manchester and Sheffield in England
- * Cardiff in Wales
- * Belfast in Northern Ireland

The UK's technology ecosystem is supported by expertise in artificial intelligence (AI) and cyber security. This system and knowledge have helped create a successful digital transformation of financial services operations and allow businesses to remain competitive in the market.

FinTech Bridge agreements with other fintech hubs including Singapore, South Korea, China, Hong Kong, and Australia create valuable opportunities for expansion and collaboration by reducing barriers to entry to international markets.

The Green Finance Institute champions the UK's green finance brand internationally. It brings together global practitioners to design sector-specific solutions that channel money towards an environmentally sustainable economy.

R&D capability

The UK's business schools have some of the world's best MBA programmes. In 2021, 9 UK programmes made the Financial Times Global MBA's ranking of the 100 best full-time MBA programmes worldwide.

Financial and professional services firms in the UK have access to a large pool of highly qualified talent. In 2018 to 2019, 184,155 students graduated across business, finance and accounting, computer and mathematical sciences studies. The Financial Services Skills Commission works with the UK financial services sector to ensure that it has the talent and skills it needs for the future.

Business and government support

The UK financial services sector benefits from a supportive regulatory regime. The Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) work to build a competitive and innovation-friendly business environment.

Key initiatives include the creation of the:

- * FCA's Regulatory Sandbox
- * Global Financial Innovation Network (GFIN)
- * Open Banking framework

The UK Financial Services Act 2021 represents a major milestone in shaping the regulatory and legislative framework of the UK's post-Brexit financial services landscape.

The City of London Corporation works to strengthen the UK's competitiveness as the world's leading global hub for financial services. It runs The Global City to showcase the UK's offer.

Source: Business.gov.uk

<https://www.business.gov.uk/invest-in-uk/investment/sectors/financial-services/>

Leading Companies

Atom Bank

We're all about making a difference

Whether you want to make the most of your savings, apply for a mortgage or take out a loan for your business, we provide simple, secure products that can make a difference.

Man smiling looking away from phone

We've created a bank that's changing things for the better. We want to improve things for our customers, our people and the world around us, while changing the industry for good.

What's the story?

We were founded in 2014 as the UK's first app-based bank and were the country's first digital-only bank to be granted a regulatory licence.

We're based in the North East of England and we love the region for its culture, energy and sense of community, so we strive to add value wherever we can.

We've grown to a team of over 470 people, many of whom are based in the area. As a progressive employer, we understand the benefits of enabling a diverse bunch of people to shape our business, so we're actively making it easier for individuals from a range of backgrounds to work for us.

<https://www.atombank.co.uk/about-us/>

Barclays plc (LSE: BARC)

Our strategy

We have a clear plan to improve our operational and financial performance, and improve total shareholder returns. To do so, over the next three years we will make Barclays Simpler, Better and More balanced.

Our Priorities

We want Barclays to be renowned for an excellent operational performance, highly satisfied customers and clients, strong liquidity, capital and risk management, and predictable, attractive shareholder returns. Building on our strong foundations, we have a clear plan to achieve these objectives and deliver further value for shareholders by 2026.

<https://home.barclays/who-we-are/our-strategy/>

Barclays PLC Interim Results Announcement

30 July 2026

Performance Highlights

Barclays delivered a return on tangible equity (RoTE) of 14.8% in H126, announced £2.3bn total capital distributions, and is on track to deliver its 2026 and 2028 targets

* S. Venkatakrishnan, Group Chief Executive, commented "I am pleased with another strong quarter for Barclays. Income for Q226 is £8.3bn, up £1.2bn from the same quarter last year. Profit before tax is £3.3bn, up 31% in the same period. Our earnings per share (EPS) has increased 43% to 16.7p, and our cost: income ratio improved to 54% from 59% a year earlier. We have a robust common equity tier 1 (CET1) ratio of 14.3%, above our 13% to 14% target range. We also delivered a RoTE of 16.1%. We continued deploying balance sheet in the UK, with year-on-year loan growth of 5%, and the Investment Bank performed well in a favourable environment, with a RoTE of 16.0%. Our performance supports distributions of £2.3bn for the first half of 2026, up 61% year-on-year. This includes a £1.0bn buyback and a c.£0.8bn dividend announced today. We are upgrading the 2026 Group income target to c.£31.5bn and remain committed to, and confident in, delivering all financial and distribution targets for 2026 and 2028."

- H126 Group RoTE of 14.8% (H125: 13.2%) and Q226 Group RoTE of 16.1% (Q225: 12.3%)
- All divisions delivered double-digit RoTE for H126 and Q226
- H126 EPS of 30.7p (H125: 24.7p) and Q226 EPS of 16.7p (Q225: 11.7p)
- 2026 Group income target increased to c.£31.5bn (from c.£31bn)
- 2026 Group net interest income (NII) excluding Barclays Investment Bank and Head Office increased to greater than £13.7bn (from greater than £13.5bn)
- Strong CET1 ratio of 14.3% and announced intention to initiate a share buyback of up to £1.0bn for Q226, and a dividend of 5.9p per share for H126 (H125: 3.0p)
- 5% growth in UK lending balances year-on-year in H126
- Delivered £25bn of c.£30bn planned UK risk weighted assets (RWAs) growth since 2024¹ (£3bn in Q226), of which £18bn was organic growth

Q226 Performance highlights:

- Group RoTE was 16.1% (Q225: 12.3%) with profit before tax of £3.3bn (Q225: £2.5bn)
- Group income of £8.3bn increased 16% year-on-year. Group NII excluding IB and Head Office was £3.4bn, up 10% year-on-year
- Barclays UK income increased 7%, as higher structural hedge income was partially offset by retail deposit dynamics and mortgage margin compression
- Barclays UK Corporate Bank (UKCB) income increased 8%, reflecting higher average deposit and lending balances, and higher structural hedge income
- Barclays Private Bank and **Wealth Management** (PBWM) income increased 5%, reflecting growth in client balances, partially offset by the impact of deposit mix
- Barclays Investment Bank (IB) income increased 20%, driven by Global Markets and Investment Banking fees
- Barclays US Consumer Bank (USCB) income increased 38%, driven by portfolio changes including a c.£225m gain from the sale of the American Airlines co-branded credit cards portfolio (AA portfolio) and the impact of the Best Egg Inc. (Best Egg) acquisition
- Group total operating expenses were £4.5bn, up 7% year-on-year
- Group operating costs increased to £4.5bn (Q225: £4.1bn), reflecting business growth (including higher performance costs), inflation and further investment spend (including the Best Egg acquisition), partially offset by c.£200m of cost efficiency savings
- Credit impairment charges were £0.6bn (Q225: £0.5bn) with an LLR of 51bps (Q225: 44bps)

For the full release, see:

<https://home.barclays/content/dam/home-barclays/documents/investor-relations/ResultAnnouncements/H12026Results/Q226-BPLC-Results-RA.pdf>

HSBC Holdings plc (LSE: HSBA, NYSE: HSBC)

Our history

Supporting our customers for 160 years

The birth of a bank

HSBC was born from one simple idea – a local bank serving international needs. In March 1865, HSBC opened its doors for business in Hong Kong, helping to finance trade between Europe and Asia.

We have been supporting our customers for 160 years. Today, we serve around 41 million personal, **wealth** and corporate customers worldwide in 57 countries and territories.

The experiences of the past 160 years have formed the character of HSBC. A glance at our history explains why we believe in capital strength, in strict cost control and in building long-term relationships with customers.

The bank has weathered change in all forms – revolutions, economic crises, new technologies – and adapted to survive. The resulting corporate character enables HSBC to meet the challenges of the 21st century.

<https://www.hsbc.com/who-we-are/our-history>

HSBC Holdings plc Interim Results 2026

4 August 2026

Georges Elhedery, Group CEO, said:

“HSBC is becoming the stronger bank we set out to build. We are executing our strategic priorities with pace, precision and discipline. This is allowing our four businesses to focus on their core strengths, grow, work together more effectively and deepen customer relationships. The result is a bank capable of achieving more.”

Financial performance in 1H26

- Profit before tax increased by \$3.7bn or 23% to \$19.5bn compared with 1H25. The increase primarily reflected a year-on-year net favourable impact of \$2.2bn from notable items. The increase also reflected growth in banking net interest income ('banking NII') and higher fee and other income, primarily in **Wealth** and Wholesale Transaction Banking ('WTB'). This was partly offset by higher expected credit losses and other credit impairment charges ('ECL'), and a planned increase in operating expenses. Profit after tax of \$15.3bn was \$2.9bn or 23% higher compared with 1H25.

- In 1H26, notable items included disposal losses of \$0.3bn recognised on classification to held for sale associated with the planned sale of our business in Malta, restructuring costs associated with our organisational simplification of \$0.3bn, and losses of \$0.2bn from the recycling of foreign currency translation reserves following the completion of the sale of our UK life insurance business. In 1H25, notable items included dilution and impairment losses of \$2.1bn related to our associate Bank of Communications Co., Limited ('BoCom'), and restructuring costs associated with our organisational simplification of \$0.6bn.

- Constant currency profit before tax excluding notable items increased by \$1.1bn to \$20.4bn compared with 1H25.

Revenue increased by \$3.6bn or 11% to \$37.7bn compared with 1H25, including a year-on-year net favourable impact of notable items of \$0.8bn and the favourable impact of foreign currency translation differences of \$0.7bn. The remaining increase reflected higher banking NII, and strong growth in **Wealth** fee and other income in our International **Wealth** and Premier Banking ('IWPB') and Hong Kong business segments, supported by higher customer activity. The increase also included a one-off property asset disposal gain of \$0.2bn. Constant currency revenue excluding notable items rose by \$2.0bn to \$38.2bn compared with 1H25.

- Net interest income ('NII') increased by \$1.4bn compared with 1H25, primarily driven by deposit balance growth and the benefit of reinvestment of our structural hedge at higher yields. There was also a favourable impact from foreign currency translation differences of \$0.4bn, partly offset by the impact of an adverse \$0.1bn one-off item. The impact of lower market interest rates on the funding deployed to the trading book was broadly offset by higher trading balances. Banking NII, which excludes the funding costs associated with the trading book and insurance NII, increased by \$1.6bn to \$22.9bn.

- Net interest margin ('NIM') of 1.61% was 4 basis points ('bps') higher compared with 1H25, mainly due to the impact from foreign currency translation differences and the benefit of our structural hedge, partly offset by lower market interest rates.

- ECL of \$2.4bn were \$0.4bn higher than in 1H25. The 1H26 charge primarily reflected stage 3 charges on wholesale exposures, including a \$0.4bn fraud-related, secondary, securitisation exposure with a financial sponsor in the UK in our Corporate and Institutional Banking ('CIB') business, and \$0.2bn related to the Hong Kong commercial real estate ('CRE') sector. 1H26 also included allowances to reflect uncertainty due to the ongoing conflict in the Middle East. ECL in 1H25 included charges related to the Hong Kong CRE sector of \$0.5bn, as well as allowance increases relating to geopolitical tensions and higher trade tariffs.

- Operating expenses of \$17.4bn were \$0.4bn or 2% higher than in 1H25, including an adverse impact from foreign currency translation differences of \$0.4bn. The increase was driven by higher planned spend and investment in technology, and the impact of inflation. These increases were partly mitigated by cost reductions from our organisational simplification and a year-on-year favourable impact from notable items.
- Target basis operating expenses were \$0.4bn or 2% higher than in 1H25, including the impact of inflation and higher planned spend and investment in technology, partly offset by cost reductions from our organisational simplification.
- Customer lending balances increased by \$34bn compared with 31 December 2025, including adverse foreign currency translation differences of \$6bn. On a constant currency basis, lending balances increased by \$40bn, reflecting growth across all our business segments, particularly in our main entity in Hong Kong. This was partly offset by the classification to held for sale of loans from the planned sale of our business in Malta.
- Customer accounts increased by \$41bn compared with 31 December 2025, including adverse foreign currency translation differences of \$15bn. On a constant currency basis, customer accounts increased by \$56bn, primarily reflecting growth in our CIB business, partly offset by the classification to held for sale of deposits from the planned sale of our business in Malta and our retail banking business in Indonesia.
- Common equity tier 1 ('CET1') capital ratio of 14.1% decreased by 0.8 percentage points compared with 31 December 2025, reflecting the impact of the privatisation of Hang Seng Bank Limited ('Hang Seng Bank'), dividends and an increase in risk-weighted assets ('RWAs'), partly offset by regulatory profit.
- The Board has approved a second interim dividend of \$0.10 per share. We also intend to initiate a share buy-back of up to \$1bn, which we expect to complete by our third quarter 2026 results announcement.

Financial performance in 2Q26

- Profit before tax increased by \$3.8bn or 60% to \$10.1bn compared with 2Q25, primarily reflecting a net favourable impact from notable items of \$2.6bn. The increase also reflected growth in banking NII, and higher fee and other income primarily in **Wealth** and WTB. Profit after tax increased by \$3.1bn or 63% to \$7.9bn compared with 2Q25.
- In 2Q26, notable items included restructuring costs associated with our organisational simplification of \$0.2bn. In 2Q25, notable items included dilution and impairment losses of \$2.1bn related to our associate BoCom, and restructuring costs associated with our organisational simplification of \$0.5bn.
- Revenue increased by \$2.6bn to \$19.1bn compared with 2Q25, including a year-on-year net favourable impact of \$1.3bn from notable items. The increase also reflected a rise in banking NII, and strong growth in **Wealth** fee and other income in our IWPB and Hong Kong business segments, supported by higher customer activity. Revenue grew in Debt and Equity Markets and WTB in our CIB business. Constant currency revenue excluding notable items rose by \$1.3bn to \$19.0bn.
- ECL of \$1.1bn were stable compared with 2Q25. The charge in 2Q26 primarily comprised stage 3 charges, including \$0.2bn related to the Hong Kong CRE sector. The ECL charge in 2Q25 included charges of \$0.4bn related to the Hong Kong CRE sector.
- Operating expenses of \$8.7bn were \$0.2bn or 2% lower compared with 2Q25, reflecting lower restructuring costs together with the resultant cost reduction benefits from our organisational simplification, and the phasing of performance-related pay accrual relative to 2Q25. These reductions were partly offset by higher planned spend and investment in technology, the impact of inflation and an adverse impact from foreign currency translation differences of \$0.1bn.
- Customer lending increased by \$20bn compared with 1Q26 on a reported basis, reflecting growth across all segments.
- Customer accounts increased by \$46bn compared with 1Q26 on a reported basis, primarily reflecting growth in our CIB business, notably in Hong Kong, partly offset by the classification of deposits from the planned sale of our retail banking business in Indonesia to held for sale.

For the full release, see:

<https://www.hsbc.com/news-and-views/news/media-releases/2026/hsbc-holdings-plc-interim-results-2026>

Lloyds Banking Group (LSE: LLOY)

About us

Lloyds Banking Group is a leading UK-based financial services group. We provide a wide range of banking and financial services, focused primarily on retail and commercial customers.

<https://www.lloydsbankinggroup.com/who-we-are/group-overview.html>

2026 half year results

RESULTS FOR THE HALF-YEAR

"Lloyds Banking Group continues to deliver for customers, colleagues, communities and shareholders. Our purpose of Helping Britain Prosper has never been more important. As the UK's largest financial services provider, our purpose drives our strategy and creates opportunity for people and businesses, shaping finance as a force for good.

In the first half of 2026, we delivered sustained strength in financial performance, with continued income growth, improving operating leverage, strong credit performance, growing capital generation and increasing shareholder returns.

We are successfully completing our 2022 to 2026 strategy, focusing on customer experience, pivoting the Group to growth and laying the foundations for our exciting new strategy. We have strengthened our market leadership, built our digital and AI capabilities, and enhanced our cost and capital leadership, while remaining on track to deliver our 2026 financial targets.

This ensures the Group is well placed to launch our new strategy, Accelerate 2030, from a position of strength. Building on our leadership position we will accelerate through reimagined customer experiences, increased Group connectivity, and a productivity step-change, all enabled by pioneering technology. Our strategy will allow us to unlock the next phase of growth and sustainable value creation for our shareholders." Charlie Nunn, Group Chief Executive

Successfully delivering our purpose-driven strategy

- Successfully delivering the 2022 to 2026 strategy; growing market share in key areas, further improving our digital and AI leadership, and disciplined cost and capital optimisation
- Continuing to transform the Group, building digital engagement, modernising our infrastructure and delivering enhanced operating leverage, while tightly managing risk
- On track for £2 billion of strategic initiative income by the end of 2026, on track to deliver an 8% compound annual growth rate in underlying other income from 2021 to 2026, and have generated more than £2 billion of gross cost savings to date
- Launching Accelerate 2030 strategy; growing in core areas, innovating to deepen and diversify our propositions and further simplifying the Group

Sustained strength in financial performance¹

- Statutory profit before tax of £4.3 billion (half-year to 30 June 2025: £3.5 billion) benefitting from higher total income and controlled costs, partially offset by higher charges for operating lease depreciation and impairment. Return on tangible equity of 17.1%
- Underlying net interest income of £7.3 billion, up 9% year-on-year. Reflecting a higher banking net interest margin of 3.19%, up 15 basis points (up 5 basis points in the second quarter compared to the first quarter), due to strong structural hedge income, franchise-led volume growth and average interest-earning banking asset growth of 4% to £475.7 billion, partially offset by asset margin compression
- Underlying other income of £3.3 billion, 11% higher year-on-year. Driven by strengthening customer activity and the continued benefit of investments in strategic initiatives

- Operating lease depreciation of £841 million. Up 18% due to a charge in the second quarter for declines in used car prices alongside fleet growth and the depreciation of higher value vehicles, partially offset by continued risk mitigation
- Operating costs of £4.9 billion, flat compared to the first half of 2025. This reflected business growth costs, inflationary pressures and the full acquisition of Schroders Personal **Wealth** (now Lloyds **Wealth**) in the fourth quarter of 2025, offset by continued cost savings, a lower severance expense and plateauing investment as this strategic cycle culminates. Remediation costs totaled £39 million across a small number of programmes
- Strong and stable credit performance. Underlying impairment charge of £617 million, resulting in an asset quality ratio of 25 basis points. This includes an £80 million net charge from updated multiple economic scenarios, compared to a small credit in the prior year

For the full release, see:

<https://www.lloydsbankinggroup.com/assets/pdfs/investors/financial-performance/lloyds-banking-group-plc/2026/q2/2026-lbg-hy-results.pdf>

OneSavings Bank (LSE: OSB)

About us

OSB Group is a UK listed bank supporting underserved segments of the mortgage market with over 150 years heritage. Our team of experts deliver specialist lending and retail savings through our industry leading brands.

Our Purpose

To help our customers, colleagues and communities prosper.

By that we mean more than just helping them to be more financially well off. We want them to flourish, thrive and succeed in their personal and professional goals.

Our Vision

To be recognised as the UK's number one choice of specialist bank, through our commitment to exceptional service, strong relationships and competitive propositions.

By working Stronger together, Taking ownership, Aiming high and Respecting others, we will more powerfully achieve our own goals, as well as our stakeholders'.

But we are not just focused on lending and savings (though that is what we do and what we are great at); we are a business that cares about leaving things better than we found them. We are passionate about our final value, Stewardship, which encourages us to give back to our communities, supporting those who are vulnerable or less fortunate, embracing diversity and finding new ways to protect our environment.

It does not matter where we are working from; a branch, on the road, in the office or from home. It does not even matter that we are not all in the same country, we are clear about what we want to achieve. We know how we want to achieve it and we are absolutely determined to build upon the foundations we have created so our customers, shareholders, communities and our people can all prosper.

<https://www.osb.co.uk/about-us/our-business-model>

Interim Report for the six months ended 30 June 2026

6 August 2026

This announcement contains inside information for the purposes of Article 7 of the UK Market Abuse Regulation. Upon the publication of this announcement, this inside information is now considered to be in the public domain.

OSB GROUP PLC (OSBG or the Group), the specialist lending and retail savings group, announces today its results for the six months ended 30 June 2026.

Andy Golding, Group CEO, said: "The Group delivered a resilient financial and operational performance in the first half of 2026 against a volatile macroeconomic backdrop.

Our Buy-to-Let and Residential franchises performed well in the period. Originations grew moderately in our higher-yielding sub-segments compared to the prior period, despite macroeconomic uncertainty and elevated mortgage rates. The transformation programme continued at pace and I am pleased that we have soft launched Residential products on the new lending platform and our savings migration is progressing well.

We have seen strong competition in the retail savings market and elevated retail funding costs so far this year. We have made the conservative assumption that these pressures will not ease, if that is the case, we now expect net interest margin for 2026 to be 215bps to 220bps.

We continue to expect administrative expenses to be c.£280m, excluding costs related to the incoming CEO.

Our net loan book growth guidance for the year remains unchanged.

We now expect return on tangible equity (RoTE) for 2026 to be c.12.5%, assuming elevated costs of funds continue and excluding costs related to the incoming CEO.

Whilst it is too early to be more precise, if the funding cost pressures seen so far this year continue, this could result in a modest impact on our 2027 mid-teens RoTE aspiration.

We have confidence in delivering on our longer-term 2028 - 2029 aspirations supported by both mechanical factors, including MREL and back book roll-off, and management actions such as continued loan book diversification and benefits from our transformation programme.

Further to my retirement announcement, I will be stepping down as CEO and Board Director with effect from 31 August 2026. Enrique Alvarez Labiano's appointment as the Group CEO and Board Director will take effect from 1 September 2026. I wish him every success as he takes the business forward." David Weymouth, Chair of the Board, said: "I and the whole OSB Group Board would like to acknowledge and thank Andy for his significant contribution to growing OSB into the UK's largest specialist lender over the last 14 years. The Group's success was driven by his strong leadership, strategic vision and focus on growing deposits and broadening the Group's lending profile. He has delivered substantial shareholder value and shareholder returns of over £1.3bn since 2019. We all wish him well in his future endeavors."

<https://www.osb.co.uk/media/oodnfskp/osbg-2026-interim-results.pdf>

Natwest Group

The Royal Bank of Scotland plc (1727-date) is part of NatWest Group.

[https://www.natwestgroup.com/heritage/companies/the-royal-bank-of-scotland-plc.html#:~:text=The%20Royal%20Bank%20of%20Scotland%20plc%20\(1727%2Ddate\)%20is,as%20The%20Thre%20Banks%20Group](https://www.natwestgroup.com/heritage/companies/the-royal-bank-of-scotland-plc.html#:~:text=The%20Royal%20Bank%20of%20Scotland%20plc%20(1727%2Ddate)%20is,as%20The%20Thre%20Banks%20Group) .

<https://www.rbs.com/rbs/about/update-on-parent-name.html#:~:text=We%20have%20announced%20that%20we,80%25%20of%20our%20customer%20base> .

Who we are

We're a UK-focussed bank serving over 20 million customers, with businesses across retail, commercial and private banking markets.

<https://www.natwestgroup.com/who-we-are/about-natwest-group.html>

H1 2026 NatWest Group Results

31 July 2026

Chief Executive, Paul Thwaite, commented:

"NatWest Group's strong performance in the first half of the year shows that our strategy is consistently delivering for customers and shareholders. We are growing all three of our customer businesses, becoming even more efficient and delivering market-leading returns, with a Return on Tangible Equity of 19.7%.

Our performance is grounded in the support we provide to more than 20 million customers throughout the UK, helping them to plan, save and invest, to get on the housing ladder and to scale and grow their businesses. As a result, deposits, lending and assets under management all continued to grow over the past six months.

We are confident in the scale and capabilities we're building and the opportunities ahead. Through our long-standing relationships, deep regional presence, and responsible adoption of AI, we are well placed to accelerate our progress by doing even more to meet our customers' needs, as well as helping to generate growth in every nation and region of the UK.

The consistency of our performance, coupled with the completion of our Evelyn Partners acquisition, has given us the confidence to strengthen our guidance for 2026, whilst our continued capital generation means we have today announced an interim dividend of 12.0p per share and that we will consider share-buybacks from full year 2026, six months earlier than previously planned."

Strong financial performance

We delivered a strong financial performance in H1 2026, with attributable profit of £3.0 billion and Return on Tangible Equity (RoTE) of 19.7%. Capital generation pre-distributions was 137 basis points, before the impact of the acquisition of Evelyn Partners, and earnings per share was 38.1 pence, up 23.3% on prior year.

Strong growth as we deepen customer relationships

We are progressing well against our strategic priorities, expanding capabilities to meet more of our customers' needs. We have three growing customer businesses, delivering strong returns, underpinned by trusted customer relationships and a proven track record of customer assets and liabilities (CAL) expansion.

- CAL increased by £95.2 billion, or 10.7%, in H1 2026 including £71.7 billion of assets under management and administration (AUMA) balances relating to the acquisition of Evelyn Partners and £23.5 billion, or 2.6%, of growth in our existing business.

- In Retail Banking we are growing our share in savings and investments and have supported customers with 20% more Individual Savings Accounts (ISAs) opened, and 32% more customers now invest with us than in H1 2025. We delivered £8.2 billion of mortgage lending to First Time Buyers and continue to broaden our mortgage proposition through partnerships with Rightmove and Landbay.

- In Private Banking & **Wealth Management** our focus on deepening customer relationships delivered record AUM net inflows of £2.0 billion, equivalent to 9.2% of opening balances on an annualised basis. These inflows were supported by over 45,000 customers across the Group investing with us for the first time, up more than 60% compared with H1 2025.

- In Commercial & Institutional we continued to support long-term economic growth and maintained our leading position in UK infrastructure and project finance. We provided over £1.9 billion to the social housing sector(1) in H1 2026, keeping us on track to meet our £10 billion ambition by the end of 2028. We continue to be one of the leading banks for UK start-ups, helping 1 in 5 new businesses get started. We are strengthening the UK innovation ecosystem by expanding our Accelerator network, opening new university hubs in Brighton and York, and increasing our Venture Banking customers.

For the full release, see:

<https://www.natwestgroup.com/news-and-insights/latest-stories/financial-reporting/2026/jul/h1-2026-natwest-group-results.html>

Standard Chartered (LSE: STAN)

Who we are

We are a global bank connecting corporate, institutional and affluent clients to a network that offers unique access to sustainable growth opportunities across Asia, Africa and the Middle East.

<https://www.sc.com/en/about/>

Standard Chartered releases Second Quarter and Half Year 2026 Results

29 Jul 2026

We've released our financial results for the first half and second quarter ended 30 June 2026.

For more details, please visit our Investor Relations section.

All figures are presented on a reported basis and comparisons are made to 2025 on a constant currency basis, unless otherwise stated.

Bill Winters, Group Chief Executive, said:

"We delivered a record first-half performance in 2026, with double-digit growth in **Wealth** Solutions and Global Banking. Our performance demonstrates the strength of our differentiated international network and the disciplined execution of our strategy. Clients continue to turn to us to facilitate trade, investment and **wealth** flows across the world's most dynamic markets. We delivered a 17 per cent increase in our earnings per share, and our upgraded income guidance and new share buyback of USD1 billion reflect our confidence in the business."

Manus Costello, Group Chief Financial Officer, said:

"We are now compounding the growth of our powerful franchise while investing to build a simpler, faster and more connected bank that meets the evolving needs of our clients. At the same time, we remain disciplined on expenses and focused on managing capital tightly.

Together, these strengths give us confidence in our ability to deliver exceptional growth and sustainably higher returns."

Selected information on H1'26 financial performance with comparisons to H1'25 unless otherwise stated

- * Record operating income up 6 per cent to USD11.6 billion, up 8 per cent excluding the Solv India transaction
- * Net interest income¹ (NII) up 4 per cent to USD5.7 billion; Non-interest income¹ up 8 per cent to USD5.9 billion
- * **Wealth** Solutions up 38 per cent, driven by strong growth in investment products
- * Global Banking up 19 per cent, driven by strong origination activity and strong capital market activity
- * Operating expenses up 1 per cent to USD6.3 billion, up 2 per cent excluding notables²
- * Credit impairment charge of USD446 million with USD296 million from **Wealth** & Retail Banking (WRB) and USD150 million from Corporate & Investment Banking (CIB) mostly driven by management overlays relating to the Middle East conflict
- * Record profit before tax of USD4.8 billion, up 9 per cent
- * Tax charge of USD1.1 billion; effective tax rate of 23.3 per cent
- * Return on Tangible Equity (RoTE) of 17.6 per cent, up 120bps
- * Earnings per share increased 17 per cent to 151.6 cents

Selected information of Q2'26 financial performance with comparisons to Q2'25 unless otherwise stated

- * Operating income of USD5.7 billion up 3 per cent
- * Excluding USD238 million gain on the Solv India transaction in Q2'25, income is up 8 per cent
- * NII¹ up 7 per cent to USD2.9 billion; driven by volumes and improved balance sheet mix
- * Non-interest income¹ of USD2.8 billion was broadly flat, up 9 per cent excluding the Solv India transaction; driven by continued momentum in **Wealth** Solutions and Global Banking
- * **Wealth** Solutions up 43 per cent, mostly driven by strong double-digit growth in Investment Products
- * Global Banking up 18 per cent, driven by strong origination activity and increased capital markets activity
- * Operating expenses were broadly flat, up 3 per cent excluding a notable item of USD74 million release of provisions on Korea equity-linked securities (ELS) portfolio

* Credit impairment charge of USD150 million up USD31 million. WRB charge of USD116 million down USD49 million mainly from portfolio actions. CIB charge of USD39 million was up USD78 million mostly from management overlays partly offset by releases

* Profit before tax of USD2.3 billion, up 2 per cent

* RoTE of 17.9 per cent, broadly flat

* Balance sheet remains strong, liquid and well diversified with underlying loans and advances to customers up 2.2 per cent and underlying customer deposits up 2 per cent quarter-on-quarter

* Risk-weighted assets (RWA) of USD261.5 billion, down USD4.7 billion since 31.3.26; Credit risk RWA down USD3.4 billion, Market RWA down USD1.4 billion, and Operational RWA flat

* The Group remains strongly capitalised with Common Equity Tier 1 (CET1) ratio of 14.2 per cent up 77bps quarter-on-quarter

* USD1 billion share buyback starting imminently is expected to reduce CET1 ratio by 38bps

* Interim ordinary dividend increased 66 per cent to 20.4 cents per share (USD448 million)

* Tangible net asset value per share of USD17.55, up 4 per cent

Guidance

Our revised 2026 guidance is as follows:

* Operating income growth year-on-year to be around the middle of the 5-7 per cent range at constant currency and excluding material notable2 items

* Within which, net interest income1 expected to be low single digit percentage growth year-on-year at constant currency

* Expenses excluding notables2 expected to be around USD13.3 billion at constant currency

* RoTE to be greater than 12 per cent.

<https://www.sc.com/en/press-release/half-year-2026-results/>

Secure Trust Bank (LSE: STB)

Here to help you fulfil your ambitions

It's what we've been doing since 1952

We are an award-winning UK retail bank, providing savings accounts and lending services to over a million customers. In 2022 the Group celebrated 70 years of helping consumers and businesses fulfil their ambitions.

Our approachable teams are based at our Solihull headquarters and offices in Cardiff, London, Manchester and Reading. We are making good progress towards our vision to be the most trusted specialist lender in the UK.

Since 1952, Secure Trust Bank has been here to help you fulfil your ambitions. Our Savings business in Solihull offers bonds and savings accounts, whilst the Real Estate Finance team offer finance to experienced developers for residential, commercial and mixed use development schemes, as well as professional landlords. Meanwhile, our business and commercial division in Manchester provides companies with refinance options to help them grow.

V12 is our retail finance division in Cardiff that has an underwriting team, as well as risk and fraud departments, plus a call centre. V12 arrange and administer retail finance loans for national brands and retail partners all over the UK, helping customers buy the things they want.

<https://www.securetrustbank.com/about-us>

SECURE TRUST BANK PLC 2025 Annual Results and Investor Update Event: updated strategic plans and medium-term targets

12 March 2026

Secure Trust Bank PLC ('STB', 'Secure Trust Bank', or the 'Group'), a leading specialist bank, will host its 2025 Annual Results and Investor Update event for analysts and institutional investors today, 12 March 2026.

A live webcast of the presentation and slides will be available at the following link at 13.00: https://brrmedia.news/STB_FY25_Investor_Update. The Annual Results presentation will begin at 13.00, with the Investor Update presentation to begin at 14.15. The event will cover the Group's 2025 annual results and refreshed strategic plans, including product driven growth opportunities, and its capital allocation strategy.

The event includes presentations from the CEO, CFO and management of the Retail Finance, Business Finance and Savings divisions.

2025 Financial highlights¹ :

- Achieved return on average equity ('ROAE') of 14.3% (2024: 14.6%)
- Delivered continuing profit before tax of £59.3 million (2024: £59.4 million)
- Common Equity Tier 1 ('CET 1') ratio improved by 60 bps to 12.9% (2024: 12.3%)
- Sale of Consumer Vehicle Finance business further increases CET 1 ratio to 14.7%² on a pro forma basis
- Growth in lending balances of 8.1% to £3.3 billion (2024: £3.1 billion)
- Cost income ratio improved by 220 bps to 45.2% (2024: 47.4%)
- Tangible book value per share increased by 5.8% to £19.73 per share (2024: £18.64 per share)
- Increased total dividend to 35.5 pence per share (2024: 33.8 pence per share), in line with progressive dividend policy
- Committing £10 million of capital to initiate a share buyback programme to be delivered over 12 months, subject to regulatory approval Strategic update
- Refreshed strategic priorities centred on product expansion, effective digital solutions and capital discipline will deliver targeted growth for higher returns
- New medium-term targets of c.10% annual growth and ROAE above 16%
- Simplified business on clear trajectory to grow in large scale markets at lower cost of risk
- Investment in cost efficiency alongside operating leverage will drive strong cost income ratio

Strategic update

- Refreshed strategic priorities centred on product expansion, effective digital solutions and capital discipline will deliver targeted growth for higher returns
- New medium-term targets of c.10% annual growth and ROAE above 16%
- Simplified business on clear trajectory to grow in large scale markets at lower cost of risk
- Investment in cost efficiency alongside operating leverage will drive strong cost income ratio

2025 Annual Results

The Group achieved strong levels of new business lending, leading to an 8.1% increase in net lending balances to £3.3 billion (2024: £3.1 billion). Retail Finance grew 8.0%, as the business continued to leverage the strength of its retail distribution network. Business Finance grew by 8.1%, driven by Real Estate Finance which grew by 9.4% and continued momentum in Commercial Finance, delivering 3.2% growth in net lending balances. Strong pricing discipline across the Group in a falling rate environment contributed to stable net interest margin ('NIM') of 4.7% (2024: 4.7%).

Customer deposits increased 8.2% year on year to £3.5 billion (2024: £3.2 billion), supporting growth in the lending book, and remaining stable relative to the half year. The rundown of the Vehicle Finance portfolio reduced the need for additional funding in the second half of the year. The Group fully repaid its Bank of England Term Funding Scheme with additional incentives for SMEs ('TFSME') balances in 2025 (2024: £230.0 million). The Group has £201.2 million (2024: £125.7 million) of funding through sale and repurchase arrangements.

Cost income ratio improved to 45.2% (2024: 47.4%) reflecting strong income growth and effective cost management in an inflationary environment, and the delivery of operational efficiencies through our cost optimisation programme, Project Fusion3. In 2025, operating expenses included £2.5 million of non-recurring costs relating to changes in senior leadership; excluding these items, the cost income ratio would have been 43.7%.

Cost of risk increased to 1.0% (2024: 0.8%). This reflects the impact of three specific cases in Business Finance and a normalisation of impairment charges in Retail Finance, following the impact of one-off model benefits.

The Group was capital accretive in 2025 and strengthened its capital position in the year, improving the CET 1 ratio by 60 bps to 12.9% (2024: 12.3%). The sale of the Consumer Vehicle Finance business, which completed on 25 February 2026, further increases the CET 1 ratio on a pro forma basis to 14.7%².

For the full release, see:

<https://www.securetrustbank.com/investor-relations/document-library/press-release-2025-final-905476464137>

Virgin Money UK plc (LSE: VMUK, ASX: VUK)

About us

Virgin Money is so much more than just a bank. As part of the Nationwide Building Society, we are driven by our purpose, Banking – but fairer, more rewarding, and for the good of society.

Banking – but fairer, more rewarding, and for the good of society.

We offer red-hot products and services to meet the full range of our 6.6m customers' retail and business banking needs via our leading technology platform, telephone banking and a network of innovative branches and business banking centres.

Visit Virgin Money to find out more about what we offer for our customers.

As a Virgin company, we are also committed to being a force for good. Guided by our Purpose, we seek to drive social and environmental impact. This includes tackling the poverty premium, offering products that aim to help our customers make a positive impact on society and the environment, providing grants through the Virgin Money Foundation to enable local organizations to improve their communities, and helping build the next generation of budding entrepreneurs while boosting their confidence in managing money through our Make £5 Grow programme.

You can find out more by visiting our Corporate Sustainability section.

<https://www.virginmoneyukplc.com/about-us/>

Document ACQIND0020260812em8a0002e

HSBC Group: Malaysia's affluent and high-net-worth investors rank among the highest in adopting AI for Finance, but more than half want Human-AI Synergy in making financial decisions

Distributed by Contify.com

971 words

10 August 2026

Islamic Finance News - Contify

ATISFN

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Malaysia's affluent investors adopt AI for finance at 85%.
- * 58% prefer Human-AI synergy for financial decisions.
- * HSBC launches **Wealth** Intelligence, AI-driven platform for RM.

Original Press Release:

Aug. 10 -- HSBC Group issued the following news release:

- Malaysia is among the top 3 markets surveyed with the highest adoption of AI in finance at 85%, surpassing the global average of 73%.
- More than half (58%) of Malaysia's affluent and high-net-worth investors value a hybrid approach combining AI with the expertise of financial professionals and institutions when making decisions.
- Gen Z and Millennials are leading the use of AI for finance and investment ideas.

Affluent and high-net-worth investors in Malaysia are adopting AI tools for finance and investment, but they still rely heavily on the critical oversight that comes from human professional judgement. This is why more than half, or 58% still want human-AI synergy in making financial decisions.

A new survey of around 10,000 affluent and high-net-worth individuals across 10 markets, commissioned by HSBC and conducted by Ipsos, shows AI has become a widely used tool among these investors. Malaysia ranked among the top three markets for AI adoption in finance at 85%, level with mainland China (85%) and trailing only India (86%). Aside from finance, these investors are also using AI for work and career (64%) and for personal development (64%).

Despite the strong interest in AI for finance, these investors still rank financial professionals and institutions as the leading source of investment ideas (65%) and the most influential factor in investment decisions (39%), more than double the influence of AI tools (16%).

When asked why investors turn to financial professionals and institutions when making financial decisions, 85% cite reassurance and 76% cite strategic expertise. This includes spotting mistakes in AI-generated data (31%), providing personalised interpretation of complex data (31%) and applying judgement and validation (30%).

Linda Yip, Country Head of International **Wealth** and Premier Banking, HSBC Malaysia, said: "Technology gives us speed, but human connection builds trust. The future of banking lies in a seamless partnership between AI-driven insights and human expertise. By pairing advanced analytics with human relationships, we aim to support our clients with the confidence to navigate, invest and pursue growth in an increasingly complex financial landscape."

Across the generations surveyed, Gen-Z(aged 21-29) and Millennials (aged 30-45) make up the heaviest users of AI for financial and investment decisions, at 86% and 89% respectively, followed by Generation X (aged 46 to 61) at 85% and Baby Boomers (aged 62-69) at 78%.

While AI use is high across generations, the data shows it does not remove the need for professional insights within any age group. 58% of respondents in Malaysia say their ideal future financial decision-making approach is driven by the Human-AI partnership. For Gen Z, this includes analysing portfolio performance (61%) and generating new investment ideas (57%); for Millennials, the pattern is similar at 53% for both tasks.

AI use also appears linked to shifts in sentiment among these investors. 57% say it makes them feel more in control of their investments, compared with 21% who say it makes them feel less in control. More than half (54%) say AI makes them more willing to take calculated risks – more than double the 25% who say it makes them more cautious.

HSBC Malaysia is advancing the Human-AI hybrid approach through the launch of **Wealth** Intelligence, a generative AI-enabled platform that analyses and summarises insights from data sources. These include HSBC Chief Investment Office house views, market commentary, and comprehensive analysis of unit trust funds, helping Relationship Managers work toward more effective and valuable customer conversations.

This initiative reflects HSBC's commitment to developing innovative AI solutions for both customers and colleagues. By strengthening the role of Relationship Managers with personalised, data-driven insights, HSBC seeks to help Relationship Managers provide customers with information that is timely, relevant, and practical to support the conversations underlying their investment decisions. **Wealth** Intelligence generated insights are for internal use by Relationship Managers and does not itself provide investment advice or recommendations to customers.

Methodology

HSBC's survey findings are based on insights from 9,993 affluent and high-net-worth individual investors aged between 21 and 69 with minimum investable assets of USD100,000 and USD2 million respectively. The research was conducted by Ipsos Asia Limited on behalf of HSBC online from 6 January to 6 February 2026 in mainland China, Hong Kong, India, Malaysia, Mexico, Singapore, Taiwan, the UAE, the UK and the US.

HSBC Malaysia

HSBC's presence in Malaysia dates back to 1884 when the Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited established its first office in the country on the island of Penang, with the permission to issue currency notes. HSBC Bank Malaysia Berhad was locally incorporated in 1984 and is a wholly-owned subsidiary of The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited, founding member of the HSBC Group. In 2007, HSBC Bank Malaysia was the first foreign bank to be awarded an Islamic banking subsidiary licence in Malaysia, namely HSBC Amanah Malaysia Berhad. HSBC Malaysia offers a comprehensive range of banking and financial services, including Islamic financial solutions. HSBC Malaysia has also led innovation in Malaysia by introducing Malaysia's first ATM and Electronic Touch Banking in the early 1980s. Today, HSBC Malaysia has launched innovative solutions such as HSBCnet for secure banking for businesses, Trade Transaction Tracker and Facial Recognition on supported mobile phones.

Disclaimer: The Above Content is Auto-Translated

[Category: New Offerings, Artificial Intelligence]

Source: HSBC Group

Document ATISFN0020260812em8a00006

Capital: Singapore: Valuing life insurers and why Great Eastern's rally has been so strong

By Goola Warden of The Edge Singapore

585 words

10 August 2026

The Edge Malaysia (Weekly)

EDGEWK

English

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In general, Singapore's financial services stocks rallied. Great Eastern Holdings (GEH) is up 41% in the year to July 29. Its parent, Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation (OCBC), has gained 48% in the same time, and it has outperformed the other two banks. DBS has gained 32% and UOB 25%. JP Morgan is up 6.98% this year, while the MSCI USA Banks 20/35 Capped Index, which measures the performance of the large and mid-cap securities in the US, is up 6.99%.

Was GEH the cause of OCBC's outperformance? It is now trading at a price-to-comprehensive equity of 1.39 times and must be among the most expensive life insurance companies in Singapore and Hong Kong. Investors are certainly valuing GEH higher than AIA and Prudential, against which it is often benchmarked.

During OCBC's offer to privatise GEH, which started in 2024 and concluded in July last year, GEH was not trading. It resumed trading in August 2025 at S\$13.50. Since its relisting, its share price has moved higher, resulting in one of the best performances of a mega-cap (with market capitalisation of more than S\$20 billion) this year.

On July 24, part of the reason that GEH has done so well emerged. Allianz agreed to pay S\$2.7 billion (RM8.6 billion) for 100% of HSBC Life. According to the Allianz statement, there are numerous reasons for acquiring HSBC Life. They include Singapore's GDP growth, AAA credit rating, a stable political environment with a very stable currency, and attractive insurance and **wealth** dynamics.

Of note is that in Allianz's view, Singapore is the largest life insurance market in Southeast Asia. More importantly, Allianz is expecting a return on investment of more than 10% in the "short- to mid-term". Its contractual service margin (CSM) growth is well above Allianz's overall group target.

CSM is the carrying amount of an insurance contract group representing the unearned profit that an entity expects to recognise as it provides future insurance contract services. Simply put, it is the untouched profit that an insurance company has locked away in a long-term policy. It's the money the company expects to make from that policy, but they aren't allowed to count it as earnings all at once.

European life insurers such as Allianz have moved away from embedded value to comprehensive equity to value life insurance companies. Comprehensive equity is the sum of shareholders' funds plus CSM net of reinsurance contracts and tax.

Allianz is paying around 1.5 times HSBC Life's comprehensive equity of €1.2 billion (RM5.6 billion). GEH's performance and potential are likely to be as positive as HSBC Life's because of its market positioning.

Income Insurance does not report its comprehensive equity, so analysts have estimated it. It is likely to have been valued at around 1.3 times based on Allianz's offer for Income in 2024. At the time, Allianz offered to acquire 51% of Income. The valuation for HSBC Life is higher because Allianz is acquiring 100%.

Is GEH undervalued and should it trade at more than 1.5 times comprehensive equity? That remains to be seen.

Goola Warden is an executive editor at The Edge Singapore. This article was first published in The Edge Singapore on Aug 3, 2026

Document EDGEWK0020260812em8a0000h

DBIL extends INR 5.2 billion construction finance facility

Distributed by Contify.com

1,195 words

10 August 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Funds 1.1 million sq. ft. LEED Platinum pre-certified office tower in Pune
- * Project supports growing demand for high-quality, sustainable office spaces
- * DBS committed to financing high-quality, sustainable assets in India

Original Press Release:

India, Aug. 10 -- DBS Bank Ltd issued the following news release:

- Facility to support K Raheja Corp's commercial development comprising approximately 1.1 million sq. ft. of Grade A office space in Balewadi, Pune's business district

DBS Bank India today announced the extension of a construction finance facility of INR 5.2 billion to a special purpose vehicle (SPV) of K Raheja Corp for the development of a LEED Platinum pre-certified commercial tower in Balewadi, Pune, spanning approximately 1.1 million square feet.

The development is being built to globally recognised green building standards, reflecting a focus on sustainability across both construction and long-term operations. Located in one of Pune's fastest-growing business districts, the project is designed to address the growing need for high-quality, future-ready office spaces.

India's commercial real estate sector continues to witness strong momentum, driven by business expansion, increasing demand from global capability centres, and a growing emphasis on quality, sustainability and operational efficiency. Pune remains one of the country's leading commercial hubs, supported by a robust technology ecosystem, a strong talent pool and ongoing infrastructure development.

Santanu Mitra, Managing Director & Country Head, Corporate Banking (Large and Midcap), DBS Bank India, said, "As businesses increasingly seek high-quality, environmentally responsible workplaces, demand for future-ready commercial developments continues to grow. We are pleased to partner with K Raheja Corp on this landmark project in Pune, reflecting our commitment to supporting sustainable development through tailored financing solutions and deep sector expertise."

Vinod Rohira, MD and CEO, K Raheja Corp, said, "Balewadi is fast becoming the epicentre of Pune's commercial growth story. As GCCs and growth-stage enterprises expand here, they seek cutting-edge ecosystems built to attract top talent and support business growth. That is exactly what this development delivers. For us, sustainability is not a feature we add on; it is integral to how we build. In DBS Bank India, we have found a partner whose commitment to high-quality, sustainable assets mirrors our own."

This transaction reflects DBS Bank India's commitment to financing high-quality assets that support India's urban and economic development while advancing sustainability objectives. DBS works closely with clients to deliver tailored financing solutions that support long-term growth and value creation.

DBS Bank India was named Best Bank for ESG in India at the Euromoney Awards for Excellence 2026. The bank was also awarded Best Bank for Sustainable Finance in India by Global Finance in 2024.

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named "World's Best AI Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Digital Bank" by Euromoney and the winner of multiple digital assets awards. In addition, DBS has been accorded the "Safest Bank in Asia" award by Global Finance for 17 consecutive years from 2009 to 2025. DBS Bank India was recognised by CRISIL Coalition Greenwich as the Best Bank for Corporate Cash Management in India in 2025 and 2026. The bank was also named Best Bank for ESG in India at the Euromoney Awards for Excellence 2026 and was recognised as the Best Bank in Emerging Tech and AI at the Business Today-KPMG India's Best Banks Awards 2026.

DBS provides a full range of services in Consumer, **Wealth**, SME and corporate banking. As a bank born and bred in Asia, DBS understands the intricacies of doing business in the region's most dynamic markets.

DBS Bank has been present in India for more than 30 years, opening its first office in Mumbai in 1994. DBS Bank India Limited is the first among the large foreign banks in India to start operating as a wholly owned, locally incorporated subsidiary of a leading global bank. As a trusted partner, DBS provides a range of banking services for large, medium, and small enterprises and individual consumers in India, focusing on a seamless customer experience that helps them 'Live more, Bank less'. In November 2020, Lakshmi Vilas Bank was merged with DBS Bank India Limited. DBS Bank India is now present in ~350 locations in 19 Indian states.

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by uplifting lives and livelihoods of those in need. It provides essential needs to the underprivileged, and fosters inclusion by equipping the underserved with financial and digital literacy skills. It also nurtures innovative social enterprises that create positive impact.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com

About K Raheja Corp

K Raheja Corp is one of India's leading real estate conglomerates and a success story spanning over four decades, having pioneered the concepts of self-contained townships and branded commercial business districts in the country. Diversified across multiple business verticals and anchored by three publicly listed entities, the group has built deep acumen across every major segment of the industry.

Its commercial real estate business develops fully integrated Grade A business parks and premium independent office assets that serve as workplaces of choice for leading domestic and global enterprises - a part of which is listed as Mindspace Business Parks REIT. K Raheja Corp Homes crafts distinctive residential addresses across the premium, luxury and ultra-luxury segments in cities across India. Chalet Hotels Ltd., the group's listed hospitality arm, owns and operates a portfolio of upper-upscale and luxury hotels under globally recognised brands. In retail, Shoppers Stop Ltd. is a pioneer of organised retail and one of India's foremost premium department store chains, while Inorbit Mall helped shape the country's modern mall culture and continues to run some of its most-loved shopping destinations. The group's power distribution business further supports its commercial ecosystems as a dedicated private-sector provider.

A founding signatory to the CII-Green Building Council and a long-standing proponent of green building in India, K Raheja Corp has sustainability embedded across construction and operations, and remains committed to creating high-quality, future-ready spaces that shape how India lives, works and grows.

[Category: Investment Banking, Construction and Materials, Real Estate, ESG and Sustainability, Sustainability Initiatives]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd

Document ATINBK0020260811em8a000jp

Banking Watch: Record second-quarter performance sends DBS shares to new high

By Kwan Wei Kevin Tan (kevin.tan@bizedge.com)

1,160 words

10 August 2026

The Edge Singapore

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English

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When it comes to creating shareholder value, few Singaporean-listed stocks have done as good a job as DBS Group Holdings. The city-state's largest lender has seen its stock price go from strength to strength.

Over the last three years, DBS's stock price has more than doubled, going from just over \$30 on Aug 6, 2023 to a high of \$75.80 on Aug 6. That is on top of the bank's longstanding commitment to return \$8 billion to shareholders from FY2025 to FY2027.

In its latest earnings announcement for 2QFY2026 on Aug 6, DBS announced a return on equity (ROE) of 17.9% as well as an interim dividend of 66 cents and a capital return dividend of 15 cents, totalling 81 cents. This is in line with past dividend payouts in 1QFY2026 and 4QFY 2025.

"The function of our price reflects to some extent the high ROE that we have," DBS CFO Chng Sok Hui told reporters during the bank's earnings briefing held on the same day. "The ability to pay dividends is also a function of the growth in NPAT (net profit after tax) versus the growth in our risk-weighted assets. These are what you have to balance. The growth in the business versus what you want to pay out."

DBS CEO Tan Su Shan says the banks' stock performance parallels what has been going on in Singapore's banking sector. DBS's rivals, Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation (OCBC) and United Overseas Bank (UOB), have all rallied to new highs in recent weeks. OCBC closed at nearly \$30 on July 29 while UOB hit nearly \$45 on July 15.

DBS might have benefited from the potential reallocation of investments taking place in the market, Su Shan says. "The people that were trading the AI stocks in the first half, now they are maybe starting to diversify. I think the Sing dollar also has an element to play in that investors may be looking for some Sing dollar diversification."

"If you are a company with both dividend yield and structural growth, then hopefully people will see that you deserve some kind of premium," Su Shan adds. "I hope that DBS will be the kind of company that, when the chips are down, we will outperform and we will have a lower beta and a higher alpha. But when the chips are up and things are doing well, then we should outperform. So, that's our hope, of my team and I."

Treasury and trading income offset low rates

DBS's net profit for 2QFY2026 grew 9% y-o-y to reach \$3.08 billion, exceeding the consensus estimate of \$2.881 billion according to Bloomberg's poll of analysts. The bank's total net profit for 1HFY2026 is up 5% y-o-y at \$6.01 billion.

Although DBS's net interest income for 2QFY2026 had fallen by 2% y-o-y to \$3.58 billion due to lower interest rates, the bank was able to offset that through its outperformance in other areas such as fee income (up 25% y-o-y or \$293 million), treasury customer sales and other income (up 30% y-o-y or \$159 million) as well as market trading income (up 12% y-o-y or \$51 million).

That trend was repeated across the bank's performance for 1HFY2026. Even though net interest income was down 3% y-o-y to \$7.08 billion, that was mitigated by the strong performance recorded in fee income (up 20% y-o-y or \$500 million), treasury customer sales and other income (up 20% y-o-y or \$213 million), and market trading income (up 10% y-o-y or \$77 million).

Su Shan notes that while the income DBS earns through its treasury customer sales has been bolstered by AI, those segments are inherently cyclical. "There will be some cyclicity," Su Shan says. "The markets are up. You can do a lot more. When the markets are down, you can't do as much. So, there will be cyclicity in those

numbers, but the key is you must keep growing your funnel and you must keep growing your AI prowess and your ability to nudge customers when they need to be nudged.”

Wealth management continues to remain a key pillar of DBS’s strategy, with its assets under management (AUM) in that segment exceeding \$500 billion for the first time. DBS’s group head of consumer banking and **wealth management**, Shee Tse Koon, said in July that the bank is targeting to reach \$1 trillion in AUM by 2030.

To that end, DBS is looking to onboard 600 frontline advisors and platform engineers by 2028. The bank is also planning to open 18 new **wealth** centres and upgrade 36 existing **wealth** centres.

When asked if the growth in DBS’s **wealth** segment was headcount-led, Shee says that while hiring new relationship managers (RM) remains necessary, it is going to take a lot more than just adding people to drive growth.

“It’s about adding people while making each and every one, even much more effective,” Shee told reporters at the earnings briefing on Aug 6, 2026. “We have gone way beyond just throwing bodies. It’s about making the bodies even more able.”

Full-year guidance raised

Going forward, Su Shan expects DBS’s total income for FY2026 to exceed FY2025 levels. “Whether it was record top-line, record bottom-line, record fees, the team is firing on all cylinders and building a strong foundation for future growth,” she says.

Even though the market is pencilling in a rate hike by the Federal Reserve, Su Shan expects rates to stay at current levels and for the Singapore Overnight Rate Average to remain at around 1.2% for the rest of the year. “The market has been expecting a rate hike, and so we will trade when we see those opportunities,” she says.

For 2QFY2026, DBS wrote back \$75 million in general provisioning (GP) while specific allowances were at \$188 million or 16 basis points of the bank’s loans. DBS saw some repayments from its Hong Kong borrowers in the second quarter. “Some of the weaker real estate credits they actually sold and then they repaid,” Su Shan says, adding that further repayments may take place in 3QFY2026.

Citi’s Tan Yong Hong says in his Aug 6 note that DBS’s results beat for the second quarter was partially driven by “volatile items” such as its GP writeback of \$75 million and its total provisions coming in \$115 million below street estimates. He expects the bank’s net profit to go up by 2.7% to \$11.3 billion from FY2025 to FY2026 and by 10.3% to \$12.5 billion from FY2026 to FY2027.

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Frankly Speaking: Why Allianz group is attracted to Singapore

By Goola Warden (goola.warden@bizedge.com)

897 words

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The Allianz group has been on a buying spree in Singapore. On July 24, Allianz agreed to pay \$2.7 billion for 100% of HSBC Life, which works out at around 1.53 times HSBC Life's comprehensive equity of EUR1.2 billion (\$1.7 billion).

On Aug 5, Allianz Global Investors, a unit of Allianz, announced the acquisition of UOB Asset Management for \$555 million. As of Dec 31, 2025, UOBAM had \$42 billion and a net asset value of \$223 million.

Why is Allianz attracted to Singapore? Of course it isn't just the Europeans finding Singapore attractive. On April 20, CapitaLand Integrated Commercial Trust announced the divestment of Asia Square Tower 2 to IOI Properties (a Malaysian company) for \$2.476 billion. On July 31, Hongkong Land announced the proposed acquisition of Wheelock Place for \$1.1 billion. Although listed on the Singapore Exchange, Hongkong Land, as its moniker suggests, is based in Hong Kong.

Despite its very small physical size, Singapore has one of the highest GDP per capita globally. During a results briefing for DBS Group Holdings on Aug 6, group CEO Tan Su Shan observed Singapore GDP growth has surprised on the upside. Singapore has "a lot of the semiconductor higher-end ecosystem here. Do I expect that to continue to grow? Yes. Do I expect financial services to continue to grow? Also, that's another big part of the economy. Yes."

Tan points to the capital markets, an AI-ready workforce, Singapore's tech and data ecosystem, and "structural tailwinds in trade" as tailwinds for Singapore. "We want to grow global champions. I think that north and south trade will continue to grow, and Singapore as a trade hub will stand to benefit from that as well."

Throw into the mix a rapidly ageing, relatively well-to-do resident population, and that makes Singapore attractive to life insurers such as Allianz.

In a series of slides, Allianz points to the rationale for a presence in Singapore. The city-state is viewed as a high-economic-growth and AAA-rated economy. It is a global **wealth** hub with a large and growing customer base. In Allianz's view, the economy has a "strong financial infrastructure with a sophisticated life and health insurance market". Part of the reason Allianz is acquiring HSBC Life also ties back to why investors are chasing stocks such as DBS and the two local banks. Singapore is politically stable with a strong currency, Allianz adds.

On the sector front, according to data cited by Allianz, Singapore is the largest life insurance market in Southeast Asia. Individual life and health new business annualised premium growth was at a CAGR of 8% from 2020 to 2025.

Increasingly, AIA and Prudential are facing headwinds in Hong Kong, based on media reports. Steven Lam, senior industry analyst for insurance at Bloomberg Intelligence, says a 20% tax on dividend payouts and interest earned from prepayment of offshore policies purchased by mainland Chinese citizens, as reported by Caixin Global on Aug 4, could curb demand for insurance sold by HSBC, FWD, Prudential, AIA, Manulife and Sun Life in Hong Kong.

"Every 10% drop in new sales from the mainland Chinese visitors segment could drag down group new business value (NBV) by an average of 2% this year, we calculate, with HSBC's 3.6% the highest, followed by FWD's 2.5% and below 2% for AIA, Prudential and Manulife. AIA generates about 20% of its NBV from its onshore mainland China business, the highest among peers, so we don't rule out that it can recapture some of the business onshore. Beijing and Hangzhou reportedly have implemented such tax measures, though the extent of nationwide adoption is unclear," Lam writes in an update on Aug 6.

No surprise then that since Great Eastern Holdings' suspension was lifted on Aug 21 last year, it has outperformed AIA and Prudential by a wide margin. Despite its outperformance, GEH's price-to-comprehensive equity ratio remains well below that of the price Allianz has agreed to pay for HSBC Life.

HSBC Life's comprehensive equity based on IFRS17 equity plus net CSM (contractual service margin) is EUR1.2 billion, translating into a price-to-comprehensive equity of around 1.53 times. Based on price-to-net asset value (P/NAV), Allianz paid 5.8 times HSBC Life's shareholders' funds of \$460.7 million, and around 23.1 times earnings based on HSBC Life's 2025 annual report. Altogether, Allianz will be paying \$2.9 billion, with a further \$200 million for a distribution agreement with HSBC Singapore. Allianz is expecting a return on investment of more than 10%.

On completion, HSBC and Allianz will enter an exclusive 15-year bancassurance distribution agreement, under which HSBC will continue to distribute insurance products to its customers in Singapore. On entering the distribution agreement, HSBC will receive the \$200 million initial lump sum cash payment.

Separately, AllianzGI, as the asset management arm of Allianz, says the proposed acquisition of UOBAM will immediately double its AUM in Singapore. The agreement with UOB covers the UOBAM franchise in Singapore, Brunei, Indonesia, Japan, Malaysia, Taiwan, Thailand and Vietnam.

Of course, Singapore, presumably, will be the hub of all this growth. Happy 61st birthday, Singapore.

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United Overseas Bank downgraded to Sell from Neutral at Citi

45 words

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thefly.com

FLYWAL

English

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Citi downgraded United Overseas Bank to Sell from Neutral with a price target of S\$38, down from S\$41.80. The firm expects the company's earnings estimates to move lower on reduced non-wealth fees income growth.

Document FLYWAL0020260810em8a01fmd



What's Going On With HSBC Stock Monday?

Lekha Gupta

371 words

11 August 2026

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BNZNGA

English

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HSBC Holdings plc (NYSE:[HSBC](#)) said Monday it repurchased 340,000 ordinary shares on the Hong Kong Stock Exchange from BNP Paribas Financial Markets SNC. The purchase was part of its share buyback program announced Aug. 4. HSBC will cancel the shares.

\$1 Billion Stock Buyback Program

On Aug. 4, HSBC announced a share buyback program of up to \$1 billion to reduce its outstanding share count. The program began Aug. 6 and is expected to run through Oct. 23.

The banking giant paid between 161.60 Hong Kong dollars and 162.80 Hong Kong dollars per share. The volume-weighted average price was 162.3102 Hong Kong dollars.

Since the program began, HSBC has repurchased about 1.13 million shares for approximately \$23 million. The company had about 17.18 billion ordinary shares and voting rights outstanding before canceling the latest shares repurchased in Hong Kong.

Recent Earnings

Last week, HSBC reported second-quarter and [first-half 2026 results](#). First-half revenue rose 11% to \$37.7 billion, helped by higher banking net interest income and growth in **wealth** fees and other income.

Revenue also benefited from an \$800 million net favorable impact from notable items and a \$700 million foreign-exchange translation benefit.

Banking net interest income rose \$1.6 billion to \$22.9 billion, supported by deposit growth and higher yields from reinvestment of the structural hedge. Net interest margin increased 4 basis points to 1.61%.

First-half profit before tax climbed 23% to \$19.5 billion, driven by a \$2.2 billion net favorable impact from notable items, higher banking net interest income and stronger fee and other income. Higher expected credit losses and planned increases in operating expenses partly offset the gains.

Profit after tax rose 23% to \$15.3 billion from a year earlier.

For the second quarter, HSBC reported adjusted earnings per American depositary share of \$2.25, below the \$2.28 analyst estimate. Revenue of \$19.12 billion topped the \$18.79 billion estimate.

HSBC Price Action

HSBC Price Action: HSBC Holdings shares were down 0.40% at \$103.31 at the time of publication on Monday, [according to Benzinga Pro data](#).

Document BNZNGA0020260810em8a00106

StanChart to roll out CIO funds from GIFT City

Citywire Asia Staff

327 words

10 August 2026

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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Standard Chartered is set to expand its footprint in India's offshore **wealth management** landscape after receiving in-principle approval from the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) to distribute capital market products out of Gujarat International Finance Tec-City (GIFT City).

The regulatory green light will allow the London-headquartered lender to roll out its suite of global **wealth management** offerings from India's GIFT City.

The bank announced that it will first roll out its Signature CIO funds for eligible high net worth and affluent clients in the coming weeks, with additional **wealth** solutions slated to follow.

The Signature CIO funds, first introduced by Standard Chartered in 2022, include a suite of four multi-asset strategies directly managed according to the insights of the bank's CIO. The funds offer global exposure across equities, fixed income, commodities, alternatives, and cash.

Since their inception, the funds have grown rapidly, gathering over \$5bn in assets under management (AUM) and expanding across 12 markets, including key private banking hubs in Singapore, Hong Kong, and the UAE, the bank said.

Bringing these strategies to GIFT City provides India-connected investors with a channel to diversify their capital internationally under a local offshore regulatory framework.

'We are seeing growing demand from affluent clients for internationally diversified portfolios, expert advice, and seamless access to opportunities across markets,' said Samir Subberwal, global head of **wealth** solutions, retail products, data & analytics at Standard Chartered.

'This approval marks an important step in expanding our **wealth** capabilities through GIFT City. As a leading international **wealth** manager, we are well-positioned to connect clients to global investment opportunities through our network, CIO expertise and advisory capabilities,' Subberwal added.

GIFT City is India's first operational smart city and a dedicated international financial services centre. It's designed to compete with global hubs like Dubai, Singapore, and London, and operates as an offshore enclave within India.

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AI

Malaysia ranks third globally for AI adoption in finance at 85%, but 58% still want human oversight: HSBC

Duc Dao

440 words

10 August 2026

TechNode Global

TENOG

English

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As many as 85 percent of affluent and high-net-worth investors in Malaysia use AI tools for finance and investment, ranking the country third among ten markets surveyed, according to HSBC.

In a statement on Monday regarding its survey of affluent and high-net-worth individual investors, HSBC said Malaysia's figure on the same level with mainland China. It trailed only India at 86 percent.

Meanwhile, 58 percent in Malaysia say their ideal financial decision-making approach combines AI with human professional expertise, Malaysia's AI adoption in finance exceeds the global average of 73 percent across surveyed markets.

Beyond finance, Malaysian investors also use AI for work and career at 64 percent and personal development at 64 percent. Across generations, Millennials aged 30 to 45 record the highest AI use for financial and investment decisions at 89 percent, followed by Gen Z aged 21 to 29 at 86 percent, Generation X aged 46 to 61 at 85 percent, and Baby Boomers aged 62 to 69 at 78 percent.

Despite strong AI adoption, financial professionals and institutions remain the leading source of investment ideas at 65 percent. They are also the most influential factor in investment decisions at 39 percent, more than double the influence attributed to AI tools at 16 percent.

Regarding their decision on human factors, 85 percent of Malaysian respondents cite reassurance and 76 percent cite strategic expertise. Specific tasks valued in human professionals include spotting mistakes in AI-generated data at 31 percent, providing personalized interpretation of complex data at 31 percent, and applying judgement and validation at 30 percent.

Besides, 57 percent of Malaysian respondents say AI makes them feel more in control of their investments, compared with 21 percent who say it makes them feel less in control. About 54 percent say AI makes them more willing to take calculated risks, more than double the 25 percent who say it makes them more cautious.

HSBC Malaysia is advancing its Human-AI hybrid approach through the launch of **Wealth** Intelligence, a generative AI-enabled platform that analyses and summarizes insights from data sources, including HSBC's in-house views, market commentary, and unit trust fund analysis, to support customer conversations.

Linda Yip, Country Head of International **Wealth** and Premier Banking at HSBC Malaysia, said technology provides speed while human connection builds trust. The future of banking can feature a partnership between AI-driven insights and human expertise.

[76% of Singapore investors use AI for finance, still seek human advisers for final decisions: HSBC](#)

Document TENOGL0020260810em8a00006

Standard Chartered Bank declares GH¢673m dividend • pledges support for economic growth

Admin1

465 words

10 August 2026

The Ghanaian Times

GATIM

English

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Shareholders of Standard Chartered Bank Ghana PLC have approved a final dividend of GH¢4.989 per ordinary share at the Bank's 56th Annual General Meeting (AGM), bringing the total payout to GH¢673.48 million.

The approved dividend includes GH¢672.35 million for ordinary shareholders and GH¢1.13 million for preference shareholders, based on the Bank's performance for the year ended December 31, 2025.

The AGM, held in Accra, also provided the platform for the Bank to present its Annual Report and Financial Statements to shareholders.

The Bank used the occasion to reaffirm its commitment to supporting Ghana's economic development, as it marks 130 years of continuous operations in the country.

During engagements with shareholders, the Board highlighted the Bank's longstanding contribution to the economy, particularly in trade, infrastructure development, **wealth** creation and cross-border banking services.

The Chairman, Mr Ebenezer Twum Asante, is reported to have reiterated the Bank's commitment to delivering value to shareholders.

He said that as the Bank reflected on the year under review, it remained focused on positioning itself to deliver sustainable returns. He noted that Ghana's improving macroeconomic outlook offered some optimism, despite ongoing global uncertainties.

Mr Twum Asante added that the Bank remained confident in the strength of its operations, the resilience of its workforce and the relevance of its strategy, and would continue to support clients, contribute to national development and deliver long-term value to shareholders.

The Chief Executive, Mr Xorse Godzi, also indicated that the Bank's priorities were centred on supporting clients while driving sustainable growth.

He explained that as a "super-connector bank", Standard Chartered leveraged its international network, local expertise and specialised capabilities to provide cross-border banking solutions that connect Ghanaian businesses and institutions to global markets, capital and innovation.

Mr Godzi added that the Bank would continue to deepen client relationships, strengthen its digital capabilities and deliver solutions to help clients navigate changes in the business environment.

He further stated that as the Bank marked 130 years of operations in Ghana, its focus would remain on disciplined execution, innovation and long-term value creation, while contributing to the country's economic development.

Established in 1896, Standard Chartered Bank Ghana PLC has played a significant role in Ghana's economic transformation by supporting trade and investment, promoting enterprise growth and connecting the country to global opportunities through its international network.

The Bank said it continued to contribute to sustainable economic growth through its core banking operations, responsible business practices, community investment and talent development, while also providing thought leadership to help shape the financial services sector.

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Prudential Zenith, Standard Chartered partner on bancassurance

446 words

10 August 2026

punchng.com

TPUNC

English

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Prudential Zenith Life Insurance and Standard Chartered Bank Nigeria Limited have announced a strategic bancassurance partnership aimed at expanding access to life insurance and financial protection across Nigeria.

The collaboration combines Prudential Zenith's underwriting expertise with Standard Chartered's extensive banking network to deliver accessible protection solutions to a broader segment of the population.

The partnership demonstrates a shared commitment to bridging the country's insurance gap and advancing financial inclusion by embedding insurance access directly into everyday banking touchpoints.

Through the alliance, Standard Chartered customers will gain access to a suite of life insurance products tailored to diverse life-stage needs, ranging from individual protection to family security and education planning.

Speaking on the potential of the initiative in Lagos on Wednesday, the Executive Director and Chief Financial Officer of Prudential Zenith Life Insurance, Afolabi Lawal, said, "At Prudential Zenith, we believe that financial inclusion is not only about access, but also about empowerment.

"This partnership with Standard Chartered Bank Nigeria Limited allows us to reach more Nigerians with products that are not exclusively protective but also aspirational. Whether it is safeguarding a child's education or securing a family's future, we are making life insurance more intuitive, affordable, and integral to every customer's financial journey. Together, we are dismantling barriers while building a stronger, more resilient society."

Also commenting, the Acting Chief Executive Officer of Standard Chartered Bank Nigeria Limited, Ayodeji Adelagun, stated, "This partnership with Prudential Zenith Life Insurance underscores our commitment to deliver financial solutions that enable and protect clients and their families.

"By integrating these essential insurance products into our banking services, we are enhancing our **wealth management** offerings and deepening financial inclusion in Nigeria. Our customers can now secure their futures with confidence, knowing that their **wealth** and legacy are protected."

The agreement builds on a 27-year global relationship between Prudential and Standard Chartered across 11 markets in Africa and Asia.

Standard Chartered Bank re-entered Nigeria in 1999 as a wholly owned subsidiary of Standard Chartered Plc. The bank offers a wide array of financial products and services spanning Corporate and Institutional Banking as well as **Wealth Management**.

Prudential Zenith Life became a fully owned subsidiary of Prudential plc following an acquisition of 100 per cent shareholding on 26 September 2024. The insurer has grown to become one of the most capitalised companies in the Nigerian insurance industry, posting a Profit After Tax of N7.4bn in FY 2024.

It provides individual plans, such as savings, investment-linked, endowment and protection policies, alongside corporate coverage, including Group Life, Key-Man Assurance, Credit Life, School Fees Protection and Mortgage Protection.

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MINT, Economy

Dollar race: Foreign banks ramp up FCNR deposits, narrow gap with locals

Subhana Shaikh, Shayan Ghosh

933 words

10 August 2026

Mint

HNMINT

English

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New Delhi, Aug. 10 -- Backed by a global network and wealthy clientele, India's foreign banks are flexing their muscle in attracting dollar deposits, despite their undersized presence in the local deposit market.

Foreign banks, which had barely \$603 million in foreign currency non-resident bank deposits on 5 June when the central bank announced the concessional dollar swap window, managed to clock \$8.97 billion by 30 July. A clutch of three foreign banks, HSBC, Standard Chartered Bank, and DBS Bank India, led the inflows.

Experts said that what worked in their favour is the availability of customers across the world and access to more dollars. For local banks, attracting such deposits would entail raising money in dollars and then lending to customers for deposits.

The surge is being driven by foreign banks' superior access to dollar liquidity, said Abizer Diwanji, founder at NeoStrat Advisors LLP. Global banks have much larger funding lines and counterparty credit limits with overseas institutions, allowing them to mobilise dollars quickly whenever an opportunity arises, he said.

"Foreign banks have much larger limits with dollar deposit sources; so, they are able to raise much more," he said. "Every bank which raises deposits needs to have a limit with their counterparty banks. If somebody is going to place an FCNR deposit with the SBI, they need to have limits with SBI to be able to lend to SBI."

The scheme allows Indians living abroad to make leveraged and unlevered deposits at Indian banks in foreign currency, with the RBI taking the hedging risk to offer the potential for high returns. The scheme, announced on 5 June and rolled out three days later, will run till the end of September.

Among the biggest gainers, HSBC saw outstanding FCNR deposits jump from \$120.26 million to \$6.26 billion, while Standard Chartered Bank, which had no FCNR(B) deposits on June 5, had mobilized \$1.86 billion by 30 July. DBS Bank India more than doubled its outstanding deposits to \$613.55 million from \$282.67 million over the same period.

On an outstanding basis-the total amount of deposits at a given point in time-private sector banks dominated the segment, with \$25.7 billion in such deposits as of 30 July, up 72%, while public sector banks were close behind at \$25.6 billion, a 53% increase over the period. Foreign lenders have narrowed the gap in just under two months, reflecting their ability to tap global dollar pools far more efficiently than domestic peers.

Foreign banks have traditionally not been big players in the deposit market in India, with their collective share at 4.8% in end-December 2025. In comparison, state-owned banks had a market share of 57.9%, while private banks had a 36.1% share. Although led by a handful of foreign banks, the inflows under FCNR show that they can step up where global presence and clientele matters.

The rupee hit a record low of 96.96 against the US dollar on 20 May, Bloomberg data showed, hurt by surging crude oil prices and economic stress following the US-Iran war that began on 28 February.

However, Diwanji of NeoStrat believes the current trend may not permanently alter the competition. "It's only temporary," he said, adding that only foreign banks with a branch presence in India can directly mobilise such deposits under the scheme.

A spokesperson for HSBC declined to comment. Emails sent to Standard Chartered Bank and DBS Bank India remained unanswered.

The RBI's FCNR(B) swap facility, announced alongside temporary relaxations to attract foreign currency inflows and support the rupee, has triggered intense competition among banks to mobilise NRI deposits.

The key to such flows is the leverage. This structure allows customers to pledge a relatively small amount of their own capital and borrow the balance from the bank to create a much larger FCNR(B) deposit. For unlevered deposits, the customer puts only his/her own funds into the deposits.

Experts said that local banks have been more conservative than their foreign counterparts when it comes to leverage, offering about nine times leverage as compared to up to 19 times by British lender HSBC.

"Foreign banks realized that they have in addition to the benefit of RBI's swap cover, their own dollar balance sheets outside of India. Therefore, they can leverage even more," said Ashvin Parekh, managing partner of Ashvin Parekh Advisory Services LLP.

Parekh said only a handful of foreign banks in India have the scale-large balance sheets and branch networks-needed to mobilise deposits. "You have HSBC and Standard Chartered Bank with such networks now that Citi has sold off its retail business in India."

"Personally, I believe that on account of these geopolitical tensions, NRIs in West Asia are uncertain whether they should keep their **wealth** back there or at least put it in FCNR(B) deposits and bring it home," said Parekh, who expects over \$70 billion inflows under various RBI incentive schemes.

These schemes include external commercial (ECBs) and overseas foreign currency borrowing, both available till the end of 2026. On 5 August, RBI governor Sanjay Malhotra said that the central bank has no immediate plans to prematurely close or extend the FCNR(B) deposit window before its 30 September deadline.

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Top Stories

Singapore banks provide diverging outlooks with China tax rules a new watchpoint

Renald Yeo

1,181 words

10 August 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

print

A2

English

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Singapore's three banks continued to grow their earnings in the second quarter despite pressure from lower interest rates, with **wealth management** emerging once again as a key source of growth.

DBS's net profit rose 9 per cent year on year to S\$3.08 billion, while OCBC posted a 22 per cent increase to S\$2.22 billion. UOB's net profit climbed 10 per cent to S\$1.48 billion, as higher fee and other non-interest income helped offset weaker net interest income.

But beneath the headline numbers, the three lenders struck somewhat different notes on the outlook for the rest of the year – and on emerging issues ranging from China's new tax rules to the potential for artificial intelligence to contribute to the bottom line.

DBS was the first of the three banks to report its Q2 results on Thursday (Aug 6), followed by OCBC and UOB on Friday.

Here are five takeaways from their Q2 results:

1. **Wealth** remains the biggest earnings engine

As falling interest rates squeeze lending margins, **wealth management** continues to do much of the heavy lifting for Singapore's banks.

At DBS, **wealth management** income grew 16 per cent in the first half to S\$3.3 billion, while assets under management crossed S\$500 billion. The business helped lift net fee income by 20 per cent to a record S\$2.94 billion over the period.

That strength was a major reason the bank became more upbeat about its full-year non-interest income outlook, with CEO Tan Su Shan saying the team was "firing on all cylinders and building a strong foundation for future growth".

OCBC similarly recorded strong growth from its **wealth** franchise, with **wealth management** income rising 27 per cent in the first half to a record S\$3.29 billion.

UOB's **wealth management** income rose 16 per cent year on year in the first half to S\$717 million, while high-net-worth assets under management grew 7 per cent to S\$204 billion.

Its momentum has been particularly strong outside Singapore, with **wealth** income from its four key Asean markets – Malaysia, Indonesia, Thailand and Vietnam – rising 30 per cent.

The bank is also looking to lean further into **wealth** after its strategic tie-up with Allianz Global Investors, which will allow it to focus more heavily on distribution and advisory while drawing on the global asset manager's product capabilities.

2. Guidance shows more uneven outlook for second half

The banks' guidance revisions point to different expectations for the remainder of 2026.

DBS raised its forecast for commercial-book non-interest income growth to the mid-teens, led by **wealth management**, and now expects total income for the year to exceed 2025 levels. It also expects group net interest income to narrow its gap with last year's level.

OCBC made one of the more notable upgrades, raising its full-year loan growth forecast from mid single-digit growth to the high single-digit to low double-digit range.

That followed particularly strong lending growth in Q2, although group CEO Tan Teck Long cautioned against extrapolating the pace into the rest of the year. The lender also expects full-year income to grow year on year despite a slight decline in net interest income.

UOB, meanwhile, was more circumspect.

It maintained its low single-digit full-year loan growth forecast and net interest margin guidance of between 1.75 and 1.80 per cent, but cut its fee-income growth forecast to the low single digits from high single digits previously.

UOB continues to expect its 2026 earnings to be broadly flat against 2025.

3. China's offshore tax changes have yet to trigger significant outflows

China's increased scrutiny of offshore **wealth** has emerged as a new issue for banks with sizeable Greater China **wealth** businesses, but the lenders said they have yet to see a meaningful impact.

The changes include rules surrounding offshore trusts and the taxation of overseas investment income, raising questions over whether wealthy Chinese clients could shift assets or restructure their holdings.

OCBC said Bank of Singapore – its private banking arm – has not seen any significant asset outflows since news of the changes emerged. Its offshore trust business is also relatively small, while clients have largely been seeking clarification on how the rules apply.

DBS similarly indicated that it was too early to draw conclusions. Tan noted that the bank will comply with the rules while continuing to build out its domestic **wealth** capabilities in China – meaning it can still serve clients if more assets remain onshore.

UOB also described the development as recent, and said it was still assessing the implications.

"We don't see any material impact at the first instance, but it's still something we're watching carefully," said CFO Leong Yung Chee.

4. AI is everywhere – but banks differ on how close it is to generating revenue

All three lenders are deploying AI extensively, but their comments pointed to how difficult it remains to isolate its financial contribution.

DBS has perhaps gone furthest in framing AI as a potential revenue generator. It is using the technology for functions such as idea generation and to prompt customers with relevant opportunities, which can in turn generate transaction and fee flows.

OCBC's Tan took a different approach. "We don't really have an AI strategy per se," he said, explaining that AI sits within the bank's broader "ADD" strategy encompassing digitisation, data analytics and AI.

The focus is on applying the technology where it is fit for purpose rather than pursuing AI for its own sake, he added.

UOB, meanwhile, said more than 30,000 employees have access to Microsoft Copilot, while over 300 AI use cases have been rolled out across the bank. Staff are generating more than 400,000 Copilot prompts a month, noted Leong.

But it is not yet putting a dollar figure on the benefits. UOB has engaged an external auditor to help establish a framework for measuring AI's impact, which it expects to complete by the end of the year, with a view to reporting the numbers regularly thereafter.

5. Investors rewarded DBS and OCBC, but UOB fell after results

The market response also diverged after the banks reported their results.

DBS shares ended the week at a fresh record high of S\$76.33, having gained 3.9 per cent since its results were released on Thursday. The counter is up 35.4 per cent year to date.

OCBC shares closed 3.3 per cent higher at S\$30.30 on Friday, after touching a fresh record high of S\$30.50 intraday. The counter has gained 53.3 per cent since the start of the year.

UOB shares, however, fell 0.6 per cent to S\$43.30 following its results on Friday. The counter is still up 23.5 per cent year to date.

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Wealth

Emotional dividends: The compounding return of staying calm

Brandon Leu

844 words

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IT IS 11 o'clock on Monday morning and Jane, a sales manager at a multinational company, is finding it difficult to focus on the quarterly report she is preparing. DBS, a stock that makes up a sizeable portion of her investment portfolio, has gained 2.6 per cent in the last two hours, and she cannot decide whether to lock in her gains or hold on for more.

Fifty metres away, her colleague Sherry is whizzing through her to-do list. Sherry owns shares of DBS too, but via an exchange-traded fund based on the Straits Times Index (STI).

The bulk of Sherry's portfolio is built on ETFs, a few opportunistic holdings to generate alpha.

These two stories are representative of real client scenarios I see every day.

The difference between the two characters is not knowledge or skill. It is emotional exposure.

Over an investing lifetime, that difference compounds into an emotional dividend: the return you earn by staying calm.

Many people know that an ETF diversifies returns. Fewer have heard that it also diversifies our emotions.

By pre-committing to owning a whole basket, an ETF minimises the three biases that do the most damage to individual investors: the fear of missing out (Fomo), the pain of loss and the urge to keep trading.

Fomo is really a fear of regret: the sting of watching others gain while you choose to sit out.

When a single stock rips 30 per cent and you own none of it, that regret can push you into buying high and hoping for a return of the rally you missed.

Managing Fomo

An ETF pre-empts this problem. If you hold an STI ETF, for instance, you already own DBS, OCBC and UOB stocks at their index weights.

When Singapore's banks surge, your ETF does too (albeit to a lesser degree).

You do not need to pick winners in advance and you never entirely miss out, because you bought participation when you invested in the ETF.

The calm works only if you know what you own, of course. But such information is easy to find. The STI constituents are listed on the Singapore Exchange's website, and ETF managers all publish the top holdings and sector weights of their funds.

Knowing what you own silences Fomo.

Behavioural researchers Daniel Kahneman and Amos Tversky showed that the pain of losing \$100 is roughly twice as intense as the joy of winning \$100.

This is loss aversion, and it is why a single stock down 40 per cent can ruin your week and prompt a panicked sale at the worst possible moment.

Now do the maths inside an ETF. A stock that falls 40 per cent but makes up just 3 per cent of the fund drags the whole portfolio down by little more than 1 per cent. You feel a ripple, not a blow.

A subtler mechanism is at work, too. When you hold 10 individual stocks, you keep 10 mental scoreboards – and you react to every one of them. The economist Richard Thaler called this narrow framing.

An ETF forces the opposite: one line item, one number. You see the forest, not 10 anxious trees. And because your portfolio collapses to a single figure, you check the price less often.

This matters because the more frequently you look, the more losses you notice and the more timid your decisions become.

Here is the honest twist, because none of this comes free. The same aggregation that removes the pain also removes the thrill.

An index fund is, by design, a little boring, and boredom can be dangerous.

It tempts investors to abandon the calm, jump on single names and quietly reintroduce every bias they had just escaped – this time with trading costs attached.

The quiet edge

The research is blunt on the consequences: finance professors Brad Barber and Terrance Odean found that overtrading diminishes returns.

The fix is not to suppress the urge, but to give it a fenced-off home. Let a broad ETF form the core of your portfolio, say 70 per cent, and let it do the emotional heavy lifting.

Then research and allocate a small sum to individual names in pursuit of higher returns. The reduced amount in single stocks means a loss would sting but never wound.

Over the 10 years to Jun 30, the State Street SPDR STI ETF and the Amova Singapore STI ETF each returned close to 10 per cent annually. But that number is only half the story.

The other half is the decisions you did not make in a panic, the winners you did not sell too soon, and the losers that did not cause you any lost sleep.

The quiet edge of holding an ETF as your core is that it lets you feel less.

And in investing, feeling less is often how you end up doing and making more.

The writer is associate director and trading representative at UOB Kay Hian

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Business

DBS, OCBC shares climb to fresh highs on strong Q2 earnings; yen rally stalls

Sheila Chiang

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DBS and OCBC shares surged to record highs last week after the Singapore banks posted strong second-quarter results fuelled by their booming **wealth management** businesses, while UOB's stock struggled to keep pace.

OCBC shares crossed the \$30 mark for the first time and closed 3.94 per cent higher at \$30.30 on Aug 7. DBS Bank closed 3.07 per cent higher at a fresh peak of \$76.33. UOB, however, ended down 0.23 per cent at \$43.30.

All three banks declared interim dividends.

DBS will pay shareholders 81 cents a share, comprising a 66-cent ordinary dividend and a 15-cent capital return dividend, after net profit rose 9 per cent to \$3.08 billion in the quarter on record **wealth-management** income.

OCBC will pay a 47-cent dividend after its second-quarter profit jumped 22 per cent to \$2.22 billion, while UOB will return 88 cents a share to shareholders as profit rose 10 per cent to \$1.48 billion.

Macquarie Capital head of ASEAN equity research Jayden Vantarakis noted that the bank's 8-basis-point quarter-on-quarter net interest margin decline was the largest among the three banks.

UOB's new non-performing assets, or loans that turned problematic, hit \$902 million in the second quarter, up 90 per cent year on year due to one real-estate account in Greater China. UOB noted that adequate provisions have been pre-emptively set aside to buffer against this exposure.

DBS and OCBC raised their 2026 financial targets, while UOB kept its guidance largely unchanged, except that it now expects low single-digit fee income growth, down from its previous forecast of high single-digit fee income growth.

Yen struggles to keep intervention gains

The Japanese yen struggled to hold on to its recent sharp gains from a joint US-Japan currency intervention.

The yen was around 157.80 per US dollar on Aug 7 after strengthening to 155.20 per US dollar on Aug 3, but remains stronger than a multi-decade low of about 164.

The yen weakened against the Singapore dollar over the week, with one Singapore dollar buying about 123.44 yen on Aug 7.

Several factors are weighing on the yen. Although the Bank of Japan has raised benchmark rates to their highest levels in decades, they remain low relative to those in the US and other major economies. That can encourage investors to borrow yen to invest in higher-yielding dollar assets, putting selling pressure on the Japanese currency.

Markets are also wary of Japan's massive debt burden, which exceeds 200 per cent of gross domestic product (GDP), while its persistent budget deficits have fuelled concerns. Such fiscal strains can undermine confidence in Japanese assets and weigh on the yen.

The Middle East conflict has also added pressure on the yen, with Japan heavily reliant on imported energy, and the region accounting for most of its oil supplies.

Vincent Chung, co-portfolio manager for diversified income bond strategy at T. Rowe Price, said that the market generally expects intervention to slow the yen's decline rather than produce a sustained recovery.

For the yen to experience a more durable reversal, the Bank of Japan would likely need to bring forward its rate-hiking cycle, which could encourage Japanese investors to repatriate more overseas capital, said Chung in an Aug 5 note.

Alternatively, a broader macroeconomic catalyst would need to emerge, he added.

SpaceX, other AI stocks surge

Shares of SpaceX gained 20.5 per cent to close out a volatile week at US\$133.11, as investors stepped back in to scoop up the shares following the expiration of an insider share lock-up period that more than doubled the public trading float.

Over 900 million insider and employee shares were freed up for trading – the first in a series of restrictions scheduled to lift over the next few months.

While SpaceX's IPO was the largest in US history, it kept a tight public float with fewer than 5 per cent of its shares available for open market trading.

The share price rebound followed an initial post-earnings slump, which saw SpaceX posting a net loss of US\$541 million and AI infrastructure spending of US\$15.8 billion for the second quarter of 2026.

Shares of AI stocks surged over the week too, as analysts remained upbeat about the sector's longer-term prospects despite risk of near-term turbulence.

Nvidia shares rose 10.9 per cent over the week to US\$223.96, Advanced Micro Devices gained 1.5 per cent to US\$483.36 and Micron surged 6.41 per cent to US\$877.57.

OCBC executive director for **wealth** advisory Afdhal Rahman highlighted that recent earnings from Amazon, the largest AI cloud hyperscaler, showed that demand for AI infrastructure and services remains robust.

He noted that AI adoption appears to be moving beyond experimentation and into real-world deployment, as enterprises increasingly use the technology to drive productivity gains and lower costs.

"Taken together, these trends suggest that while periods of volatility are inevitable as markets reassess valuations and earnings expectations, the structural drivers underpinning the AI theme remain largely intact," he said.

Oil prices climb, gold jumps above US\$4,300 an ounce

Brent crude oil climbed more than US\$1 to settle at US\$83.55 a barrel on Aug 7, driven by ongoing market uncertainty over negotiations to reopen the Strait of Hormuz.

Oil prices fell earlier in the week as signs of progress in negotiations raised hopes of a possible resolution to the Middle East conflict, which had entered its sixth month.

Meanwhile, gold prices surged above US\$4,300 an ounce this week, after a weaker-than-expected US jobs report reduced expectations of a Federal Reserve rate hike in September.

Lower interest rates generally make gold more attractive because gold does not pay interest or dividends, reducing the opportunity cost of holding it relative to interest-bearing assets.

UBS said in an Aug 7 report that it expects gold prices to reach US\$5,000 an ounce in the first half of 2027, driven by potential Fed rate cuts, a softer US dollar, and steady central bank demand.

However, the bank also said that the path to US\$5,000 would not be smooth as near-term risks such as inflation or a more hawkish Fed rate path remain.

Other market movers

Yangzijiang Shipbuilding shares jumped 6.9 per cent to close at \$4.20 on Aug 7 after the shipbuilder posted strong first-half earnings a day earlier.

Net profit for the period ended June 30 rose 28.4 per cent to 5.4 billion yuan (S\$1.02 billion).

This was mainly attributed to higher shipbuilding revenue from the progressive construction of vessels secured at higher contract prices and a favourable product mix which included ultra-large container ships and very large ethane carriers.

Shares of JustCo fell 1.6 per cent to close at 64 cents on Aug 7, well below its IPO price of 94 cents a share.

During its first results briefing on Aug 6 since listing on the SGX in May, Singapore's largest co-working operator said it will pay out half of its net profit as dividends starting from financial year 2027 – signalling confidence in generating “meaningful” profits as its business expands.

For the six months ended June 30, net loss narrowed 52 per cent to US\$839,000, from US\$1.7 million a year ago.

DBS in July initiated coverage on JustCo with a “buy” recommendation and target price of \$1.06 as it believes JustCo – with 50 centres across key APAC markets and approximately 35,000 workstations – is well positioned to benefit from structural growth in flexible workspace demand across Asia-Pacific.

Shares of Singapore Exchange gained 0.2 per cent to close the week at \$24.51 after it posted a nearly 25 per cent jump in adjusted net profit to \$759.5 million for 2026.

It also has a pipeline of about 50 companies, including companies in sectors such as digital infrastructure, healthcare and consumer, keen to list on the exchange, it said on Aug 6.

The 21 new SGX listings it hosted had raised \$4.1 billion in 2026, up from the six listings that raised \$25.7 million the year before.

What to look out for this week

It will be a shorter trading week as the local bourse is closed on Aug 10 in observance of National Day.

Investors will be watching how the banks' results continue to feed through into their share prices, dividend expectations and the broader Straits Times Index.

Singapore's earnings season rolls on with a busy week ahead, with UOL and City Developments Limited among the companies due to report, alongside StarHub, Sembcorp, Wilmar International as well as China Aviation Oil and CNMC Goldmine.

The Ministry of Trade and Industry will release the full second-quarter economic survey on Aug 11, covering GDP, sector performance, sources of growth, inflation, employment and productivity. The advance estimate showed GDP grew 5.7 per cent year on year in the period, so investors will be looking for more details and any revisions.

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Upfront

OCBC raises 2026 loan growth forecast after Q2 profit jumps 22%, lifts dividend

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OCBC has raised its full-year loan growth guidance after a stronger-than-expected first half, as continued momentum in **wealth management** and corporate lending helped offset lower interest rates.

The bank now expects loan growth of high-single digits to low-double digits, up from its previous forecast of mid-single-digit growth. It also expects total income to grow year on year despite a slight decline in net interest income.

The upgraded outlook came as OCBC on Friday (Aug 7) reported a record second-quarter net profit of S\$2.22 billion, up 22 per cent from a year earlier and above the S\$1.91 billion consensus forecast in a Bloomberg survey of five analysts.

Profit before tax rose 20 per cent to S\$2.76 billion as total income climbed 18 per cent to a record S\$4.17 billion.

The stronger performance was driven by non-interest income, which jumped 51 per cent to a record S\$1.91 billion.

Fee income rose 28 per cent on the back of record **wealth management** fees, while trading income surged 85 per cent as customer activity picked up and Great Eastern benefited from a rebound in equity markets. Insurance income, meanwhile, increased 68 per cent.

Net interest income, however, slipped 1 per cent to S\$2.26 billion as lower interest rates compressed margins.

The board declared an interim dividend of S\$0.47 per share, up from S\$0.41 a year earlier.

Group CEO Tan Teck Long said that the bank's loan pipeline remained robust, anchored by sectors such as supply chain diversification, energy transition and sustainable finance, but cautioned against expecting another quarter of similarly rapid expansion.

"We don't really expect that exceptional growth rate to continue in the third and fourth quarter," he said, noting that second-quarter growth had been boosted partly by M&A (mergers and acquisitions) financing.

"It doesn't mean that the fourth quarter is weak. It's just relative to the second quarter, we will be at a slower pace," he added.

China trust rules

Separately, Bank of Singapore (BOS) – the private banking arm of OCBC – said that it has not seen significant client asset outflows following China's latest rules affecting offshore trust structures.

Jason Moo, CEO of the private bank, noted that it was still early days since the measures were announced and the bank was in the process of contacting affected clients.

"We haven't seen any significant asset outflows since the news (came) out," he observed, adding that while some clients had sought clarification, others had welcomed the greater regulatory certainty.

Moo also described the trust business as "small", saying it forms part of BOS' overall assets under management but is not a significant contributor to revenue.

OCBC is also continuing to expand its **wealth** business in Hong Kong, where it is adding relationship managers and seeing higher productivity among its existing bankers, said Sunny Quek, head of global consumer financial services.

The bank unveiled a new branch that is due to officially open at the end of September, with customer acquisitions at the location already picking up. It is also looking to add more **wealth** branches in Hong Kong, he added.

Separately, Quek pointed to productivity gains from OCBC's generative artificial intelligence-powered sales training programme launched in April.

Wealth advisers who went through the programme saw their productivity increase by almost 50 per cent, while their appointment-setting rate also rose by about 50 per cent, he noted, although OCBC does not attribute all of those gains solely to AI.

On the latter point, Tan stressed that OCBC does not view the technology as a strategy on its own, preferring instead to deploy it selectively where it creates value.

"We don't really have an AI strategy per se," he said. Instead, the bank follows what Tan calls an "ADD" approach, combining AI, digitalisation and data analytics to redesign processes and improve productivity.

He noted that he was not "a big fan of (generative) AI everything", preferring simpler AI tools where they offer better value and lower computing costs.

Wealth acquisitions preferred

Tan also signalled that OCBC remains open to acquisitions, although it would prioritise opportunities that strengthen its retail and **wealth** franchises.

His preference would be for transactions similar to the acquisition of HSBC Indonesia's **wealth** business announced earlier this year, rather than buying corporate loan books, which he said the bank was capable of growing organically.

Asset quality remained resilient, with the non-performing loan ratio unchanged at 0.9 per cent. Total allowances rose to S\$156 million in the quarter, mainly due to management overlays set aside to cater for macroeconomic uncertainties in Indonesia.

Asked about the higher provisions in Indonesia, Tan replied that the bank's credit quality there remained "very sound", with the increase largely reflecting normal management overlays rather than any deterioration in the portfolio.

Shares of OCBC closed 3.3 per cent higher at S\$30.30 on Friday. Year to date, the counter is up 52.6 per cent.

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Business

OCBC to pay 47-cent dividend as Q2 profit jumps 22% to \$2.22b

Sheila Chiang

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OCBC Bank's net profit for the second quarter of 2026 grew 22 per cent as strong non-interest income led by **wealth management** cushioned the impact of lower interest rates.

Earnings for the quarter ended June 30 were \$2.22 billion, up from \$1.82 billion a year ago and beating analysts' forecasts of \$1.91 billion in a Bloomberg poll.

The bank declared an interim dividend of 47 cents per share for the first half of 2026, up from 41 cents a year ago.

The interim dividend payout will amount to an estimated \$2.11 billion, or approximately 50 per cent of the group's net profit after tax of \$4.19 billion for the first half.

OCBC shares crossed the \$30 mark for the first time, hitting a record high of \$30.50, before paring gains to close up 3.31 per cent at \$30.30 on Aug 7. DBS Bank, too, closed 1.67 per cent higher at a fresh peak of \$76.33. UOB, however, ended down 0.64 per cent at \$43.30.

OCBC group chief executive Tan Teck Long said at the bank's results briefing that its loan pipeline remains robust, supported by growth industries. However, he noted that loan growth for the rest of 2026 is unlikely to match the pace seen in the second quarter, which "was really outstanding in terms of loan growth".

The "exceptional" loan growth in the quarter was partly because of some merger and acquisition transactions that the bank was backing.

He noted that equity markets continued to be volatile and the bank saw a slight moderation in customer investment activity in July, given the cautious market sentiment.

"Notwithstanding this, we are pleased that our customer acquisition remains healthy, and we still see good flows. Long-term demand for **wealth** solutions continues to be strong," he said.

Tan also noted that the bank remained disciplined in evaluating acquisition opportunities and would not pursue targets that were not strategically aligned or did not materially contribute to its growth. He said he was not opposed to acquisitions and would consider a deal if the right target emerged.

He cited OCBC's acquisition of HSBC Indonesia's retail banking and **wealth management** operations in May as an example, adding that his personal preference was for **wealth**-related portfolios.

"I don't have a preference for corporate loan portfolios because we believe that we can grow that portfolio on our own. We are very competitive in terms of gaining market share and growing loans, so I don't really need that," Tan said.

He added that the bank remained fundamentally risk-averse and continued to balance risk with returns. Given that the current environment carries substantial risk, Tan said the bank exercised extra caution when evaluating loan portfolios to avoid taking on assets that could lead to future credit losses.

Second-quarter net interest income at OCBC declined 1 per cent to \$2.26 billion amid a lower interest rate environment.

Net interest margin fell to 1.7 per cent, 22 basis points below the 1.92 per cent a year ago, but the impact was partly cushioned by a 12 per cent growth in average assets.

Non-interest income rose 51 per cent to \$1.91 billion, driven by strong broad-based growth across fee, trading and insurance income.

Fees were up 28 per cent, led by **wealth management**, while trading income rose 85 per cent and insurance income jumped 68 per cent.

Total allowances increased to \$156 million from \$114 million a year ago, mainly from higher allowances for impaired assets.

OCBC group chief financial officer Goh Chin Yee said that new non-performing asset formation in the second quarter arose mainly from the downgrades of two Greater China corporate real estate accounts that were previously under special mention and were proactively managed.

She added that this was partly compensated by net recoveries, mostly from Greater China corporate real estate upgrades, as well as write-offs. Asset quality remained healthy, with the non-performing loan ratio stable at 0.9 per cent, she said.

In a statement, Tan said that global conditions remain uncertain amid geopolitical tensions and elevated inflation risks, with much of the near-term outlook depending on the easing of Asia's energy crunch brought about by the war in the Middle East.

Meanwhile, artificial intelligence and related technology sectors continue to register strong growth, he noted.

Tan added that the bank is well-positioned to navigate these uncertainties and tap the growth sectors to deliver sustainable long-term value, with its strong capital, funding and liquidity position, as well as diversified income streams and disciplined risk management.

OCBC updated its 2026 financial targets, including high-single-digit to low-double-digit loan growth, up from mid-single-digit loan growth previously, given the strong half-year loan growth.

It also guided for total income to grow, up from previous expectations for stable-to-growing total income.

The bank now expects a slight decline in net interest income, up from a slight-to-moderate decline previously. It still expects credit costs in the range of 20 to 25 basis points.

Singapore banks are expanding aggressively in the **wealth** space.

OCBC said in July that it will progressively launch what it says is South-east Asia's first AI-native mobile banking app, introducing two virtual avatars that can engage customers round the clock with personalised **wealth management** insights.

To further support its **wealth** push, the bank will hire 600 additional relationship managers for its consumer banking business over the next three years.

It is also cutting private banking account opening times down to 15 business days – lower than the industry median duration of about six weeks – with a new agentic AI platform called Helios, to speed up the onboarding of wealthy customers.

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Business

Allianz eyes Singapore **wealth, retirement market with its two acquisitions**

Kang Wan Chern

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German insurer Allianz is seeking to build a leading **wealth management** and retirement business in Singapore through its acquisitions of HSBC Life Singapore and UOB Asset Management, less than two years after its attempt to take control of Income Insurance fell through.

Allianz chief executive Oliver Bate said during the company's second-quarter earnings call on Aug 7 that it views life insurance and asset management as two components of an integrated **wealth management** and retirement offering in an important market.

Bate noted that Allianz has been working to strengthen its presence in South-east Asia for "more than a decade", and that the two Singapore acquisitions are part of a "grand design" by the insurer to establish a stronger position for future growth in the region.

"We are systematically working on growth and we are happy that it is working. But these two acquisitions are only the beginning, not the end of the work," he said.

He added that Allianz is keen to expand its presence in Singapore because "strategically, one of the things we missed 20 years ago was establishing a (business) presence here. We are closing that gap as we speak".

Allianz has operated a regional office in Singapore since 1998, but did not have a major local commercial and retail business.

Asked why Allianz was making the acquisitions only now, Bate said the group had sought to expand in Asia for years, but previously found acquisition prices too high relative to the potential value of the deals.

"But we have now found two opportunities where we believe the synergies are such that we can justify the investments."

Allianz announced on July 24 that it will acquire HSBC Life Singapore and offer protection, health, retirement and **wealth** solutions to the bank's customers in Singapore under a 15-year exclusive distribution agreement.

It is paying \$2.7 billion for the acquisition and distribution agreement, with the transaction expected to close in the first half of 2027.

This agreement adds to similar deals with HSBC in five other markets.

Bate noted that HSBC Life was not merely a bancassurance operation, as it also distributed products through insurance agents and independent financial advisers.

Two weeks after announcing the HSBC Life deal, Allianz Global Investors (AllianzGI) agreed to acquire UOB Asset Management for \$555 million.

The move covers UOB's asset management franchise across Singapore, Brunei, Indonesia, Japan, Malaysia, Taiwan, Thailand and Vietnam.

UOB Asset Management had about \$42 billion in assets under management on Dec 31, 2025.

The deal also includes a 10-year distribution partnership under which UOB will offer investment products managed by AllianzGI to its customers in Singapore and other South-east Asian markets.

Following the acquisition, Asia will account for more than one-third of AllianzGI's assets under management.

Bate said Singapore has become an important global **wealth** hub, with wealthy individuals from regions such as the Middle East and India choosing to invest through the Republic because of its strong rule of law and financial infrastructure.

The two acquisitions mark Allianz's renewed effort to expand in Singapore after the Government blocked its proposed \$2.2 billion acquisition of a majority stake in Income Insurance in 2024.

Allianz withdrew its offer in December 2024.

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Companies & Markets

5 takeaways from Singapore banks' Q2 results – diverging outlooks, China tax rules emerge as new watchpoint

Renald Yeo

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[SINGAPORE] Singapore's three banks continued to grow their earnings in the second quarter despite pressure from lower interest rates, with **wealth management** emerging once again as a key source of growth.

DBS's net profit rose 9 per cent year on year to S\$3.08 billion, while OCBC posted a 22 per cent increase to S\$2.22 billion. UOB's net profit climbed 10 per cent to S\$1.48 billion, as higher fee and other non-interest income helped offset weaker net interest income.

But beneath the headline numbers, the three lenders struck somewhat different notes on the outlook for the rest of the year – and on emerging issues ranging from China's new tax rules to the potential for artificial intelligence to contribute to the bottom line.

DBS was the first of the three banks to report its Q2 results on Thursday (Aug 6), followed by OCBC and UOB on Friday.

Here are five takeaways from their Q2 results:

1. **Wealth** remains the biggest earnings engine

As falling interest rates squeeze lending margins, **wealth management** continues to do much of the heavy lifting for Singapore's banks.

At DBS, **wealth management** fees jumped 33 per cent in the first half to a record S\$1.83 billion, while assets under management crossed S\$500 billion. The business helped lift net fee income by 20 per cent to a record S\$2.94 billion over the period.

That strength was a major reason the bank became more upbeat about its full-year non-interest income outlook, with CEO Tan Su Shan saying the team was "firing on all cylinders and building a strong foundation for future growth".

OCBC similarly recorded strong growth from its **wealth** franchise, with **wealth management** income rising 27 per cent in the first half to a record S\$3.29 billion.

UOB's **wealth management** income rose 16 per cent year on year in the first half to S\$717 million, while high-net-worth assets under management grew 7 per cent to S\$204 billion.

Its momentum has been particularly strong outside Singapore, with **wealth** income from its four key Asean markets – Malaysia, Indonesia, Thailand and Vietnam – rising 30 per cent.

The bank is also looking to lean further into **wealth** after its strategic tie-up with Allianz Global Investors, which will allow it to focus more heavily on distribution and advisory while drawing on the global asset manager's product capabilities.

2. Guidance shows a more uneven outlook for the second half

The banks' guidance revisions point to different expectations for the remainder of 2026.

DBS raised its forecast for commercial-book non-interest income growth to the mid-teens, led by **wealth management**, and now expects total income for the year to exceed 2025 levels. It also expects group net interest income to narrow its gap with last year's level.

OCBC made one of the more notable upgrades, raising its full-year loan growth forecast from mid single-digit growth to the high single-digit to low double-digit range.

That followed particularly strong lending growth in Q2, although group CEO Tan Teck Long cautioned against extrapolating the pace into the rest of the year. The lender also expects full-year income to grow year on year despite a slight decline in net interest income.

UOB, meanwhile, was more circumspect.

It maintained its low single-digit full-year loan growth forecast and net interest margin guidance of between 1.75 and 1.80 per cent, but cut its fee-income growth forecast to the low single digits from high single digits previously.

UOB continues to expect its 2026 earnings to be broadly flat against 2025.

3. China's offshore tax changes have yet to trigger significant outflows

China's increased scrutiny of offshore **wealth** has emerged as a new issue for banks with sizeable Greater China **wealth** businesses, but the lenders said they have yet to see a meaningful impact.

The changes include rules surrounding offshore trusts and the taxation of overseas investment income, raising questions over whether wealthy Chinese clients could shift assets or restructure their holdings.

OCBC said Bank of Singapore – its private banking arm – has not seen any significant asset outflows since news of the changes emerged. Its offshore trust business is also relatively small, while clients have largely been seeking clarification on how the rules apply.

DBS similarly indicated that it was too early to draw conclusions. Tan noted that the bank will comply with the rules while continuing to build out its domestic **wealth** capabilities in China – meaning it can still serve clients if more assets remain onshore.

UOB also described the development as recent, and said it was still assessing the implications.

"We don't see any material impact at the first instance, but it's still something we're watching carefully," said CFO Leong Yung Chee.

4. AI is everywhere – but banks differ on how close it is to generating revenue

All three lenders are deploying AI extensively, but their comments pointed to how difficult it remains to isolate its financial contribution.

DBS has perhaps gone furthest in framing AI as a potential revenue generator. It is using the technology for functions such as idea generation and to prompt customers with relevant opportunities, which can in turn generate transaction and fee flows.

OCBC's Tan took a different approach. "We don't really have an AI strategy per se," he said, explaining that AI sits within the bank's broader "ADD" strategy encompassing digitisation, data analytics and AI.

The focus is on applying the technology where it is fit for purpose rather than pursuing AI for its own sake, he added.

UOB, meanwhile, said more than 30,000 employees have access to Microsoft Copilot, while over 300 AI use cases have been rolled out across the bank. Staff are generating more than 400,000 Copilot prompts a month, noted Leong.

But it is not yet putting a dollar figure on the benefits. UOB has engaged an external auditor to help establish a framework for measuring AI's impact, which it expects to complete by the end of the year, with a view to reporting the numbers regularly thereafter.

5. Investors rewarded DBS and OCBC, but UOB fell after results

The market response also diverged after the banks reported their results.

DBS shares ended the week at a fresh record high of S\$76.33, having gained 3.9 per cent since its results were released on Thursday. The counter is up 35.4 per cent year to date.

OCBC shares closed 3.3 per cent higher at S\$30.30 on Friday, after touching a fresh record high of S\$30.50 intraday. The counter has gained 53.3 per cent since the start of the year.

UOB shares, however, fell 0.6 per cent to S\$43.30 following its results on Friday. The counter is still up 23.5 per cent year to date.

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Sidelines
Winning Mindset

By Naazneen Karmali

500 words

7 August 2026

Forbes Asia

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Volume 22 Issue 5

English

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Success, no matter how stupendous, harbors within it the seed of potential failure if taken for granted and not built upon. As Winston Churchill succinctly summed up: Success is not final. The business leaders profiled in these pages are moving ahead to future-proof their enterprises.

On the cover is one of Singapore's most-watched CEOs, Tan Su Shan, the first woman to head DBS Group, Southeast Asia's largest bank by assets (\$700 billion). Tan, who was born just before the bank was set up in 1968 as the Development Bank of Singapore to support the country's then-emerging businesses, is tasked with leading it in the brave new age of AI, which businesses of all stripes, not just banks, are grappling with. The 16-year DBS veteran has embraced her role with gusto, and, as she disclosed to longtime contributor Jessica Tan in an exclusive sit-down, "It's frontier stuff."

From a banking giant to the 200 small and midsize companies featured on our annual Best Under A Billion list gives an indication of the broad spectrum we endeavor to cover. This compilation, led by contributing editor Ardian Wibisono and contributor Yessar Rosendar, shines a light on top-performing companies with sales above \$10 million and below \$1 billion. Unsurprisingly, firms reaping profits from the AI boom steal the show.

One such is Japan's Santec Holdings, a maker of optical testing gear much in demand in AI data centers that use fiber-optic cables to transmit vast quantities of data. The company's shoebox-sized tunable lasers are crucial to ensuring seamless transmission. Speaking with reporter Zinnia Lee, CEO Mototaka Tei, whose father founded the company in 1979, says he aspires to be "very good" in the few products it makes, a goal that has earned Santec global recognition in its niche.

Another second-generation tycoon featured in this issue is Eusebio Tanco in Manila, a London School of Economics grad who's remade his family group, with roots in cement and metal trading, by diversifying into unrelated areas. Today, Tanco is balancing businesses that couldn't be more different from each other: education, ports and online gaming. We focus on the latter, where Tanco has built listed Digiplus Interactive into the Philippines' largest online gaming operator by gross gaming revenue, a key industry metric.

The entrepreneur's efforts secured him a place on the list of the Philippines' 50 richest in a challenging year when a weaker peso took a toll on the total **wealth** of the country's tycoons, which shrank 8% to \$79 billion. Despite the odds, ports billionaire Enrique Razon Jr.'s **wealth** rose meteorically and he took the No. 1 spot in the country's rankings for the first time. Razon, not one to rest on his success, is pressing ahead with the expansion of his port and energy interests at home and beyond. As always, comments welcome at executiveditor@forbesasia.com.

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Cover Story
Agent Of Change

By Jessica Tan

2,532 words

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In May, Tan Su Shan, CEO of DBS Group, Southeast Asia's largest bank by assets, was on a flight when her cell phone lit up. A disgruntled retail customer had just vented his frustrations on LinkedIn about an unresolved problem he faced on the bank's app. Tan, who along with other senior DBS executives was tagged in the post, responded midair with the assurance that the bank's tech team would resolve it. Grateful for the CEO's speedy action, the customer deleted his post.

This hands-on approach, emphasizing a personal touch, is signature Tan, the first woman boss in the 58-year history of what used to be the Development Bank of Singapore. A DBS veteran of 16 years, she was named to the post in 2024, which earned her a place on Forbes Asia's Power Businesswomen list that year, and moved into the C-suite in March 2025. While her tech-savvy predecessor, Piyush Gupta, was credited with giving DBS a leading edge in digital banking, Tan, 58, is crafting her own imprint at a time when AI has advanced banking's next tipping point.

Under Tan, DBS is fast embedding generative and agentic AI—software that can act autonomously to reason, plan and use tools to complete tasks—in every aspect of its internal operations while also preparing for what she describes as the "potential eventuality" of AI agent-to-agent banking, whereby AI agents representing clients and banks will interact with each other.

"It's frontier stuff," she tells Forbes Asia in an interview at DBS headquarters in Singapore's central business district in late June. "In an agentic world, you won't need banking applications anymore, it's a complete leapfrog. You will create agents that can do payments...**wealth** transactions...foreign exchange, that can do loans," she says.

Dressed in red and black, the colors of the bank's logo, Tan admits this is her preferred sartorial choice when she's meeting investors and clients. On the day of the interview, she's also squeezing in a photoshoot, a presentation to the board of Temasek, the state-owned investment firm that owns about 28% of DBS, and a private banking event she's hosting that evening.

The CEO's accelerated push into AI comes as DBS—which has 40,000 staff across 19 markets in three core businesses: retail banking and **wealth management**, institutional banking, and treasury markets—has to deal with a perfect storm of challenges, including the Middle East war, fluctuating oil prices, an unpredictable interest rate outlook and growing competition.

But Tan is working from a solid base. In 2025, the bank's total income advanced 3% to a record S\$22.9 billion, while net profit fell 3% to S\$11 billion due to higher tax expenses. Both rose 1% year-on-year in the first quarter of 2026, in line with or slightly higher than analysts' expectations. The bank nudged up its full-year net profit outlook, with chief financial officer Chng Sok Hui disclosing in an April media briefing that it has a good shot at "getting close to 2025 levels," compared with earlier guidance of slightly below that number.

Tan acknowledges the uncertain environment that has marked her tenure so far. "We've had tariffs, we've had wars...we've had a lot of unprecedented volatility in rates, in currencies and markets," she says. According to a May report by Thilan Wickramasinghe, an analyst at Malaysia's Maybank, DBS has stress-tested scenarios such as oil at \$120-\$200 a barrel, 20%-30% drops in key currencies and higher inflation.

Meanwhile, Tan is upbeat about structural growth opportunities in Asia, underpinned in part by robust intraregional trade. She notes a surge in China-India trade as well as new trade corridors between countries such as Japan, Korea, Indonesia and Vietnam.

At the same time, one of the bank's strongest businesses, **wealth management**, which along with retail banking accounted for 46% of DBS' 2025 total income, continues to gain momentum, driven by an influx of the ultrarich and their family offices into Singapore, with its reputation as a safe haven. The bank estimates its retail and **wealth** assets under management (AUM) will surge at least 58% to more than S\$1 trillion by 2030 from S\$632 billion at end-2025, fueled partly by the AI push.

Investors seem confident in Tan's leadership, with the stock rising 60% since she took charge, scaling all-time highs and outpacing the benchmark Straits Times Index. "Amidst high levels of macro uncertainty, DBS' scale, capital and increasing AI integration gives the group strong positioning to leverage opportunities," says Maybank's Wickramasinghe. The bank's adoption of enterprise AI "to improve resilience and reduce human error," he notes, could "drive further efficiencies."

The AI drive has begun to pay off. All told, DBS had more than 2,000 active AI models as of end-2025 and says it achieved an estimated S\$1 billion in economic value last year through revenue gains and cost reductions.

Part of the bank's AI strategy is DBS-GPT, a generative AI platform that employees can use to access information such as internal policy documents and product data as well as for research. They can also use the platform to build their own personal agents, about 26,000 so far, thanks to Tan's evangelizing efforts: At an offsite with the bank's senior executives in March, she distributed a T-Shirt emblazoned with the slogan, "Talk is cheap, show me your agent." Tan cites the example of a staffer responsible for collating the deposit rates of multiple banks in order to calculate what rate DBS should offer and who now uses a personal agent to do the grunt work.

Eleven enterprise AI initiatives that span multiple departments such as legal and compliance, institutional banking, marketing and **wealth management**, have also been embedded. For example, an AI-powered workflow for writing credit memos has helped corporate bankers substantially reduce the amount of time they spend on such a task, according to Tan.

But potentially the most seismic shift in the industry is still to come: the introduction of AI agent-to-agent banking. The concept is still in its embryonic phase and DBS has yet to disclose specific plans, but it's already testing the agentic commerce space. In February, it partnered with global payments giant Visa to allow AI agents to make payments on behalf of consumers using tokenized credit card details, a digital security measure that hides the card number.

Shortly after that collaboration, other banks joined a similar Visa program, including Oversea-Chinese Banking (OCBC), United Overseas Bank (UOB) and Standard Chartered. In March, Mastercard linked with both DBS and UOB for its first live agentic transaction in Singapore when an agent booked an airport ride using its framework. London-based Gartner vice president analyst Alistair Newton says that experimenting with agentic commerce first makes sense and banks are gleaning lessons from that space.

Competitors are likewise investing heavily to integrate AI and digital initiatives, with OCBC saying in July it would raise its annual tech outlay to about S\$1 billion for the next few years. DBS declines to reveal how much it is spending on its AI roll-out, but Tay Wee Kuang, head of research at CGS International Securities Singapore, says it has a head start and, "in terms of trying to catch up, the other banks will have to do more to try to narrow the gap."

DBS is also being challenged on its prime turf of **wealth management**. OCBC, with banking assets under management of S\$342 billion as of Mar. 31, agreed earlier this year to buy the retail banking and **wealth management** assets of HSBC's Indonesia arm and has pledged to double its retail **wealth** banking business by 2029. It's set to hire 600 relationship managers over the next three years, and in July it launched an AI banking app that uses avatars to offer **wealth management** services. UOB, with **wealth** AUM of close to S\$200 billion as of end-March, reportedly plans to expand its relationship management team by 60% to 450 in the next five years.

But Tan is determined to stay at the front of the pack. By deploying AI tools in its **wealth management** operations, the bank says it takes half as much time to onboard new **wealth** clients and it has helped to speed up investment decisions. By mid-August, it plans to integrate a generative AI-powered bot or virtual assistant into its digiWealth platform to help customers access **wealth**-related information. On the brick-and-mortar side, the bank will upgrade 36 of its **wealth** centers across Asia and open 18 new ones by end-2027. It also plans to add 600 frontline advisors and platform engineers in six key markets, including Singapore, mainland China, India and Taiwan, by 2028.

As for AI agent-to-agent banking, DBS is planning for "base case, bad case and bull case" scenarios, according to Tan. "If everyone is using agents...if you still want to be the bank of choice...you better make sure your

services, your products are lined up first in place, not last in the queue," she asserts. "We have to prepare for [it], whether it happens in two years, five years, 10 years," she adds.

It may not take that long, says Gartner's Newton. "Pretty much every conversation I have with tier one, tier two bank clients across the globe, they are having digital knocks on their front door from [AI] agents and machines," he reveals. By 2029, 25% of banks' customer service interactions will use AI financial assistants or machine customers, up from 8% in 2025.

The banks are grappling with how to interact with entities whose identities they can't validate, says Newton. While some are tempted to close the door, "A larger proportion are trying to figure out how to engage with them, because while they know there are bad actors...increasingly they know these are agents acting on behalf of customers," he says.

Indeed, both agentic and agent-to-agent banking are fraught with potential risks related to governance, trust, cybersecurity and sovereignty. DBS says it is working on "control plane" software to ensure rigorous oversight of all agents it deploys. Having guardrails in place is key, Tan maintains. "Your agents have to be grounded in very good data [relating to] the customer...in controls, in governance, in policies," she says. With regard to the AI-powered credit-memo-writing workflow, for example, "we've put some stops and gates just to make sure there is human cognition," she adds.

The spread of AI raises the spectre of layoffs. In May, Standard Chartered CEO Bill Winters was widely criticized and had to apologize for referring to the nearly 8,000 support roles set to lose their jobs because of AI as "lower-value human capital." In Singapore, the parliament supported a motion in May that AI disruptions should not lead to jobless growth. Tan is mindful of treading a fine line. "Other people might say it's easier, just fire everyone and then hire again, but if you do that, then where is the humanistic appreciation of people who've been with you 30 years, 40 years, 20 years?"

Tan elaborates that for staff willing to morph, "we want to save them." DBS employees are being urged to reskill and roles are being redesigned, she adds. To help employees adapt, DBS has built an online learning hub where they can access more than 10,000 classes. The bank also organizes hackathons, teach-ins and trips to Silicon Valley to meet fintech startups.

Since she took charge, the number of entry level production engineers, who work on routine operations, has been reduced to 135 as of July from 3,000 due to AI, but the bank says those affected were retrained and moved to other tech positions within the organization. That said, DBS has acknowledged that some 4,000 temporary or contract roles could be phased out in the coming years due to AI adoption.

A banking lifer, Tan interned at DBS while studying philosophy, politics and economics at Oxford University. After graduating in 1989, she worked for several financial institutions, including Barings Securities, a unit of Barings Bank that posted her to London, Tokyo and Hong Kong to cover institutional equity and derivative sales before it collapsed in 1995.

After that, two stints at Morgan Stanley, where she pivoted to private banking, punctuated by a stop at Citi Private Bank, a division of Citibank, deepened her **wealth management** experience. In 2010, Gupta, an ex-Citi colleague, hired her back to DBS as group head of **wealth management**. She knew the movers and shakers and culture-wise, she was a good fit, says Gupta, now chairman of both Singapore investment company Keppel and the board of trustees at Singapore Management University. "I wanted to get somebody who had the capacity to work collaboratively, and in private banking, it's not easy, because it's an industry made up of a lot of prima donnas," he says.

Tan went on to head up the retail banking and **wealth management** business as well as institutional banking at DBS. Over the years she honed her ability to strike a rapport with key clients. Billionaire hotelier Koh Wee Meng counts Tan as a private and corporate banker he has come to trust. She "connects with people very easily" and has built a "strong and long-term partnership" with his businesses, says Koh, who made his early fortune from property development and the budget Fragrance Hotel chain in Singapore, and also owns hotels in Australia and the U.K.

Tan worked closely with Gupta, whom she considers a mentor alongside longtime DBS chairman Peter Seah, as he transformed DBS into a digital bank. There were lessons along the way, including one related to an early attempt at AI adoption. In 2014, the bank worked on an AI tool to give **wealth** clients advice in real time, but after 18 months, Gupta pulled the plug. The key takeaway, he recalls, was that the bank needed to be "more pragmatic in our choice of use cases and try to focus on internal rather than external applications at first pass." But the

experiment, he says, gave DBS "a lot of learning to build on." Tan agrees that the setback paved the way for the bank's AI journey. "Learning from that failure was [something] money cannot buy," she says.

But as keen as Tan is on leading DBS into the AI future, she says that some things about banking won't change, such as the personal touch, which, she insists, will remain indispensable. "You can use AI to answer questions," but "You need humans to do what humans do best, which is to create long-term human-to-human relationships," she says. "At the end of the day, that's what being human is all about."

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The Official Board

HSBC Bank Turkey - The organizational chart displays its 9 executives, including Burcin Ozan and Seyyare Ozbasli

229 words

7 August 2026

The Official Board

OFBOAR

English

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In the Banking industry, there are 5,570 large companies in 188 countries, with a total of 104,122 top executives. Within those companies, 43,366 executive movements have been recorded in the last 12 months.

Company: HSBC Bank Turkey

URL: www.hsbc.com.tr

Industry: Banking

HSBC Bank Turkey is a subsidiary of HSBC Continental Europe.

Name: Burcin Ozan

Title: Chief Executive Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/burcin-ozan-g9409>

Name: Cem Muratoglu

Title: Head of **Wealth** and Personal Banking

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/cem-muratoglu-106g8>

Name: Ibrahim Chukwuemeka Hayatuddini

Title: Chief Financial Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/ibrahim-chukwuemeka-hayatuddini-g58e1>

Name: Tolga Tuzuner

Title: Chief Legal Counsel

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/tolga-tuzuner-78g58>

Name: Namik Aksel

Title: Head of Global Markets

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/namik-aksel-605d1>

Name: Seyyare Ozbasli

Title: Chief Operating Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/seyyare-ozbasli-eg184>

Name: Peter Kallo

Title: Chief Credit and Risk Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/peter-kallo-27d30>

Name: Funda Temoçin

Title: Head of People and Communications

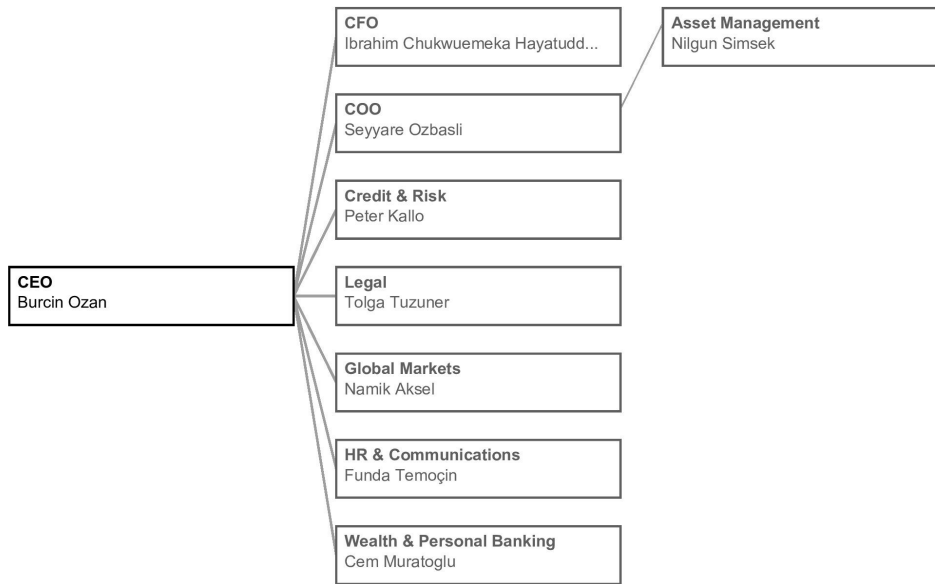
Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/funda-temocin-de708>

Name: Nilgun Simsek

Title: Chief Executive Officer, Asset Management

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/nilgun-simsek-71g31>

Organizational Chart HSBC Bank Turkey



The Official Board as of Aug 10, 2026 8:01:44 AM - Know more at contact@theofficialboard.com



UOB; UOB partners Visa to launch new Visa Infinite tiers across ASEAN in landmark multi-market launch of such scale

850 words

7 August 2026

Investment Weekly News

INVWK

401

English

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2026 AUG 8 (VerticalNews) -- By a News Reporter-Staff News Editor at Investment Weekly News -- UOB has partnered with Visa, a global leader in digital payments, to relaunch several card products across its five key markets (Singapore, Malaysia, Thailand, Indonesia and Vietnam) under Visa's newly introduced premium card tiers, Visa Infinite Privilege and Visa Infinite Private.

UOB is progressively upgrading its suite of affluent and high-net-worth (HNW) card solutions to the new Visa Infinite tiers, reinforcing the Bank's leadership in premium card innovation. With the relaunch, more than 300,000 UOB Visa Infinite cardholders across ASEAN will be upgraded to higher card tiers, giving them access to an expanded suite of premium benefits. All other cardholders will continue to enjoy their existing privileges, with no downgrades across the portfolio. Eligible UOB Visa Infinite cardholders will be notified of their new card tiers via UOB's official channels from September onwards, with no action required from them.

UOB is currently Visa's largest card issuer in ASEAN[1] and brings an unparalleled regional footprint and customer base, serving over 8.5 million customers across the region. As the first Visa issuer across ASEAN to execute a launch of this scale across multiple markets, UOB and Visa are setting a new benchmark for regional card offerings, delivering elevated privileges and experiences to affluent cardmembers in the region. This collaboration is timely as affluent spending in ASEAN experiences strong growth. The number of new UOB affluent cardholders[2] grew over 10 per cent year-on-year in 2025, while card billings for this segment surged more than 25 per cent in the same year.

Visa unveiled its refreshed Visa Infinite offering in Asia Pacific on 16 July 2026, reimagined for the evolving needs of today's affluent consumers. Anchored in a three-tier card suite, the enhanced platform introduces greater flexibility, personalisation and differentiated benefits across the affluent spectrum. In addition to Visa Infinite, the portfolio now includes the newly launched Visa Infinite Privilege and Visa Infinite Private, enabling issuers to deliver more tailored value propositions, experiences and rewards to distinct customer segments within a unified premium framework.

Selected top-tier UOB cardholders across the region will enjoy access to enhanced platform privileges and UOB-exclusive curated experiences, tailored to their respective Visa Infinite tiers. This aligns with UOB's sharpened customer segmentation approach and enhanced card value propositions, aimed at serving the unique needs of customers by offering exclusive privileges tailored to their lifestyle preferences.

Mr Pratik Bhattacharjee, Head of Group Cards and Payment Products, UOB, said, "As UOB continues to sharpen our customer-centric operating model, we are focused on serving our customers more holistically across the **wealth** spectrum. Our partnership with Visa marks a significant milestone in this journey, allowing us to deepen our engagement with affluent customers by curating exclusive experiences that money cannot buy. As we continue strengthening our offerings to cater to each customer's aspirations and lifestyle, our goal is to connect with them through life moments and opportunities that truly matter."

Mr. T.R. Ramachandran, Head of Products & Solutions for Asia Pacific, Visa, said, "The affluent segment is one of the fastest-growing consumer segments in Asia Pacific, with expectations evolving alongside it. Today's affluent consumers are seeking experiences that are more personalised, seamless and relevant to their lifestyles. The refreshed Visa Infinite portfolio is designed to meet these changing expectations, and through our partnership with UOB, we are extending these enhanced experiences to affluent customers across Southeast Asia."

Greater personalisation through tiered privileges

With Visa's enhanced Infinite tier segmentation, selected cardholders will benefit from more tailored services, differentiated privileges and elevated experiences that reflect their evolving lifestyle needs. This includes access to curated regional and global lifestyle offers as well as premium destination-based travel and dining privileges worldwide as part of the base membership. In addition, selected cardholders will get exclusive access to top-tier concerts and global sporting events like FIFA World Cup(TM), and reserved entitlements to key lifestyle offerings under Visa Infinite Privilege. At the highest tier, Visa Infinite Private offers bespoke invitation-only experiences highly personalised for ultra-high-net-worth individuals.

Leveraging its deep understanding of affluent customers across the region, UOB will complement Visa's refreshed benefits with exclusive privileges, curated experiences and value-added offerings tailored to the unique preferences of its cardmembers. For example, selected cardholders will be able to enjoy specially-customised luxury travel experiences and privileged access to curated series of rare timepieces.

Paired with the Bank's unparalleled regional connectivity, advisory excellence and One Bank ecosystem, this partnership with Visa aligns with UOB's aim to bring together banking, **wealth** and lifestyle holistically to all customers. This also furthers the Bank's ambition to become the Bank of Choice for aspiring customers across ASEAN.

Keywords for this news article include: UOB.

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UOB; Consumer confidence remains resilient across ASEAN as Singapore records the strongest improvement in the region: UOB's regional Consumer Sentiment Index

1,254 words

7 August 2026

Economics Week

ECOWEK

114

English

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2026 AUG 7 (VerticalNews) -- By a News Reporter-Staff News Editor at Economics Week -- ASEAN consumers remained optimistic about both the macroeconomic environment and their personal finances in 2026, with the UOB ASEAN Consumer Sentiment Index (the Index)[1] holding steady at 54. Despite ongoing macroeconomic uncertainties such as geopolitical tensions in the Middle East and concerns over rising oil prices, consumers' sentiment proved resilient as most major ASEAN economies continued to show steady growth. Stronger optimism about the macroeconomic environment helped sustain regional confidence, even as consumers remained pragmatic about their personal finances amid concerns over household expenses, income security and long-term financial commitments. Against this backdrop, Singapore recorded the region's strongest improvement, with its country's Index surging nine points to 56.

Together with a pickup in sentiment in Thailand, this helped to counterbalance softer sentiment in the rest of the region.

The Index is based on six key indicators from the eighth edition of the flagship UOB ASEAN Consumer Sentiment Study (ACSS)[2], covering consumers' perceptions of current and future economic conditions and their personal financial outlook. An Index score above the neutral level of 50 indicates overall optimism among consumers across the region. This year's Index reflected a region that remained confident about broader economic prospects despite ongoing volatility and geopolitical uncertainty.

Stronger optimism towards the macroeconomic environment was the key driver underpinning regional sentiment, with the macro sub-index rising by three points to 61. Positive perceptions of the current economic environment rose from 57 per cent to 60 per cent, while optimism about economic performance over the next six to 12 months increased from 58 per cent to 61 per cent. This stronger macro confidence helped sustain the overall Index, even as consumers remained more measured about their personal finances.

Consumers remained cautious about their personal finances, with the micro (personal finances) sub-index easing slightly from 52 to 51 this year. While there are more respondents who expected themselves to be financially better off next year (four percentage points increase to 60 per cent), concerns around increased household expenses, prospects of pay cuts and ability to sustain long-term financial commitments weighed on sentiment, with each indicator dipping by three percentage points from a year ago.

Mr Suan Teck Kin, Head of Research, Global Economics and Markets Research, UOB, said: "ASEAN-5 economies remained resilient in the first half of 2026, with Singapore and Thailand outperforming expectations. Amid heightened geopolitical tensions, ASEAN remains a compelling investment destination for multinational corporations as companies diversify supply chains and expand their regional presence. This is supporting employment growth and broader economic opportunities across the region, and is reflected in consumers' stronger optimism about the macroenvironment."

Singapore and Thailand drive regional uplift as macro confidence strengthens

Consumer sentiment diverged across ASEAN markets in 2026, reflecting differing economic conditions and consumer priorities. Vietnam retained the highest level of consumer sentiment, while Singapore and Thailand recorded the strongest year-on-year improvement.

Vietnam recorded its country's Index at 63, making it the most optimistic market in the region despite a four-point decline, and surpassing the regional average by nine points. Confidence was underpinned by exceptionally strong sentiment on the macroeconomic environment, with 84 per cent of Vietnam consumers expressing positive views of both their current and future economic performance. More consumers (80 per cent, an increase of three percentage points) also expect that they will be better off financially this time next year, despite increasing concerns about their personal finances and income security.

The buoyant consumer sentiment was supported by the country's position as the fastest growing economy in ASEAN, with healthy economic fundamentals and government measures that cushioned elevated energy prices and alleviated broader price pressures. Foreign investors remained confident in Vietnam's medium-term prospects as supply chain diversification continued to favour the country, with data for the first half of 2026 suggesting that foreign direct investment (FDI) inflows are on track to remain near record highs this year.

Singapore recorded the region's strongest improvement, with its country's Index surging nine points to 56. This was driven by uplifts across all macroeconomic and personal finance indicators. Positive perceptions of the current economy rose 16 percentage points to 66 per cent, while confidence in future economic performance increased 13 percentage points to 63 per cent. This reflected Singapore's strong growth performance in the first half of 2026, as tailwinds from artificial intelligence-related demand supported activity across manufacturing, wholesale trade, transport and storage, with positive spillovers into the services sector.

Improved personal finance sentiment also contributed to Singapore's higher Index score, with fewer consumers expressing concerns over household expenses and more of them feeling positive about their long-term financial commitments compared to last year. Government efforts to alleviate cost-of-living pressures through measures such as CDC vouchers, U-Save rebates and Cost-of-Living support payments have helped cushion household expenses amid ongoing global uncertainty. **Wealth** effects from gains in equity markets may also have bolstered consumer sentiment and discretionary spending.

Thailand's Index rose four points to 51, as improved optimism towards both current and future economic conditions drove the strong uplift, with both indicators increasing from 39 per cent to 50 per cent. Government stimulus measures, particularly the Thai Chuay Thai Plus programme, alongside resilient tourism and exports, easing external pressures, and seasonal gains in farm incomes supported consumer sentiment. Sentiment towards personal finances remained relatively stable (only one percentage point improvement from last year), likely a reflection of the country's persistently high household and business debt, elevated living costs, and uncertainty stemming from geopolitical tensions and US tariff measures.

On the other hand, Malaysia's Index eased three points to 50, bringing overall sentiment closer to neutral. Despite a more positive economic outlook, concerns over household expenses, income security and long-term financial commitments weighed on sentiment, with an increase of nine, eight, and seven percentage points respectively from last year. While headline inflation suggests that overall price pressures remain manageable, rising living costs across essential categories such as food, utilities, healthcare and insurance have likely contributed to the more cautious outlook. Mitigating factors such as fuel subsidies and stable labour market conditions continued to buffer for higher expenses, while strong export performance, higher mining output and sustained domestic demand supported Malaysia's economic resilience. Following Malaysia, Indonesia also recorded a slight dip in its Index at 49, from 55 a year ago, amid a more challenging external environment marked by currency pressures and global uncertainty.

As ASEAN continues to navigate a complex and fast-changing global environment, the UOB ASEAN Consumer Sentiment Index offers a timely barometer of how consumers across the region are responding to economic shifts, policy measures and financial pressures. Backed by insights from the flagship UOB ASEAN Consumer Sentiment Study, this year's findings point to an increasingly nuanced consumer landscape, where optimism about the broader economic outlook coexists with a prudent approach towards personal finances. This balance between optimism and pragmatism underscores the resilience of ASEAN consumers and reinforces the importance of UOB's deep regional presence in understanding and supporting their evolving needs across the region.

Keywords for this news article include: UOB, Asia, Vietnam, Thailand, Economics, Singapore, Finance and Investment.

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Invest

Staff at Singapore banks reap big windfall as company stocks shoot up

Angela Tan

1,556 words

7 August 2026

The Straits Times

STIMES

online

English

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SINGAPORE – “Yes, I am in heaven – seventh heaven!” Maggie Liu says with a laugh as the shares of OCBC climbed to record highs.

The 27-year-old legal executive at OCBC Bank is among a growing number of employees whose disciplined monthly contributions to their companies’ employee share purchase plans (ESPPs) have paid off handsomely as Singapore bank stocks soar to new peaks.

Unlike buying shares through the stock market, participating in an ESPP allows eligible employees to contribute a fixed sum from their monthly salary over a pre-determined period.

Those savings are used to purchase company shares, typically at a discount to the prevailing market price – making ESPPs one of the most cost-effective ways for ordinary workers to build ownership in blue-chip companies.

In many cases, the disciplined nature of payroll deductions encourages employees to invest regularly, instead of trying to time the market.

For Liu, what began as a modest savings habit has become one of her best financial decisions.

Her experience reflects a broader trend unfolding across Singapore’s banking sector.

As DBS, OCBC and UOB shares rally on strong earnings, generous dividends and higher interest rates over the past few years, eligible employees have found themselves sitting on sizeable gains.

For many, cashing out their accumulated shares has become a way to fund overseas holidays or other major expenses. Others choose to hold on to the shares, allowing them to compound through capital gains and dividends as part of their retirement nest egg.

For Wendy Ng, participating in OCBC’s share plan was not initially an obvious decision.

When she first joined the bank more than two decades ago as a contact centre agent, setting aside even a few hundred dollars a month felt difficult.

“I didn’t participate immediately because you have to put some money aside. Back then, I was still early in my career,” she says.

However, after her salary grew, Ng joined the plan.

“I heard people talking about this as a form of forced savings. So I eventually put aside a few hundred dollars every month. I am glad I did, because I would have used the money to buy soft toys and stuff for my hobbies otherwise,” she says, adding that the interest rate is also attractive.

“I am very happy because this is a good opportunity for us to gain shares in the bank and save as well.”

Ng, who is now in the bank's service transformation department, a role still close to her customer-service roots, has participated in the plan every year since 2010.

The timing, in hindsight, is perfect. She recalls buying OCBC shares at about \$8 each in the early days of her participation. Today, the shares are around \$30. She has also collected years of dividends along the way.

Another employee, Lee Pek Wai, tells a similar story.

The client account services specialist at Bank of Singapore, OCBC's private banking arm, has spent more than three decades within the group. She joined the ESPP in 2009 after feeling financially comfortable enough to commit part of her salary monthly.

"I wasn't, and I still am not much of, an investor. I just wanted something safe to build up my savings steadily for retirement," Lee says.

Since then, she has enrolled in every offering.

"I have also been very happy with the dividends that I have been receiving over the years. This is my best investment to date by far," she says.

Stories like that are not unusual within OCBC.

As the bank continues to notch up record valuations, more of its employees are finding that this workplace benefit once viewed as little more than "forced saving" has become an unexpectedly powerful **wealth**-building tool.

Ernest Phang, OCBC's head of talent acquisition, total rewards, risk and compliance in group human resources, says its ESPP has ended "in the money" in 15 of its past 18 offering periods, meaning participating employees were able to purchase shares below the prevailing market price.

Almost four in five participants have enrolled in multiple offering periods, suggesting many employees view the programme as a long-term savings and investment vehicle rather than a short-term trading opportunity.

Schemes differ

Not all employee equity plans work the same way.

DBS Bank operates an ESPP that allows eligible staff – those ranked executive director and below – to participate.

Each year, employees can choose to contribute up to 10 per cent of their monthly salary, capped at \$1,000 a month, while receiving matching contributions from the bank.

Patrick Sim, senior associate and branch service manager at DBS, says the DBS iShares programme has been an excellent monthly savings scheme, empowering staff to accumulate **wealth** and become owners of the bank's shares.

DBS matches 25 per cent of employee contributions through additional bank shares, which vest 24 months after the end of each plan year.

Sim says: "This scheme offers the dual benefit of consistent quarterly dividend yields and potential capital appreciation, fostering strong loyalty to the bank among employees."

A DBS spokesperson says the programme reflects the company's commitment to encouraging disciplined saving and long-term investing, while giving employees the opportunity to share in the success they help create.

Employees who have remained invested over the years have benefited alongside other shareholders as DBS shares climbed to record highs of more than \$75.

UOB defers part of the variable pay for employees in senior grades and material risk personnel into restricted shares under the UOB Share Plan. These are vested over at least three years. While they remain unvested, employees receive dividends at the same rate as ordinary shares.

Employee ownership extends well beyond Singapore's banking sector.

Listed companies such as Singapore Airlines and Singtel also offer equity-based incentive schemes as part of their overall remuneration framework.

Across Singapore, companies from start-ups to multinationals have long embraced equity-based incentives such as ESPPs and employee share option plans to attract and retain talent.

For many IT professionals, equity can make up a significant portion of total compensation – sometimes outweighing base salary over the long term.

Past performance is no guarantee of future returns

Singapore's banks have enjoyed an exceptional run over the past few years, supported by resilient earnings, healthy capital positions and a higher interest rate environment.

If economic conditions change, interest rates fall sharply or corporate earnings weaken, share prices could come under pressure.

For employees considering whether to participate in an equity plan, understanding the details matters as much as appreciating the potential upside.

Questions worth asking include how the purchase price is determined, whether the company offers a discount or matching contribution, what the vesting schedule looks like, whether there are lock-up periods, and what happens to the shares or options if the employee leaves the organisation.

Contribution limits, administrative fees and dividend treatment can also affect overall returns.

For listed companies, employees can evaluate the firm's profitability, dividend record and long-term share price performance. For private companies and start-ups, the more important question is often whether there is a realistic path to an eventual liquidity event, such as an initial public offering or acquisition.

At OCBC, the ESPP has evolved into more than just a staff benefit.

Launched in 2004, the programme was intended to foster a stronger sense of ownership among employees by allowing them to become shareholders in the group.

Employees from across OCBC Group – including OCBC Bank, Bank of Singapore and Great Eastern – who are at least 21 years old and have been with the group for not less than six months can participate.

The duration of each ESPP offering period is two years.

At the start of each offering period, employees can decide on a fixed sum, up to a maximum contribution level set by the bank, for the purpose of the ESPP. This contribution will be made from their monthly salary.

They then have the option to convert these contributions to OCBC shares once after 12 months, and once more after the full two years.

As a further incentive, during the two years, the contributions will earn a preferential interest rate.

Employee participation can be withdrawn at any time without penalty, and the amounts contributed, along with accrued interest, will be refunded to them.

For every offering, the share acquisition price is fixed at the start of the offering period and is based on the average of the last traded prices over the five consecutive trading days immediately before the price-fixing date.

More than two decades after the programme began, employees like Liu, Ng and Lee are among those who have benefited from staying the course.

They do not describe themselves as sophisticated investors. Nor did they set out expecting to make windfall gains.

Instead, they simply invested consistently through monthly payroll deductions, while continuing with their careers.

Their experience offers a reminder that **wealth** is often built through patience and discipline rather than dramatic investment bets.

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Document STIMES0020260807em87002xo

Banking

UOB expands wealth solutions through strategic partnership with Allianz Global Investors

Team CXP Asia

407 words

7 August 2026

CXP Asia

BMCXPA

English

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UOB Group is strengthening its **wealth management** strategy through a strategic agreement for Allianz Global Investors (AGI) to acquire UOB Asset Management (UOBAM), while establishing a long-term distribution partnership to expand investment solutions for customers across Asia.

The acquisition covers UOBAM's operations in eight markets: Singapore, Brunei, Indonesia, Japan, Malaysia, Taiwan, Thailand and Vietnam, and is expected to be completed in 2027, subject to regulatory approvals.

Under the partnership, UOB will continue to focus on its role as an open-architecture **wealth** distributor, working with AGI to provide a wider range of investment products and solutions for its more than eight million regional customers.

The collaboration aims to strengthen UOB's advisory-led approach by offering customers more diversified investment options aligned with their financial goals, life stages and risk profiles.

UOB and AGI said they will prioritise a smooth transition for customers and employees. All 500 UOBAM employees across the region will transfer to AGI, which has committed to maintaining their employment while providing access to a broader global investment platform. UOBAM's operations will continue as usual, with customers able to access, invest in and redeem their funds without disruption.

The transaction, valued at S\$555 million, is expected to generate a pre-tax gain of approximately S\$330 million and increase UOB's CET1 ratio by around 14 basis points, excluding one-off transaction costs.

UOBAM, which has been part of UOB for four decades, has grown into a regional asset management franchise with approximately S\$42 billion in assets under management as of Dec. 31, 2025.

UOB Deputy Chairman and Chief Executive Officer Wee Ee Cheong said the partnership would allow the bank to sharpen its focus on **wealth** advisory and distribution while combining UOB's customer relationships with AGI's global investment capabilities.

"By combining UOB's advisory expertise and customer relationships with Allianz Global Investors' investment capabilities, we are well positioned to meet our customers' evolving needs and support their long-term **wealth** goals," he said.

AGI CEO Tobias Pross said the partnership would combine UOBAM's Southeast Asian investment expertise with AGI's global active investment platform, enabling both organisations to deliver broader **wealth management** and retirement solutions across the region.

The collaboration reflects a broader shift in financial services, as banks increasingly strengthen advisory capabilities, expand investment choices and build more personalised **wealth** journeys for customers.

Document BMCXPA0020260807em8700001

FINANCE

Standard Chartered gets nod to offer **wealth** products from GIFT City in India

289 words

7 August 2026

19:30

MarketLine News and Comment

DTMNTR

English

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Standard Chartered has received in-principle clearance from the International Financial Services Centres Authority to distribute capital market products from Gujarat International Finance Tec-City, or GIFT City, in India.

The decision allows the banking giant to start offering **wealth** products from the financial centre.

It plans to introduce its Signature CIO Funds there in the coming weeks, with other **wealth** offerings expected later.

The Signature CIO Funds consist of four funds linked to the bank's Chief Investment Office (CIO) investment approach.

They invest across a mix of asset classes, including equities, fixed income, commodities, alternatives and cash.

The funds were launched in 2022 and have gathered more than \$5bn in assets under management. They are available in 12 markets, including Standard Chartered's private banking locations.

Standard Chartered began operations in GIFT City in 2020 as the first foreign bank to do so. It now offers banking services there to corporate and institutional clients.

Standard Chartered **wealth** solutions, retail products, data & analytics?global head Samir Subberwal said: "We are seeing growing demand from affluent clients for internationally diversified portfolios, expert advice and seamless access to opportunities across markets. GIFT City provides a compelling platform to serve these needs, drawing on India's growing role in global **wealth** creation and investment flows.

"This approval marks an important step in expanding our **wealth** capabilities through GIFT City, starting with the launch of our Signature CIO Funds and followed by a broader suite of **wealth** solutions over time. As a leading international **wealth** manager, we are well-positioned to connect clients to global investment opportunities through our network, CIO expertise and advisory capabilities."

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Document DTMNTR0020260807em87000gv

HSBC Private Bank appoints Feras Al Jaramani to lead its UAE Market

DUBAI

290 words

7 August 2026

TradeArabia

TRADAR

English

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HSBC Private Bank has confirmed the appointment of Feras Al Jarmani to lead its UAE Market, taking on overall responsibility for the bank's private banking business across the country.

Al Jaramani expands his role from Head of the UAE Market for Arab and Emirati Clients, and his expanded remit brings HSBC's UAE private banking teams under a single leadership as the bank pursues its ambition to become the leading private bank in the Middle East, the bank said.

The appointment supports HSBC's UAE **wealth** hub strategy and the ambition of its International **Wealth** and Premier Banking (IWPB) business to become the UAE's leading international **wealth** player, serving the full spectrum of clients from affluent individuals to ultra-high-net-worth families and entrepreneurs. The UAE remains a strategically important market for HSBC, attracting more net inflows of millionaires than any other country in the world.

Al Jarmaani brings 25 years of financial services experience, including 13 years at HSBC servicing sovereign and corporate clients in the UAE. In his expanded role he will drive closer alignment across HSBC's UAE private banking teams, faster decision-making and a more integrated, consistent client experience, while maintaining clear governance and accountability.

Aladdin Hangari, Head of HSBC Private Bank, MENA, said: "Feras is a highly experienced leader who understands the UAE and the needs of our clients here. Bringing our UAE private banking teams under his leadership sharpens our focus on what matters most: helping clients build, protect and grow their **wealth**. This is an important step as we deliver on our ambition to be the leading private bank in the region." - TradeArabia News Service

[Click to view image](#)

Document TRADAR0020260807em87000jh

CrediaBank posts record first-half profit as loan growth accelerates

547 words

7 August 2026

The Malta Independent

MLIND

English

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CrediaBank reported record financial results for the first half of 2026, driven by strong lending growth, higher recurring revenues and improved operational efficiency, while saying it remains well positioned to complete its planned acquisition of a majority stake in HSBC Bank Malta, subject to regulatory approvals.

In a statement, CrediaBank said that the lender posted recurring operating profit of €53.6 million for the six months ended June 30, up 45% from the same period a year earlier. Recurring profit before tax also rose 45% year-on-year to €40.1 million, supported by continued credit expansion and growth in fee-based income.

CrediaBank reached a new high in lending activity during the first half, with €2 billion in new loan disbursements, a 26% increase compared with the same period in 2025. Net credit expansion rose 55% year-on-year to €841 million, while gross loans increased 39% to €5.3 billion.

The bank's total assets grew 20% year-on-year to €9.6 billion, while customer deposits increased 16% to €7.6 billion, supporting a loan-to-deposit ratio of 70% and a liquidity coverage ratio of 145%.

Revenue growth continued across the bank's core businesses. Net interest income increased 26% year-on-year to €98.2 million, while net fee and commission income rose 34% to €22.7 million during the first half.

CrediaBank also reported further improvements in efficiency and asset quality. Its cost-to-recurring income ratio fell to 58.9%, down 772 basis points from a year earlier. The non-performing exposure (NPE) ratio declined to 2.4%, its lowest level to date, while the NPE coverage ratio improved to 57.1%.

Capital levels remained comfortably above regulatory requirements. The bank reported a Common Equity Tier 1 (CET1) ratio of 15.5% and a total capital ratio of 20.8%. On a pro forma basis, including its planned acquisition of Evropi Holdings, the CET1 ratio would increase to 16.7%.

During the first half, CrediaBank completed a €300 million share capital increase and advanced several strategic initiatives, including the acquisition of Evropi Holdings, a Greek property and casualty insurer, and an agreement to acquire a 70% stake in Pantelakis Securities S.A. Both transactions remain subject to corporate and regulatory approvals.

The bank also announced a strategic partnership with BNP Paribas Asset Management to strengthen its **wealth management** offering and joined the European Investment Bank's Security and Defence Programme to support small and medium-sized enterprises.

CrediaBank said its proposed acquisition of a majority shareholding in HSBC Bank Malta, which is awaiting regulatory approval, is expected to more than double the group's balance sheet, taking total assets above €17 billion, while enhancing profitability.

Chief Executive Officer Eleni Vrettou said the bank's performance reflected continued execution of its growth strategy.

"Looking ahead, we continue to focus on strengthening our customer relationships, supporting the healthy economy, expanding our product and service offering, accelerating our digital transformation and leveraging strategic partnerships and targeted investments," Vrettou said.

She added that the planned entry into the Maltese market would represent an important milestone for the group and create additional value for customers and stakeholders in both Greece and Malta, subject to regulatory approvals.

Document MLIND00020260807em8700033

Singapore

Daily Debrief: What Happened Today (Aug 7)

360 words

7 August 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

online

English

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Stories you might have missed

UOB Kay Hian H1 net profit jumps 66% to S\$164.7 million on higher volume

[SINGAPORE] UOB Kay Hian posted a 66 per cent surge in net profit to S\$164.7 million for the first half of FY2026 ended June. This increase from S\$99.2 million in the year-ago period was driven by higher trading volume and revenue growth.

High Court rejects bid to bring ST Engineering unit into trademark infringement suit over RSAF aircraft parts

[SINGAPORE] The High Court has rejected a wholesale trader's attempt to bring ST Engineering Aerospace Systems into a trademark infringement suit over allegedly counterfeit components supplied for use in Republic of Singapore Air Force aircraft.

DBS sees choppy Q3 for STI as investors pivot from Singapore banks to listcos that're unlocking value

[SINGAPORE] DBS Group Research expects the Straits Times Index to face a choppy third quarter, and a tactical rotation away from local banks, citing an increasingly concentrated rally that has left index valuations elevated while broader market performance lags.

OCBC raises 2026 loan growth forecast after Q2 profit jumps 22%, lifts dividend

[SINGAPORE] OCBC has raised its full-year loan growth guidance after a stronger-than-expected first half, as continued momentum in **wealth management** and corporate lending helped offset lower interest rates.

'Size in banking is not everything': UOB pursues capital-light strategy as Q2 profit rises; trims fee growth outlook

[SINGAPORE] UOB signalled that it will continue pruning non-core businesses as it reshapes itself into a more capital-light, advisory-led lender, with group chief executive Wee Ee Cheong saying that the bank will focus on businesses where it has a competitive advantage.

Ex-Sakae director Ong Siew Kwee handed 10.5-year jail term for misappropriating S\$15.8 million, lying in court

[SINGAPORE] Former Sakae director Ong Siew Kwee was sentenced to 10.5 years of imprisonment on Friday (Aug 7) for his role in the misappropriation of S\$15.8 million from a joint venture linked to the Bugis Cube development and giving false evidence in court.

Document STBT000020260807em87001b9

The Week in Asia-Pacific Banking

UOB to divest asset management unit; HSBC sells Australian home loan portfolio

1,125 words

7 August 2026

Market Intelligence News

MKTINWS

English

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S&P Global Market Intelligence offers our top picks of banking news stories and more published throughout the week. Please note that some entries may have links to third-party sources that require a subscription.

Earnings results

- DBS Group Holdings Ltd. reported a consolidated net profit of S\$3.08 billion for the second quarter, up 9.2% year over year from S\$2.82 billion.
- United Overseas Bank Ltd. reported a consolidated net profit of S\$1.48 billion for the quarter ended June 30, up 10% year over year from S\$1.34 billion.
- Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp. Ltd. reported a net profit of S\$2.22 billion for the second quarter ended June 30, up 22% year over year from S\$1.82 billion.
- Sumitomo Mitsui Financial Group Inc. reported a consolidated net profit of ¥501.37 billion for the fiscal first quarter ended June 30, up 33.0% year over year from ¥376.90 billion.
- Mebuki Financial Group Inc. reported a consolidated net profit of ¥34.50 billion for the quarter ended June 30, marking a year-over-year increase of ¥12.2 billion, or 32.4%.
- Shizuoka Financial Group Inc. reported a consolidated net profit of ¥32.74 billion for the quarter ended June 30, up 44.97% year over year from ¥22.58 billion.
- Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co. posted an attributable net profit of 24.90 billion Philippine pesos in the first half, inching up 0.23% from 24.85 billion pesos in the prior-year half. T
- Habib Bank Ltd. booked a consolidated net profit of 18.39 billion Pakistani rupees for the quarter ended June, up 3.17% year over year from 17.82 billion rupees.

Mergers and deals

- HSBC Holdings PLC agreed to sell its A\$36 billion Australian home and personal loan portfolio to Blackstone Inc.-affiliate Virgo Bidco Pty. Ltd. The UK-based lender will wind down its Australian retail banking operations over 18 months.
- Westpac Banking Corp. completed the sale of RAMS Financial Group Pty. Ltd.'s mortgage portfolio to a consortium comprising Pepper Money Ltd. and funds managed by KKR & Co. Inc. and Pacific Investment Management Co. LLC for about A\$15.4 billion.
- Police & Nurses Ltd. (P&N) and Bank Australia Ltd. will advance to the regulatory application stage of their proposed merger after completing initial due diligence.
- Shivalik Small Finance Bank Ltd. completed its acquisition of ManiBhavnam Home Finance India Pvt. Ltd. for nearly 1.09 billion rupees, The Economic Times reported.
- Malayan Banking Bhd. (Maybank) agreed to buy Belgium-based Ageas Insurance International Nv's 30.95% stake in their joint venture, Maybank Ageas Holdings Bhd, for 4.83 billion Malaysian ringgit.
- DFCC Bank PLC completed the acquisition KA 95045199 of the **wealth** and retail banking business of Standard Chartered Bank (Sri Lanka) Ltd. for 3.66 billion Sri Lankan rupees plus applicable taxes.

- HSBC Holdings said the privatization of its Hong Kong unit, Hang Seng Bank Ltd., will not result in layoffs, and there is no plan to merge the banks' customer-facing frontline operations, The Standard reported.
- Daiwa Next Bank Ltd. completed the acquisition of all outstanding shares of Orix Bank Corp. from ORIX Corp. Orix Bank is now a wholly owned subsidiary of Daiwa Next Bank.
- United Overseas Bank agreed to sell UOB Asset Management Ltd. to Germany's Allianz Global Investors for S\$555 million. The deal covers UOB Asset's operations across eight Asian markets, including Singapore, Japan and Thailand.

Regulatory activity

- The Reserve Bank of India said in a news release that its concessional foreign exchange swap facility drew \$40.82 billion in overseas currency inflows since opening in June.
- The Reserve Bank of India will resume issuing licenses to urban cooperative banks after a pause of more than two decades.
- Bangladesh's government will no longer appoint the managing directors and CEOs of the country's six state-owned financial institutions, the Dhaka Tribune reported.
- India's finance ministry suggested changes to a rule that could allow banks and payment companies to charge fees to major retailers for processing digital transactions through the Unified Payments Interface (UPI), Moneycontrol reported.
- The Reserve Bank of India issued new instructions on conduct related to loan-dues recovery to all commercial banks.
- State Bank of Vietnam plans to close millions of dormant accounts to clean up the banking database and curb financial fraud, Viet Nam News reported.

Monetary policy

- The Bank of Japan said it held its short-term policy rate at 1.0% in an 8-1 vote. The Japanese regulator expects core inflation to accelerate "clearly above" 2% from the second half of fiscal 2026.
- Bangladesh Bank cut its benchmark policy rate by 50 basis points to 9.50%, effective Aug. 2. The central bank said the economy remains in a fragile, uneven recovery, with real GDP growth slowing to 2.2% in the third quarter of fiscal year 2026.
- The Reserve Bank of India held its repurchase rate steady at 5.25% and kept a neutral policy stance.

Expansion and other initiatives

- Tamilnad Mercantile Bank Ltd. plans to open liaison offices in Singapore, Malaysia and the Middle East to expand its outreach to Indians living abroad, Moneycontrol reported.
- SBI Shinsei Bank Ltd. will collaborate with more than 20 regional banks on large-scale syndicated loans exceeding ¥100 billion for M&A and data center-related projects, The Nikkei reported.
- Hana Financial Group Inc. is boosting its financial inclusion initiatives after allocating 60% of its 3.1 trillion won budget for 2026 during the first half of 2026, The Korea Times reported.

In other news

- SBI Shinsei Bank Ltd. will begin paying dividends twice a year starting with the fiscal year ending March 31, 2027. The move aims to enhance shareholder returns while maintaining financial soundness.
- The Bank of Korea plans to buy domestically produced gold for the first time in 13 years through over-the-counter transactions, Yonhap News Agency reported.
- Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank is exploring tokenized payments and digital settlement systems, tapping Hong Kong's growing digital finance ecosystem, the South China Morning Post reported.

Featured during the week on S&P Capital IQ Pro

DBS expects 2026 total income to grow as **wealth** fees offset rate pressure

July slide hits Vietnam's bank stocks while broader Asia-Pacific sees gains

Australia's stability creates fertile ground for M&A activity in Asia-Pacific

APAC financial sector deals to rise in H2'26 as India, Japan lead activity

Singapore banks' Q2 profits seen steady as non-interest income offsets NIM drop

Japan's megabanks on track to achieve full-year earnings targets with strong Q1

Document MKTINWS020260807em87000bb

Companies & Markets

UOB dips 2.2% while OCBC rises 2% after Q2 earnings releases

Chloe Lim

263 words

7 August 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

online

English

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[SINGAPORE] Shares of local banks UOB and OCBC diverged post-Q2 earnings release, with UOB declining 2.2 per cent, while OCBC shares rose 2 per cent on Friday (Aug 7).

UOB shares declined 1.5 per cent at market open, before slipping further to S\$42.61 at 9.06 am, down 2.2 per cent or S\$0.97, after about 1.1 million securities valued at S\$46.1 million were transacted.

On the other hand, OCBC shares were up 2 per cent, before easing to S\$29.88 at 9.06 am, still up 1.9 per cent or S\$0.55. Around 1.8 million securities worth S\$52.7 million changed hands.

This comes after the two banks Q2' earnings beat forecasts, with OCBC's operating profit up 12 per cent year on year at S\$2.6 billion, on strong contributions from its **wealth management** and insurance segments.

UOB's operating profit was also up 2 per cent year on year at S\$2 billion for Q2, but its H1 operating profit declined 4 per cent on the year to hit S\$3.9 billion.

UOB's net profit for its second quarter rose 10 per cent to S\$1.48 billion, compared with S\$1.34 billion for the year-ago period. Meanwhile, OCBC's net profit for the period was up 22 per cent at S\$2.22 billion, from S\$1.82 billion previously.

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Document STBT000020260807em870005m

Banking: UOB Sells \$434M Asset Management Business in 8 Markets, Including Vietnam

151 words

7 August 2026

Vietnam News Brief Service

VIETNB

English

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Singapore-based United Overseas Bank (UOB) agreed on August 5 to sell its asset management business operating in eight Asian markets, including Vietnam, to Allianz Global Investors for \$434 million, expanding AllianzGI's regional **wealth management** presence.

The acquisition covers UOB Asset Management's operations in Singapore, Brunei, Indonesia, Japan, Malaysia, Taiwan (China), Thailand, and Vietnam. The deal also includes surplus cash and a ten-year investment product distribution agreement.

UOB Asset Management managed approximately SGD42 billion in client assets at the end of 2025. UOB said the sale supports its strategy to focus on investment advisory services and product distribution instead of directly owning an asset management company.

About 500 employees will transfer to AllianzGI, which plans to retain all staff. UOB will continue distributing investment products from both firms through its banking network across Southeast Asia, including Vietnam.

Document VIETNB0020260806em87000b5

UOB Strengthens **Wealth Management** Through Strategic Distribution Partnership With Allianz Global Investors

817 words

6 August 2026

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MarketLine News and Comment

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English

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The partnership expands customers' access to investment solutions and reinforces UOB's advisory-based **wealth management** services across ASEAN.

UOB Group has entered into a strategic partnership with Allianz Global Investors (AGI). Under this partnership, AGI will acquire UOB Asset Management (UOBAM). The acquisition includes UOBAM's business in eight Asian markets: Singapore, Brunei, Indonesia, Japan, Malaysia, Taiwan, Thailand, and Vietnam. As part of the agreement, UOB and AGI will also establish a long-term distribution partnership. This partnership strengthens UOB's position as a provider of investment product distribution services using an open architecture approach, while expanding the range of investment solutions available to customers. The move also underscores UOB's focus on advisory-based **wealth management** services that help customers develop and preserve the value of their assets over the long term.

Through this partnership, UOB will offer an increasingly diverse set of investment products and solutions to more than eight million customers across ASEAN. The partnership reinforces UOB's open architecture strategy by providing access to global investment capabilities, while continuing to prioritize advisory services, product suitability aligned with customers' risk profiles, and the achievement of long-term investment objectives. In addition to expanding customers' investment choices, this collaboration supports UOB's **wealth management** business growth targets through a wider range of investment solutions tailored to customers' risk profiles, life cycles, and financial goals.

The transaction is still subject to regulatory approvals in the relevant jurisdictions and is targeted to be completed in 2027. During this process, UOBAM and AGI are committed to ensuring a smooth transition for both customers and employees. Under the agreement, all 500 UOBAM employees across different countries will join AGI. AGI is committed to retaining their employment relationships and providing opportunities for them to become part of a broader global investment platform. During the transition period, UOBAM's operational activities will continue normally, allowing customers to keep accessing services, investing, and redeeming UOBAM investment funds without changes or service disruptions.

Excluding the one-off transaction costs, the transaction value totals S\$555 million. UOB expects the transaction to record a profit before tax of approximately S\$330 million, and to increase the Group's Common Equity Tier 1 (CET1) ratio by about 14 basis points. This step is part of UOB's long-term strategy to strengthen its business focus. By optimizing the value of its asset management business and maintaining the strategic partnership with AGI, UOB is positioned to grow its **wealth management** business, drive sustainable profit growth, and enhance long-term valuation for shareholders.

After four decades as part of UOB Group, UOBAM has grown into one of Asia's leading asset management networks, with operations across multiple countries. As of December 31, 2025, UOBAM's total assets under management (AUM) reached approximately S\$42 billion. Based on the unaudited pro forma consolidated balance sheet as of December 31, 2025, the net asset value related to the disposal of the equity interest in this transaction is S\$223 million.

Deputy Chairman & Chief Executive Officer of UOB, Wee Ee Cheong, said: "UOB serves more than eight million customers in ASEAN with increasingly diverse and complex investment and asset management needs. This partnership further strengthens our focus on providing advisory services and distributing investment products. By combining UOB's expertise in investment advisory services and building long-term relationships with customers, together with Allianz Global Investors' investment capabilities, we are ready to meet customers' evolving needs and help them achieve their long-term financial goals. This collaboration also supports us in accelerating the

growth of our **wealth management** business and enhancing long-term valuation for shareholders. During the transition period, we will maintain continuity of service for customers and provide certainty for employees. We would like to express our appreciation for the dedication and contributions of the UOBAM management team and all employees over the past four decades, enabling UOBAM to develop into one of the most trusted asset management networks in the region."

Meanwhile, Chief Executive Officer of Allianz Global Investors, Tobias Pross, said: "This transaction is an important milestone in Allianz Global Investors' journey in Asia Pacific. By bringing together the investment expertise of UOB Asset Management in Southeast Asia and the global, scalable active investment platform we have, we are building a stronger organization with enhanced capabilities to serve customers across the region. Through this collaboration, customers can access a more diverse and innovative range of investment solutions, **wealth management**, and retirement planning. Just as importantly, today's announcement also marks the start of a long-term distribution partnership between Allianz Global Investors and UOB, a trusted financial institution serving millions of customers in Southeast Asia. With complementary capabilities and an expanding market reach, we are optimistic that we can strengthen our relationships with customers while delivering greater added value in the future."

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Standard Chartered declares GH¢673.48 million dividend at its 56th Annual General Meeting

358 words

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Business and Financial Times

BUSFINC

English

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The Bank declared a dividend of GH¢4.989 per ordinary share, amounting to a total payout of GH¢672.35 million, and preference share dividend of GH¢1.13 million resulting in a total payout of GH¢673.48 million after shareholders approved the final dividend at the Bank's 56

th

Annual General Meeting (AGM) held in Accra.

The Bank also reaffirmed its commitment to supporting Ghana's economic development as it marks 130 years of continuous operation. This commitment was reinforced during the Board's engagement with shareholders, where the Bank's impact and contribution to Ghana's progress, from trade and infrastructure to **wealth** creation and cross-border banking solutions were highlighted.

Addressing shareholders, Mr Ebenezer Twum Asante, Chairman of Standard Chartered Bank Ghana PLC, highlighted the bank's commitment to delivering shareholder value.

He said, \

Mr Xorse Godzi, Chief Executive of Standard Chartered Bank Ghana PLC, commenting on the Bank's priorities, said "Our focus is on supporting our clients' ambitions while positioning the Bank for sustainable growth. As a super-connector bank, we leverage our international network, deep local expertise and differentiated capabilities to provide cross-border banking solutions that connect Ghanaian businesses and institutions to global markets, capital and innovation. We will continue to deepen client relationships, strengthen our digital capabilities and deliver solutions that help our clients navigate change with confidence."

"As we commemorate 130 years in Ghana, our priorities remain anchored in disciplined execution, innovation and long-term value creation, while contributing to the country's continued economic development." he added.

Since its establishment in 1896, the Bank has been a trusted partner in the country's economic evolution, enabling trade and investment, supporting enterprise growth, advancing innovation and connecting Ghana to global opportunities through the strength of its international network.

The Bank contributes to sustainable economic growth through our core banking business, responsible business practices, community investment and the development of talent. Given our heritage and legacy, we also provide thought leadership on key industry topics, helping to shape and strengthen the banking and financial services.

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Search Summary

Text	"wealth" or "wealth management"
Date	01/08/2026 to 30/08/2026
Source	Group: All Pubs Excluding Wires Not MBMR (Mavericks Business & Market Research) (India)
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